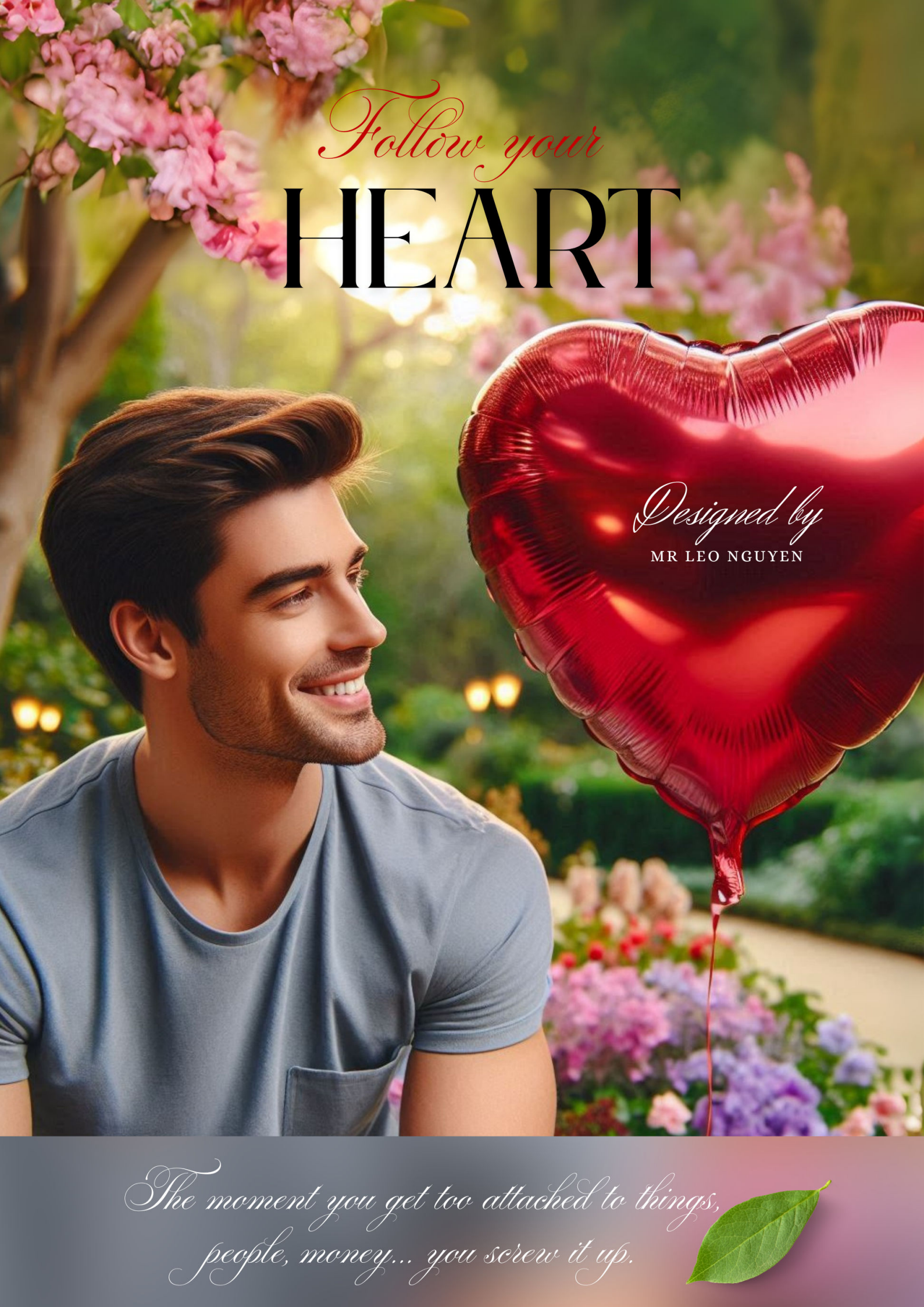

Follow your
HEART
Designed by
MR LEO NGUYEN
The moment you get too attached to things,
people, money... you screw it up.

1

WE ARE HERE TO LEARN LESSONS, AND THE WORLD IS OUR TEACHER.

When we fail to learn a lesson,
we get to take it again... and again!
Once we have learned the lesson,
we move on to the next one.
(And we never run out of lessons!)

WHY DO I NEED DISASTERS?

LESSONS

LIVING AND LEARNING



Something can be staring you in the face…
(Cái gì đó có thể đang nhìn chằm chằm vào mặt bạn [rành rành trước mặt bạn]…)

When I was ten, my most prized possession was my football – I ate with it, slept with it and I polished it weekly... instead of my shoes. I knew all about football – but on some other things, like where babies came from, I was a little hazy. One afternoon I was playing in the street and I lost my precious ball. I looked everywhere. I figured someone had stolen it.	Possession /pəˈzeʃ.ən/ **(n)** vật sở hữu Polish /ˈpɑː.lɪʃ/ **(v)** đánh bóng Hazy /ˈheɪ.zi/ **(adj)** mơ hồ, mù mịt

Eventually I spotted a woman who seemed to be hiding it under her jacket. So I marched up and asked her: “What do you think you’re doing with my football stuck up your shirt?” It turned out that she didn’t have my football... but that afternoon I learned where babies come from – and what a woman looks like when she is nine months pregnant. Later that day, I also found my ball. What fascinated me most of all, was why, before the age of ten, I had never noticed a pregnant woman... and why, from then onward, I seemed to be surrounded by them.	Spot /spɑːt/ **(v)** phát hiện Turn out **(ph.v)** hóa ra Fascinate /ˈfæs.ən.eɪt/ **(v)** làm thích thú, khiến cho hứng thú From then onward - từ đó trở đi

IN A NUTSHELL

We reach points in our life when we are ready for new information. Until then, something can be staring us in the face but we don’t see it.



Why do I need disasters?

(Tại sao tôi cần những tai họa?)

The only time most of us ever learn anything is when we get hit over the back of the head! Why? Because it’s easier not to change. So we keep doing what we’re doing until we hit a brick wall. Take our health for example. When do we change diets and start exercising? When our body is falling apart – when the doctor says: “If you don’t change your lifestyle, you’ll kill yourself!” Suddenly we’re motivated! In relationships – when do we usually tell each other how much we care? When the marriage is falling apart, when the family is falling apart! In school – when do we finally knuckle down and study? When we’re about to fail. In business – when do we try new ideas and make the tough decisions? When we can’t pay our bills. When do we finally learn about customer service? After	Fall apart **(ph.v)** tan rã, trở nên không còn tốt Knuckle down /ˈnʌk.əl/ **(ph.v)** dốc sức, tích cực bắt tay vào việc gì đó Rough /rʌf/ **(adj)** khó khăn, gian nan Knock-back /nɑːk bæk/ **(n)** sự bác bỏ, sự từ chối, trở ngại Broke /broʊk/ **(adj)** túng quẫn, bần cùng, không tiền

the customers have left! When do we usually pray? When our life is falling apart! "Dear Lord, I know I haven't spoken to you since the last time the yogurt hit the fan..." We learn our biggest lessons when things get rough. When have you made the most important decisions in your life? When you were on your knees – after disasters, after knock-backs, when you've been kicked in the head. That's when we say to ourselves: "I'm sick of being broke, sick of being kicked around. I'm tired of being mediocre. I'm going to do something." Success we celebrate – but we don't learn too much. Failure hurts – and that's when we get educated. In retrospect, we usually notice "disasters" were turning points. Effective people don't go looking for problems, but when they get smacked in the mouth, they ask themselves: "*How do I need to change what I'm thinking and what I'm doing? How can I be better than I am now?*" Losers ignore all the warning signs. When the roof falls in, they ask: "*Why does everything happen to me?*" We are creatures of habit. We keep doing what we are doing until we are forced to change. Mary gets dumped by boyfriend Al. Devastated, she locks herself in her bedroom for a week. Then gradually she starts to call old friends and meet new ones. She soon moves house and changes jobs. Within six months she is happier and more confident than she has ever been in her life. She looks back on the "disaster" of losing Al as the best thing that ever happened to her. Fred gets the sack. Unable to find work, he starts his own little business. For the first time in his life he is his own boss, and doing what he really wants to do. He still has his problems, but his life has new meaning and excitement – and all out of apparent disaster.	Mediocre /ˌmiː.diˈoʊ.kər/ **(adj)** xoàng, tầm thường In retrospect /ˈret.rə.spekt/ nhìn lại Turning point /ˈtɜːr.nɪŋ ˌpɔɪnt/ **(n)** bước ngoặt Smack /smæk/ **(v)** vả, tát, đánh Devastated /ˈdev.ə.steɪ.ʈɪd/ **(adj)** đau khổ, buồn bã Gradually /ˈgrædʒ.u.ə.li/ **(adv)** dần dần, từ từ Get the sack - bị sa thải
SO IS LIFE A SERIES OF PAINFUL DISASTERS? Not necessarily. The universe is always nudging us with gentle signals. When we ignore the signals, it nudges us with a sledgehammer. Growth is most painful when we resist it.	Nudge /nʌdʒ/ **(v)** đẩy nhẹ, thúc nhẹ Sledgehammer /ˈsledʒˌhæm.ər/ **(n)** búa tạ



Lessons

Some things are beyond our understanding... when a child is born with AIDS, when a young mother is gunned down in a hold up, when a whole village is wiped out by flood, we are left asking: "Why?" For these things there seem to be no answers. But on a different level – on the "everyday life level" – we can find some clues.

Have you ever noticed that certain things happen to certain people? Louise gets fired about every six months, Frank seems to get sued every year, Jim gets food poisoning on vacation.

Certain things *don't* seem to happen to certain people. Jim never gets fired, Louise never goes to court and Frank doesn't send postcards from hospital.

Particular people get particular lessons. We can react to all of this in one of three ways. We either say:

"My life is a series of lessons I need, happening in perfect order."
(The healthiest approach, guarantees maximum peace of mind.)

"Life is a lottery, but I make the most of whatever comes along."
(The next best option – offers average quality of life.)

"Why do bad things always happen to me?"
(Guarantees maximum misery and frustration.)

We are continually being presented with lessons. *Unless we learn the lessons, we get to take them again... and again... and again.*

Call it a divine plan, call it the natural unfolding of events, it is happening. Like it or hate it, it is happening. Take responsibility or claim you're a victim, fight it or ignore it, it's happening. It has been happening all your life. Every time your neighbour abused you, each time a salesman ripped you off or a lover walked out on you, there was a

Hold up **(n)** vụ cướp (cướp đường, cướp ngân hàng…)

Wipe out **(ph.v)** tàn phá, quét sạch

Clue /kluː/ **(n)** gợi ý, lý do, manh mối

Get fired = Get sacked - bị sa thải, bị đuổi việc

Get sued /suːd/ bị kiện

Court /kɔːrt/ **(n)** tòa án

Particular /pərˈtɪk.jə.lər/ **(adj)** cụ thể, nhất định, riêng biệt

Guarantee /ˌger.ənˈtiː/ **(v)** bảo đảm

Misery /ˈmɪz.ər.i/ **(n)** sự khổ sở, khốn khổ

Frustration /frʌsˈtreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự thất vọng, khó chịu

Divine /dɪˈvaɪn/ **(adj)** thần thánh, của thượng đế

Unfold /ʌnˈfoʊld/ **(v)** mở ra, bày ra, diễn ra

Victim /ˈvɪk.təm/ **(n)** nạn nhân

Abuse /əˈbjuːz/ **(v)** xỉ nhục, chửi rủa

Rip off **(ph.v)** lừa tiền, lừa bán với giá mắc

lesson staring you in the face. If we are miserable seven days a week, it's likely we've missed a lesson. When we keep losing jobs, lovers, money... it's a sign that we haven't been paying attention. As one lady remarked: "*I keep getting the same old problems in a different pair of trousers!*" The worst thing we can ever say is: "*It's not fair!*"	Walk out on SB/STh **(ph.v)** bỏ, bỏ rơi, từ bỏ Miserable /ˈmɪz.ər.ə.bəl/ **(adj)** khốn khổ, khổ sở Remark /rɪˈmɑːrk/ **(v)** nói, nhận xét, bình luận I keep getting the same old problems in a different pair of trousers - Tôi cứ gặp cùng những vấn đề cũ dù tôi đã mặc quần mới (liên kết với các câu trên: tác giả đùa rằng người này không biết vấn đề đến từ đâu).

IN A NUTSHELL (tóm lại)

*We are not here to be **punished**. We are here to be **educated**. Every event has the potential to transform us, and disasters have the greatest potential to change our thinking. ACT AS IF EVERY EVENT HAS A PURPOSE, AND YOUR LIFE WILL HAVE PURPOSE. Figure out why you needed an experience, conquer it, and you won't need it again.*

Potential /poʊˈten.ʃəl/ **(n)** tiềm năng

Punish /ˈpʌn.ɪʃ/ **(v)** phạt, trừng phạt

Conquer /ˈkɑːŋ.kər/ **(v)** chinh phục, chiến thắng



I could do anything but that!

(Tôi có thể làm bất cứ điều gì trừ điều đó!)

We usually want to postpone our most important lessons. We might look at our rocky relationship with our mother and say: "After all the nasty things she has said, I could do *anything* but love her." Right! You probably *could* do almost anything but that right now. That is why it is your	Postpone /poʊstˈpoʊn/ **(v)** trì hoãn Rocky /ˈrɑː.ki/ **(adj)** lung lay, không vững

lesson. Growth is about breaking new ground!	Nasty /ˈnæs.ti/ **(adj)** tồi tệ, khó chịu, thô lỗ
MY EX HUSBAND IS A PAIN IN THE BUTT! Divorcing someone doesn't mean our class with them is over. If the marriage is finished, but we're still blaming them for our misery and our mortgage, we are still hooked to them! We remain linked because there is more to learn. You say: "But the guy is a turkey! I could do *anything*, but forgive him!" Forgiving him probably *would* be the hardest thing – and it's probably something you are not good at – so you are getting a chance to practise it. You can postpone the class, but if you want your life (and your health) to improve, you'll have to take it sometime. While we believe that someone is ruining our life, that belief will make it true for us. It might seem like *they* are in the way of our happiness. Actually it's us in the way – because we choose how we see people.	Mortgage /ˈmɔːr.gɪdʒ/ **(n)** việc thế chấp, món nợ thế chấp Hook /hʊk/ **(v)** móc vào, dính vào Turkey /ˈtɜːr.ki/ **(n)** kẻ bất tài, vô tích sự, kẻ ngốc Ruin /ˈruː.ɪn/ **(v)** làm hỏng, hủy hoại
MY BOSS IS A CREEP. IT'S NOT MY FAULT – HE NEEDS TO STOP BEING A CREEP! (SO WHAT'S MY LESSON?) While you remain convinced that your boss is a certified creep, he'll be a creep. And it's OK to think he's a creep. At the point you choose to change – e.g. focus on his good points, stop judging him, even empathize a little – the problem will evaporate. How, you say? There are a thousand possibilities... a) he may respond to your change of attitude and begin to open up, b) he may be transferred to another department, c) you may get another job, d) he may get another job, e) you may get to like the guy. (Really!) How often do we befriend people who, initially, we couldn't tolerate? When you change, your situation changes. It is law. You don't have to figure out how it will happen. Your transformation alters your circumstance. But your change must be genuine. You say: "I'll put up with Fred but I still know he's a jerk!" But that isn't a major transformation on your part! **How long will it take?** As long as it takes you to	Creep /kriːp/ (n) kẻ khó chịu, kẻ kì cục, người bạn ghét, kẻ xu nịnh Evaporate /ɪˈvæp.ə.reɪt/ **(v)** biến mất, tan biến Open up **(ph.v)** cởi mở, mở lòng Befriend /bɪˈfrend/ **(v)** kết bạn, đối xử tốt Tolerate /ˈtɑː.lə.reɪt/ **(v)** chịu đựng, tha thứ Alter /ˈɑːl.tər/ **(v)** thay đổi, biến đổi Circumstance /ˈsɜːr.kəm.stæns/ **(n)** hoàn cảnh Genuine /ˈdʒen.juː.ɪn/ **(adj)** thật, chân thật Put up with SB/STh **(ph.v)** chịu đựng (ai đó, điều gì

change. **Why don't I just leave this job now?** You can do that. But chances are you'll find yourself working for another creep – it's all part of the great cosmic curriculum!	đó) Jerk /dʒɜːrk/ **(n)** kẻ ngu ngốc, tên đáng ghét Chance /tʃæns/ **(n)** khả năng Cosmic /ˈkɑːzmɪk/ **(adj)** (thuộc về) vũ trụ Curriculum /kəˈrɪk.jə.ləm/ **(n)** giáo trình

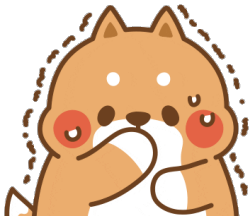
Maybe if I go to a new city, I can make a new start
(Có lẽ nếu tôi đến một thành phố mới, tôi có thể tạo ra một khởi đầu mới)



Wrong! *Usually, the best place to make a new start is where you are!* Take Fred, who owes money to half the neighborhood. Fred says to himself: "Maybe I need to move!" But when he moves, he'll take his thoughts and habit patterns with him – and they are what shape his life. Fred changes cities and attracts the same situations, and another bunch of angry creditors. If you are a spendthrift, and you migrate to Argentina, you'll still be a spendthrift. The best advice to Fred: "*Before changing your address, consider changing your thinking!*"	Pattern /ˈpæţ.ərn/ **(n)** mẫu, khuôn mẫu Creditor /ˈkred.ɪ.ţər/ **(n)** chủ nợ Spendthrift /ˈspend.θrɪft/ **(n)** người ăn xài hoang phí, người phung phí Migrate /ˈmaɪ.greɪt/ **(v)** di cư
LESSONS CHASE US AROUND THE WORLD In Jill's family, money was a dirty word. Her parents weren't especially short of it, but she was embarrassed to ask for it, they didn't want to share it and the whole family argued about it. She left home and went to live in Barcelona and married a fellow who makes plenty of money but won't give her any! When you step off the plane, your lessons are there to greet you!	Chase /tʃeɪs/ **(v)** đuổi theo Short /ʃɔːrt/ **(adj)** thiếu (tiền)
IF ONLY I COULD GO TO TIBET, MAYBE I COULD FIND THE MEANING OF LIFE...	Grand /grænd/ **(adj)** tuyệt vời

Some of us get grand ideas about travelling to distant lands to find the meaning of life... Jim treks off to the Himalayas. One day, while sitting on a dusty street corner, racked with diarrhoea and dreaming of a warm bath, he has a blinding flash: “Maybe I can ‘do enlightenment’ at the Ritz Carlton!” It sounds romantic finding the meaning of life in Tibet, but enlightenment in Tibet is for Tibetans! The meaning of life for most of us is probably in the suburbs.	Rack /ræk/ **(v)** hành hạ, giày vò Diarrhoea /daɪ.əˈriː.ə/ **(n)** bệnh tiêu chảy Flash /flæʃ/ **(n)** sự lóe lên, ý tưởng bất ngờ Enlightenment /ɪnˈlaɪ.ʈən.mənt/ **(n)** sự giác ngộ Ritz Carlton tên một khách sạn sang trọng Tibet /tɪˈbet/ **(n)** Tây Tạng. Tibetan /tɪˈbet.ən/ **(n)** người Tây Tạng Suburb /ˈsʌb.ɜːrb/ **(n)** ngoại ô, ngoại thành

Lessons we fear
(Những bài học mà chúng ta sợ)



The only way to beat fear is to face it. Because we are always attracting the learning experiences we need, we often attract the experiences that we fear. Therefore, if you are scared witless of being in debt, chances are you’ll get to find out all about it. If you fear loneliness, you’ll attract that. If you fear embarrassment, you’ll fall on your face. It’s life’s way of encouraging us to grow.	Be scared witless /ˈwɪt.ləs/ sợ hết hồn, sợ xanh mặt

IN A NUTSHELL

We are each a cause. Our thoughts attract and create circumstances. As we change, we attract different circumstances. Until we learn a lesson about debt, or work, or lovers we either, (a) stay stuck on the same lesson, or (b) keep getting the same lesson in different packages.

Life goes like this. We get hit by little pebbles - as a kind of warning. When we ignore the

pebbles, we get hit by a brick. Ignore the brick and we get wiped out by a boulder. If we're honest, we can see where we have ignored the warning signs. And then we have the nerve to say: "Why me?"

Pebble /ˈpeb.əl/ **(n)** sỏi, đá cuội

Boulder /ˈboʊl.dər/ **(n)** tảng đá

Nerve /nɜːrv/ **(n)** dũng khí

Living and Learning

"It's only by going down into the abyss
that we recover the treasures of life.
Where you stumble
there lies your treasure.
The very cave you are afraid to enter
turns out to be the source of
what you were looking for."

JOSEPH CAMPBELL

Abyss /əˈbɪs/ **(n)** vực thẳm, vực sâu

Recover /rɪˈkʌv.ər/ **(v)** tìm lại, lấy lại

Stumble /ˈstʌm.bəl/ **(v)** vấp, sẩy chân

Cave /keɪv/ **(n)** hang, động

Life doesn't always have to be painful – but pain is still the main reason we change. Until we are in pain, we can pretend. Our ego says: "I'm fine." When things hurt enough, for example, when we are lonely enough, or scared enough, we become vulnerable. Our ego has no more answers, and we open up. Pain encourages us to get serious.

It's always easier to be philosophical about *other people's pain!* We look at Jim and say: "Going broke was a huge learning experience for him." We look at Mary and say: "That divorce helped her to stand on her own feet." We all agree: "Challenges make you stronger."

But when our own challenges come along, we're not so enthusiastic. We say: "Lord, why this? Give me a *convenient* challenge!" Unfortunately, real challenges aren't convenient.

Ego /ˈiː.goʊ/ **(n)** cái tôi

Vulnerable /ˈvʌl.nər.ə.bəl/ **(adj)** dễ bị tổn thương

Philosophical /ˌfɪl.əˈsɑː.fɪ.kəl/ **(adj)** thản nhiên, bình tĩnh

Enthusiastic /ɪnˌθuː.ziˈæs.tɪk/ **(adj)** nhiệt tình, hăng hái

If only I could have some quality people in my life…
(Giá như tôi có thể có một số người chất lượng trong cuộc đời mình…)



We might look at our life and say: *"If I didn't have to deal with my lazy husband and these rowdy kids, I could get about my personal growth..."* Wrong! They are your personal growth. The people in our life are our teachers. Husbands who snore and leave cupboard doors open, "ungrateful" children, neighbors who park across the driveway... Only for so long can we tell ourselves: "I'd be happier if these guys got their act together!" If your wife makes you angry, then your project is to deal with anger effectively. And you have the perfect person to help you do it right in your home. A practice partner! What fortune! You might say: "I'll divorce her! That will fix it!" But it will fix it only until you marry someone else who will make you just as angry.	Rowdy /ˈraʊ.di/ **(adj)** om sòm, ầm ĩ Snore /ˈvʌl.nər.ə.bəl/ **(v)** ngáy Ungrateful /ʌnˈgreɪt.fəl/ **(adj)** vô ơn What fortune! - Thật là cả gia tài / Quả là vận may!

IN A NUTSHELL

Every person who walks into your life is a teacher. Even if they drive you nuts, they teach you because they show you where your limits are. Just because peolpe are your teachers doesn't mean you have to like them.

Drive SB nuts - khiến ai đó phát điên lên

Step by step

(Từng bước một)

Life is a bit like a ladder. To move up, we have to fix the step we're on – whether it's work, relationships, money, whatever. Once the step is fixed, we move to the next step. People handle their steps in different ways: *"I hate this step – I want to be on a different one."* That's when we stay stuck. *"I want someone else's ladder."* That's called jealousy. *"To hell with this ladder – I'm jumping off."* That is called suicide. Whenever we are stuck, we might ask ourselves: "What haven't I fixed?"	Ladder /ˈlæd.ər/ **(n)** cái thang Jealousy /ˈdʒel.ə.si/ **(n)** sự ghen tỵ Suicide /ˈsuː.ə.saɪd/ **(n)** sự tự vẫn

When does life get simpler?

(Khi nào cuộc sống trở nên đơn giản hơn?)



It doesn't! But you can learn to handle it better. When you sign up for planet Earth, you get the whole "life class" which means *as long as you are breathing, school is in session.* We keep thinking that once we get past pre-school, grade school, puberty… once we go to work, life will get easier. It doesn't. No one ever warned us! No wonder we get frustrated. We look at other people who, from a distance, seem to be on easy street, but they're dealing with their own problems... Bill appears to be cruising. He retires on a healthy pension – the house is paid off, he drives a nice car, eats in fine restaurants, he takes overseas vacations, plays some golf. What we don't know is that he's suing his insurance company, the roof is leaking, his son is on cocaine and some burglar will have his video recorder by this time tomorrow. All of us are constantly challenged.	Puberty /ˈpjuː.bər.ţi/ **(n)** tuổi dậy thì Frustrated /ˈfrʌs.treɪ.ţɪd/ **(adj)** nản lòng, khó chịu Cruise /kruːz/ **(v)** đi dạo chơi, du ngoạn (bằng tàu thủy) Pension /ˈpen.ʃən/ **(n)** lương hưu Leak /liːk/ **(v)** dột, rò rỉ Burglar /ˈbɜːr.glər/ **(n)** kẻ trộm

Another reason life doesn't get simpler…

(Một lý do khác khiến cuộc sống không trở nên đơn giản hơn…)

When things get too easy, we look for more problems. We say to ourselves: "I can do this with my eyes shut! I need a challenge." When life gets too simple, we start a family! When the house is paid off, we buy a bigger one! It's not just the world that complicates our lives, we do.	



So how do I keep from going crazy?
(Vậy làm thế nào để tôi không hóa điên?)

It's how you deal with it. • Never tell yourself: "I can't relax and enjoy myself until..." Relax and enjoy while you're in the middle of things. • Continually ask yourself: "What am I learning from this?" We never get our lives tidied into neat little boxes. People see happiness as some kind of distant mirage – like they are crawling through the desert and there's a sign ahead which says "HAPPINESS", and they say: *"If I can just make it THERE, then I'll be happy."* They have it logically figured out: "We can't be happy now because we're having the bathroom remodelled. But next month..." And next month the kids have the flu, the cat's on heat, the in-laws are coming to stay, and they say: "around next April..."	Mirage /mɪˈrɑːʒ/ **(n)** ảo ảnh Crawl /krɑːl/ **(v)** bò, lê bước Remodel /ˌriːˈmɑː.dəl/ **(v)** làm lại, tu sửa In-law /ˈɪn.lɑː/ **(n)** bố mẹ vợ / chồng; họ hàng bên vợ / chồng

Teaching others a lesson
(Dạy những người khác một bài học)

Have you ever been very excited about a book you just read? You take it to a friend and say: "Read this, it's fantastic! Then you hold your breath, waiting for their enthusiastic phone call. But they never call! Six months later you ask for your book to find (a) they never read it, and (b) they've lost it. The lesson here – which applies to "friendly advice" as well as books – is that, just because you're ready for information doesn't mean everyone else is ready.	Hold your breath - Nín thở

IN A NUTSHELL

If people aren't asking you, they usually don't want the information!

So what am I to learn from this?
(Vậy tôi phải học gì từ điều này?)

Reflect on your life to this point, and you'll perhaps see a reason why you took the path you did. You will see people dotted through your past – teachers, lovers and even strangers on aeroplanes – who gave you direction. You'll remember a book you found in a junk shop which shaped your thinking. You will recall "accidents" – heartaches, illnesses, failures and financial crises that made you stronger or taught you compassion. You'll see "disasters" which, in retrospect, were more likely part of a larger scheme. You might get that feeling that you have been learning a series of lessons in just the right order. You might sense that one thing was always leading to another.

In the beginning, it's difficult to see disasters in perspective. There's a lag time, while we're telling ourselves: "This is not part of the approved script – sorry God, you made a big mistake!" It takes us six months to figure how getting fired was actually part of a plan!

The universe is a patient and persistent teacher. Watch the signals and life runs relatively smoothly. But fall asleep at the wheel and "Whammo!" – you attract a major learning experience – a bankruptcy, a divorce, a heart attack.

Fred might argue: "There's no life path. Everyone has to be somewhere at sometime." As he expands his awareness, he might notice his own unfolding curriculum.

SO WHERE ARE MY NEXT LESSONS?

They are usually right under our noses – and often we know exactly what they are, and we're hoping they'll go away!

Reflect (on) /rɪˈflekt/ **(v)** ngẫm nghĩ (về)

Dot /dɑːt/ **(v)** rải rác

Junk shop /ˈdʒʌŋk ˌʃɑːp/ **(n)** cửa hàng bán đồ cũ

Recall /ˈriː.kɑːl/ **(v)** nhớ lại

Crisis /ˈkraɪ.sɪs/ **(n)** sự khủng hoảng (số nhiều: Crises /ˈkraɪ.siːz/)

Compassion /kəmˈpæʃ.ən/ **(n)** lòng trắc ẩn, lòng thương người

Scheme /skiːm/ **(n)** kế hoạch

Perspective /pərˈspek.tɪv/ **(n)** viễn cảnh

In perspective - trong sự tương quan so sánh

Persistent /pərˈsɪs.tənt/ **(adj)** bền bĩ, kiên trì

Bankruptcy /ˈbæŋ.krəpt.si/ **(n)** sự phá sản

Expand /ɪkˈspænd/ **(v)** mở rộng

Awareness /əˈwer.nəs/ **(n)** (sự) nhận thức



2

THE UNIVERSE HAS NO FAVORITES.

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Your success and happiness depend on natural laws and principles - and how you use them.

THE LAW OF THE SEED

CAUSE AND EFFECT

AS YOU GET BETTER, THE GAME GETS BIGGER

DISCIPLINE

BE ADAPTABLE!

Universal laws
(Những quy luật chung)

When the great spiritual teachers told their stories, they spoke of sowing seeds and fetching water. Of course, they talked of seasons, and crops and fish because the people of the time understood farming and fishing. But it goes deeper than that. Nature's laws are all there is. Whether you are a goat herder or computer programmer, the same rules apply.	Spiritual /ˈspɪr.ə.tʃu.əl/ **(adj)** tâm linh Sow /soʊ/ **(v)** gieo hạt Fetch /fetʃ/ **(v)** lấy và đem về Herder /ˈhɜːr.dər/ **(n)** người chăn đàn gia súc

The Law of Seed

(Quy luật gieo hạt)



In my first book, “BEING HAPPY!”, I talk about some of nature’s laws. This chapter expands on those principles. We begin with the law of the seed...

The lesson of the seed is: *“You reap your harvest after you do the work.”* You dig the soil and water the seed (effort), wait a while (patience) and then you pick your beans. Effort + patience = results.

This principle is often lost on people. They say: *“If I plant beans today, what will I get back tomorrow?”* And the answer is: *“Wet bean seeds.”* The law of the seed says: *“You plant today, and you harvest... LATER!”* Plant beans now; pick beans in four months. When everybody grew their own food, people probably understood this concept better. But this is the age of instant noodles.

Fred says: *“If I had a decent job, then I would really work hard. But all I do is wash dishes, so to heck with it.”* Wrong, Fred! If you become the best dish washer in town, someone will notice you, or someone will promote you, or you’ll feel so good about yourself that you’ll one day go and do something you really want to do.

Effort first, harvest second. It’s a principle. You can’t reverse the process. Mary says: *“Promote me, and then I’ll quit sleeping on the job.”* Frank says: *“Pay me more and I’ll stop being sick.”* Jane says: *“If I had a good marriage, I’d be nice to my husband.”*

Credit cards and mail order catalogues encourage us to buy now, pay no interest until February and go broke in March. It’s playing with the same principles. Earn now, pay later works better than buy now, pay later.

Another lesson we learn in the garden: when you plant a dozen bean seeds, you don’t get a dozen bean plants. Fred plants his bean seeds. Some get burned up. Some get blown away. The bugs get a few. The birds take three or four. Fred

Principle /ˈprɪn.sə.pəl/ **(n)** nguyên tắc, nguyên lý

Reap /riːp/ **(v)** gặt

Harvest /ˈhɑːr.vəst/ **(n)** vụ thu hoạch

Dig /dɪg/ **(v)** đào, cuốc (đất)

Effort /ˈef.ərt/ **(n)** (sự) nỗ lực

Patience /ˈpeɪ.ʃəns/ **(n)** (sự) kiên trì, tính kiên nhẫn

Decent /ˈdiː.sənt/ **(adj)** tốt, kha khá, tươm tất

To heck (hell) with it - kệ bà nó, không quan tâm

Promote /prəˈmoʊt/ **(v)** thăng chức, thăng cấp

Reverse /rɪˈvɜːrs/ **(v)** đảo ngược

Sleep on the job - lơ là trong công việc / bỏ bê công việc

Interest /ˈɪn.trɪst/ **(n)** tiền lãi

Acquaintance /əˈkweɪn.təns/ **(n)** người quen

is left with two little bean plants, and he says: “It’s not fair!” It’s life. To find even a few good friends, you begin with a lot of acquaintances. To find the ideal employee, you interview fifty. To find a few regular customers, you begin with a hundred. To find the perfect spaghetti marinara, you eat in a lot of restaurants. Many of your ideas, employees, and even your friends will get blown away or taken by the birds. This is not something you fight, it’s something you understand. It is something you prepare for.	

Cause and effect

(Nguyên nhân và kết quả)

If your life is stagnant, you need to look at what you are putting in. You never hear anyone saying: *“I rise at dawn, I’m exercising my body, I’m studying, I’m nurturing my relationships, I’m putting maximum effort into my work – and NOTHING GOOD is happening in my life.”* Your life is an energy system. If nothing good is happening in your life, it’s your fault. Once you acknowledge that your input shapes your circumstances, you cease to be a victim. We might look at other people’s lives and say: *“What happened to the law of cause and effect?”* Ralph gets a promotion and we ask: *“How did he deserve that?”* The neighbors celebrate forty years of happy marriage, and we say: *“Why are they so lucky?”* It can be confusing, but the same rules of cause and effect operate for everyone. We get in life what we ask for. Bruce charms his women with diamonds and perfume. When they walk out on him, he claims he’s been used for his money. If you go fishing with diamonds for bait, you’ll catch fish that like diamonds! Is that a surprise? Wendy hits the town in plunging necklines. Meanwhile, she’s angry that men only want her for her body. The guys spot the cleavage a block away! Where’s the mystery?	Stagnant /ˈstæg.nənt/ **(adj)** trì trệ Nurture /ˈnɜːr.tʃər/ **(v)** nuôi dưỡng Cease /siːs/ **(v)** không còn, thôi, ngừng Deserve /dɪˈzɜːrv/ **(v)** xứng đáng, đáng Operate /ˈɑː.pə.reɪt/ **(v)** áp dụng, vận hành Charm /tʃɑːrm/ **(v)** quyến rũ Bait /beɪt/ **(n)** mồi Plunging /ˈplʌn.dʒɪŋ/ **(adj)** neckline /ˈnek.laɪn/ **(n)** đường viền cổ áo xẻ sâu Cleavage /ˈkliː.vɪdʒ/ **(n)** khe ngực

IN A NUTSHELL

If we are honest with ourselves, we can list almost everything that's ever happened to us - and see how we helped create it. Don't worry about whether the laws of the universe are delivering for your neighbour. Watch the law of cause and effect at work in your own life - in your own relationships, your own successes and your own disappointments. You will have greater peace of mind.



As you get better, the game gets bigger

(Khi bạn trở nên giỏi hơn, trò chơi trở nên lớn hơn)

When we succeed at a little game, we get to play in a bigger game...and a bigger game.

When we start school, we begin in Grade One. Next we move up to Grade Two, Three and so on. It's an effective system, and the principle is, *"When you get BETTER, the game gets BIGGER."*

Somewhere along the way, people lose track of this concept. Frank is struggling to make his car payments. In twenty years of working, he has saved exactly eighty-seven cents. He says: *"If I had a million bucks, I'd know how to take care of it!"* Wrong! Your current mission, Frank, is to learn to save ten dollars. Hundreds come before thousands... and you work your way up to the million.

Candy is a singer in a local bar and she wants to be a star. She says: *"If I had an audience of a thousand, I'd really give them a show. But if you think I'm going to waste my talents on six losers, you're crazy!"* When Candy learns how to put on a show for six, she'll get twelve, and then a hundred, and one day she'll pack a thousand.

Jim sells insurance from a little office. He has one employee, and he's about to sack her! Jim says: *"If I only had a dozen good staff..."* No Jim, it will never work with a team of twelve until you can make it work with a team of two.

Life is a gradual progression. The question is always: "WHAT ARE YOU DOING WITH WHAT YOU HAVE?" While the answer is "Not much", nothing gets better.

Current /ˈkɜːr.ənt/ **(adj)** hiện thời, hiện tại

Mission /ˈmɪʃ.ən/ **(n)** nhiệm vụ

Talent /ˈtæl.ənt/ **(n)** tài năng

Loser /ˈluː.zər/ **(n)** (từ để chê bai) kẻ thấp kém, không có thành tựu gì

Insurance /ɪnˈʃɜ.r.əns/ **(n)** (sự) bảo hiểm, hợp đồng bảo hiểm

Gradual /ˈgrædʒ.u.əl/ **(adj)** dần dần, từng bước một

Progression /prəˈgreʃ.ən/ **(n)** sự tiến triển, sự tiến bộ



IN A NUTSHELL

The universe rewards effort, not excuses.

Excuse /ɪkˈskjuːz/ **(n)** lời biện hộ, lời bào chữa, cớ

One thing leads to another

(Một điều này dẫn đến một điều khác)

When my world seemed dull, I used to look at people who led[1] fascinating lives and wonder: *"How did their life become so sweet?"* I discovered that they made a start, somewhere. That small start led[2] to something else and to something else.

Sometimes we can make the mistake of being too selective. We might reject a job offer, reasoning: *"It's not quite the job I want."* If it's all you've got for the moment, grab it, master it, and watch it lead you from one thing to another. If you have nothing big going for you, start small. Jump in the water.

Entrepreneur John McCormack tells the story of how his friend, Nick, got his first job in America. Nick was an immigrant. He had no money and spoke no English, and he applied for a dish washing job in an Italian restaurant. Before his interview with the boss, Nick went into the restaurant's bathroom and scrubbed it clean. He then took a toothbrush and cleaned between every tile until the bathroom was completely spotless. By the time Nick had his interview, the boss was trying to figure out: "What's happened to the toilets?" It was Nick's way of saying: "I'm serious about washing dishes.

Nick got the job. A week later, the salad maker quit and Nick was on his way to becoming a chef. I think of Nick and his toothbrush when people tell me: "There are no jobs out

Dull /dʌl/ **(adj)** buồn tẻ, chán ngắt

Lead /liːd/ **(v)** 1 - sống, trải qua (cuộc sống).
2 - dẫn đến
(v2: led /led/)

Selective /səˈlek.tɪv/ **(adj)** (có tính) chọn lựa, kén chọn

Reject /rɪˈdʒekt/ **(v)** từ chối

Entrepreneur /ˌɑːn.trə.prəˈnɜːr/ **(n)** doanh nhân, chủ doanh nghiệp

Immigrant /ˈɪm.ə.grənt/ **(n)** người nhập cư

Scrub /skrʌb/ **(v)** cọ rửa, lau, chùi

Tile /taɪl/ **(n)** tấm (gạch)

Spotless /ˈspɑːt.ləs/ **(adj)** không một vết bẩn

there!”	

IN A NUTSHELL

Start anywhere you can. Give your best shot to whatever is in front of you, and opportunity will begin to find you. It’s called developing a reputation. It’s called “One thing leads to another.”

Reputation /ˌrepjuˈteɪʃn/ **(n)** uy tín, danh tiếng

The Frog Principle

(Nguyên tắc con ếch)

There is an often-quoted story of a frog and a bucket of water. It illustrates the law of deterioration... If you take an intelligent, happy frog and drop him into a bucket of boiling water, what will the frog do? Jump out! Instantly, the frog decides: “This is no fun – I’m gone!” If you take the same frog, or a relative, and drop him into a bucket of cold water, put the bucket on the stove and gradually heat up the bucket, what then? The frog’s relaxing... a few minutes later he says to himself: “It seems warm in here.” Soon enough, you have a cooked frog. The moral of the story? Life happens gradually. Like the frog, we can be fooled, and suddenly it’s too late. We need to be aware of what is happening. QUESTION – If you woke tomorrow twenty kilos heavier, would you be worried? Sure you would! You’d be calling the hospital: “Emergency! I’m fat!” But when things happen gradually, a kilo this month, a kilo next month, we tend to let it go. When you overspend on your budget by ten dollars in one day, it’s no big deal. But if you do it again tomorrow, and the next day, and the next, you end up broke. For people who go broke, put on weight, get divorced, it usually isn’t one big disaster – it’s a bit today and a bit tomorrow – and then one day “Kaboom!” – and they say: “What happened?” Life is accumulative. One thing ADDS to another – like	Often-quoted /kwoʊt̬ɪd/ **(adj)** thường được trích dẫn Bucket /ˈbʌk.ɪt/ **(n)** xô Illustrate /ˈɪl.ə.streɪt/ **(v)** minh họa Deterioration /dɪˌtɪr.i.əˈreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) xấu đi, trở nên tệ hơn Instantly /ˈɪn.stənt.li/ **(adv)** ngay tức khắc, lập tức Moral /ˈmɔːr.əl/ **(n)** bài học, lời răn dạy Emergency! /ɪˈmɜːr.dʒən.si/ **(n)** khẩn cấp! Overspend /ˌoʊ.vərˈspend/ **(v)** tiêu tiền quá mức, quá khả năng Accumulative /əˈkjuː.mjə.lə.t̬ɪv/ **(n)** (có tính) tích lũy

the drops of water that wear away the rock. The frog principle is telling us to watch the trends. Each day, we ask ourselves: “Where am I heading? Am I fitter, healthier, happier, more prosperous than I was last year?” If not, we need to change what we are doing. Here’s the scary thing – there’s no standing still. You’re either gaining or slipping.	Wear away **(ph.v)** làm mòn Prosperous /ˈprɑː.spər.əs/ **(adj)** thịnh vượng

Discipline



Have the discipline to do little things you don’t like, and you can spend your life doing the big things you do like.

Discipline is not everyone’s favorite word. In popularity, it probably slots somewhere between *dentist* and *diarrhoea*. But self-discipline makes all the difference. Life is a trade off between instant pleasure and long-term reward. Self-discipline in the little things – *studying instead of TV* – leads to a big thing – *better qualifications*. Self-discipline in the little things – *three sessions a week at the gym* – leads to a big thing – *a healthier life*. Self-discipline in the little things – *saving twenty dollars a day instead of blowing it on booze* – leads to a big thing – *your own apartment*. The key to self-discipline is not an iron will. It is knowing WHY you want something. If you really know ***why*** you want to get out of debt, it’s easier to save. If you’re clear about why you want to improve your qualifications, it’s easier to study. Something else about discipline: when you are self-disciplined, you don’t need to get discipline from anywhere else. As a result, you run your own life and people don’t tell you what to do. When you don’t have self-discipline, you get it from outside. People who can’t discipline themselves often slot into jobs where they take orders. People who have absolutely no self-discipline get themselves locked up!	Popularity /ˌpɑː.pjəˈler.ə.t̬i/ **(n)** sự yêu thích Slot /slɑːt/ **(v)** đặt vào Trade off /ˈtreɪd.ɑːf/ **(n)** trao đổi, đánh đổi Long-term /ˌlɑːŋˈtɜːrm/ **(adj)** dài hạn, lâu dài Qualification /ˌkwɑː.lə.fəˈkeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** trình độ, năng lực Booze /buːz/ **(n)** rượu Lock up **(ph.v)** giam giữ

Order (Trật tự)

The first law of expansion is “order”. For something to grow, it needs system. Look at a flower, cut an orange, check out the symmetry of a tree or a beehive. There is discipline. Nature keeps what is essential and gets rid of the garbage. It’s called organization. If you want your business to grow, you must have method. If you want your life to blossom, you need some order in it. Fred says: *“My office is a mess, but it’s an organized mess. I’m actually very efficient!”* Oh really? I can just imagine Fred being wheeled into an operating theatre for brain surgery, to find the medical team standing amongst piles of needles, bandages and old bottles. The surgeon says: “Relax, Fred. It’s a mess in here but we’re in total control!” Wherever performance counts, there is organization. Firemen always know where to find their helmets, ambulance drivers have one spot for car keys! Nothing blooms out of a mess. Organize your filing cabinet. Clean up your garage. Something else you’ll notice. “As within, so without” – your environment reflects your thinking. Usually, when your house is a mess, so is your life.	Symmetry /ˈsɪm.ə.tri/ **(n)** sự đối xứng Beehive /ˈbiː.haɪv/ **(n)** tổ ong Essential /ɪˈsen.ʃəl/ **(adj)** cần thiết, cốt yếu Get rid of **(ph.v)** loại bỏ Wheel /wiːl/ **(v)** đẩy (bằng vật có bánh xe) Needle /ˈniː.dəl/ **(n)** kim tiêm Bandage /ˈbæn.dɪdʒ/ **(n)** băng Surgeon /ˈsɜː.dʒən/ **(n)** bác sĩ phẫu thuật Performance /pərˈfɔːr.məns/ **(n)** hiệu suất Helmet /ˈhel.mət/ **(n)** mũ bảo hộ Filing cabinet /ˈfaɪ.lɪŋ ˌkæb.ɪ.nət/ **(n)** tủ đựng hồ sơ, tài liệu As within, so without - trong thế nào, ngoài thế ấy



No effort is wasted
(Không nỗ lực nào là vô ích)

Take a block of ice that’s been frozen to minus fifty	Minus /ˈmaɪ.nəs/ **(adj)** âm

degrees centigrade, and start heating it. For some time, nothing happens. Lots of energy for no visible result. Suddenly, at zero, it melts. Water! Keep heating. Again, lots of energy and no excitement. Then, at around one hundred degrees centigrade, bubbles and steam! It boils! The principle? It's possible to put lots of energy into something – e.g. a block of ice, a project, a career – yet it seems like nothing is happening. Actually, your energy is already producing change, but you just can't see it. Continue to put the energy in and you will surely see a transformation. Remember the principle, and you don't panic so much – and you don't despair. I like to picture my life as a pinball game. Every time I make any effort – tidy my desk, write a book, help a friend, practise drawing, pay a bill, try and fail – I'm scoring points. I think of all my efforts as adding to my "universal credit". I never know how many points I'll need for my next reward. It helps me enjoy what I'm doing rather than demand instant results. And every so often, usually when I least expect it, "Bingo!" – a new opportunity, an invitation, a cheque in the mail.	Visible /ˈbiː.haɪv/ **(adj)** có thể nhìn thấy Melt /melt/ **(v)** tan Bubble /ˈbʌb.əl/ **(n)** bong bóng Steam /stiːm/ **(n)** hơi nước Panic /ˈpæn.ɪk/ **(v)** hoảng loạn, hoang mang Despair /dɪˈsper/ **(v)** thất vọng, tuyệt vọng Pinball game /ˈpɪn.bɑːl/ **(n)** trò chơi bắn đạn Credit /ˈkred.ɪt/ **(v)** tiền / công trạng Demand /dɪˈmænd/ **(v)** đòi hỏi, yêu cầu

Waves

Life happens in waves. We know about sound waves, light waves, brain waves, microwaves. In non-scientific terms, waves demonstrate that *things have a tendency to travel in bunches*. This means family crises, wedding invitations and car repairs also tend to travel in bunches. Bearing this in mind is helpful. When you strike a month without bills, you say to your-self: *"I'll put something aside for the next wave."* When you get swamped by the next wave, you say to yourself: *"I know about these waves – this is only temporary."*	Term /tɜːrm/ **(n)** thuật ngữ Demonstrate /ˈdem.ən.streɪt/ **(v)** chỉ ra, cho thấy Tendency /ˈten.dən.si/ **(n)** xu hướng Bunch /bʌntʃ/ **(n)** chùm Put STh aside **(ph.v)** để dành Swamp /swɑːmp/ **(v)** làm ngập, bị tràn ngập



Be adaptable!

(Hãy trở nên biết thích nghi!)

We live in a world where things are always changing. The seasons come and go, the tide comes in and out, inflation goes up and down, people get hired and fired... You would think we would learn that the underlying law of the universe is change! Instead we get angry.

In high school biology, we study the law of *natural selection* – adapting to change. We learn, for example, that if you are a green bug in a brown field, and you don't change the color of your skin, you are in big trouble. You can argue: "The field should be green – it used to be green..." But very soon, no more bug. The law is brutal – "ADAPT or DISAPPEAR!" It's a shame more biology teachers never said: "TAKE NOTE – THIS IS A LESSON OF LIFE – BE ADAPTABLE."

In the corporate world, things change, and even the experts can get it wrong.

In 1927, Harry Warner of Warner Brothers Pictures said: *"Who the hell wants to hear actors talk?"*

In 1943, Thomas Watson, chairman of IBM said: *"I think there is a world market for about five computers."*

In 1977, Ken Olsen, president of Digital Equipment Corporation said: *"There is no reason for any individual to have a computer in their home."*

What is true today, may not be true tomorrow. What works today, may not work tomorrow. The only constant we have is change. If you leave home for three months, you'll find your kids have changed. Suddenly your baby is calling you "Daddy!" It's not a question of fair or unfair. Everything is moving.

Inflation /ɪnˈfleɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự lạm phát

Underlying /ˌʌn.dərˈlaɪ.ɪŋ/ **(adj)** cơ bản, cơ sở

Selection /səˈlek.ʃən/ **(n)** sự chọn lọc

Adapt /əˈdæpt/ **(v)** thích nghi, thích ứng

Adaptable /əˈdæp.tə.bəl/ **(adj)** có thể thích nghi, biết thích nghi

Brutal /ˈbruː.ţəl/ **(adj)** tàn bạo, khắc nghiệt

Corporate /ˈkɔːr.pər.ət/ **(adj)** (thuộc) doanh nghiệp, công ty

Corporation /ˌkɔːr.pəˈreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** tập đoàn

Individual /ˌɪn.dəˈvɪdʒ.u.əl/ **(n)** cá nhân

IN A NUTSHELL

Happy people don't just accept change, they embrace it. They are the people who say: ***"Why would I want my next five years to be like my last five?"***

Embrace /ɪmˈbreɪs/ **(v)** nắm lấy (thời cơ), ôm lấy

3

YOUR LIFE IS A PERFECT REFLECTION OF YOUR BELIEFS.

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When you change your deepest beliefs about the world, your life changes accordingly.

BELIEFS

MY JOB IS THE PROBLEM!

MAKING MONEY

SPOIL YOURSELF!

IT'S NOT WHAT HAPPENS TO YOU…



Beliefs

"The thing always happens that you believe in; and the belief in a thing makes it happen." - *Frank Lloyd Wright*

When people argue for their limitations they say: "I can't do 'X' because..." The common excuse is: *"It's just the way I AM."* More likely the truth is: *"It's just the way I THINK I AM."* We can learn about our beliefs by studying fish. (The following experiment was conducted at the Woods Hole	Limitation /ˌlɪm.əˈteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự hạn chế Oceanographic /ˌoʊ.ʃən.əˈgræf.ɪk/ **(adj)** thuộc hải dương học

Oceanographic Institute). Get yourself an aquarium. Divide it in half with a clear glass wall, so now you have a kind of fish "duplex". Now find yourself a barracuda – we'll call him Barry – and a mullet. (Barracuda eats mullet.) Put one fish on each side. In a flash, Barry will head for the mullet and... thump... hit the glass wall at full throttle. He'll turn around and come back for another shot... thump! Over a period of weeks, Barry will get a very sore nose. Eventually he'll figure that mullet hunting equals pain, and quit chasing the mullet. You can then remove the glass wall, and guess what! He will stay on his side of the tank for the rest of his life. Barry will happily starve to death, with the mullet swimming just inches away. He knows his limits, and he won't step outside them. Is Barry's a pitiful tale? It is actually the story of every human being. We don't run into glass plates – we run into teachers, parents and friends who tell us where we fit and what we can do. Worst of all, we run into our own beliefs. Our beliefs define our territory, we argue for it and we won't step outside it. Barry the Barracuda says: "I gave it my best shot once – so now I just swim in circles." We say: "I gave my studies / my marriage / my job my best shot once before..." We create our own glass cage, and we think it is reality. Actually, it's just what we believe. And how attached are people to their beliefs? Just try talking religion or politics at a dinner party!	Institute /ˈɪn.stə.tuːt/ **(n)** viện, học viện Aquarium /əˈkwer.i.əm/ **(n)** bể, hồ nuôi cá Duplex /ˈduː.pleks/ **(n)** nhà đôi Barracuda /ˌber.əˈkuː.də/ **(n)** cá nhồng Mullet /ˈmʌl.ɪt/ **(n)** cá đối At full throttle /ˈθrɑː.ţəl/ với tốc độ tối đa Starve /stɑːrv/ **(v)** đói Starve to death - đói đến chết Pitiful /ˈpɪţ.i.fəl/ **(adj)** đáng thương Tale /teɪl/ **(n)** câu chuyện Territory /ˈter.ə.tɔːr.i/ **(n)** phạm vi, lãnh thổ Cage /keɪdʒ/ **(n)** lồng Reality /riˈæl.ə.ţi/ **(n)** thực, thực tế Attached /əˈtætʃt/ **(adj)** gắn bó, trói buộc Politics /ˈpɑː.lə.tɪks/ **(n)** chính trị

But I know I'm right!
(Nhưng tôi biết tôi đúng!)

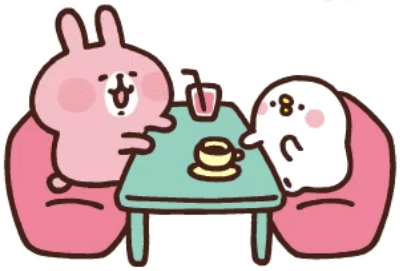


Isn't it funny? We all believe something slightly different about the world – and we all *know* that what we believe is right.	Flexible /ˈflek.sə.bəl/ **(adj)** linh hoạt, linh động

Why? Because we *are* right! Fred believes that life is tough and that he has to work seventy hours a week to survive. Looking through the employment section in the newspaper, he sees a position advertised in the next suburb... *"flexible hours, exciting travel opportunities, company car, top salary."* Fred says: "Too good to be true – there must be a catch!" Fred keeps looking. He spots another ad, and this time the job is a two hour drive across town. *"No car, long hours, low pay."* Fred says: "This is worth a closer look!" He attends an interview. The boss says: "Our products are revolting, our customers hate us, the owner is a crook. If you want to work here you're crazy!" And Fred says: "When can I start?" Fred proves that his theory about life is correct – he is miserable, but at least he is happy that he is miserable. While we are growing up, teachers, parents and friends tell us things like: "You're hopeless at mathematics, you sing like a duck and you can't draw to save yourself." They say: "Life is tough, you'll always be broke, blame the government... *That's your script. Go live it!"* And we go and act it out, almost like we're in a play. We believe it, even if it ruins our life. Suggest to Fred that he might want to "unbelieve" something he has accepted for forty years and he will probably get very upset: "I've been miserable for forty years with this belief system. You want me to give it up now, and admit I helped create this mess?" Most of us would rather be right than happy.	Opportunity /ˌɑː.pərˈtuː.nə.ţi/ **(n)** cơ hội Catch /kætʃ/ **(n)** một vấn đề hoặc bất lợi khó thấy Revolt /rɪˈvoʊlt/ **(v)** làm ghê tởm, làm chán ghét Crook /krʊk/ **(n)** kẻ gian dối, kẻ lừa đảo Theory /ˈθɪr.i/ **(n)** thuyết, lý thuyết Blame /bleɪm/ **(v)** đổ lỗi

What's my story?

(Câu chuyện của tôi là gì?)



Most of us have a "story". We label ourselves... "I'm a school teacher", "I'm a grandmother", "I'm a new age guy". Our "story" is like a software program, lodged between our ears and controlling our life. It's our personal marketing	Lodge /lɑːdʒ/ **(v)** đặt vào, mắc kẹt

package. We take it to work, we take it on vacation. At parties we drag it out... “I’m a divorcee.” “I was an abused child.” “I’m on the spiritual path!” We spend our lives trying to fit the story. We buy our cars and clothes, and choose our friends to fit the story. Jim is a doctor. He tells himself: “I have to act like doctors act and talk like doctors talk. I need a house in a doctor’s kind of street and I need a doctor’s kind of hobby.” He has his role all figured out, but poor Jim is as dull as a dog biscuit. Trying to fit a “story” makes us miserable. If my story is “I’m a school teacher”, when I lose my job, I don’t know what I am. If my story is “I’m the perfect hostess”, I set myself up for misery because no evening is perfect. When the neighbors come for dinner, and I burn the carrots, I’m devastated. Here’s the crunch... YOU ARE NOT YOUR STORY AND NOBODY CARES ANYWAY. You don’t belong in a category or a box. You are a human being having a *series of experiences*. When you quit dragging a story around, you never have to “look the part”. As I write this, I’m thinking of my Swedish friends, Anna and Per-Erik. Somewhere in their late seventies or early eighties, they still travel the world. Per-Erik rollerblades on his grandson’s skates and surfs the Internet. Anna loves to dance until four in the morning. They don’t seem to have “a story” – they have spirit.	Drag (out) /dræg/ **(v)** lôi (ra) Divorcee /dəˌvɔːrˈseɪ/ **(n)** người đã ly dị (và chưa kết hôn lại) Abused /əˈbjuːzd/ **(adj)** bị bạo hành / lạm dụng Dull /dʌl/ **(adj)** chán ngắt Hostess /ˈhoʊ.stɪs/ **(n)** bà chủ nhà, bà chủ tiệc The crunch /krʌntʃ/ **(n)** điểm quan trọng Swedish /ˈswiː.dɪʃ/ **(adj)** (thuộc) Thụy Điển Rollerblade /ˈroʊ.lər.bleɪd/ **(v)** trượt patin Skate /skeɪt/ **(n)** giày trượt Spirit /ˈspɪr.ət/ **(n)** tinh thần, sự hăng hái
Do you recognize the following *stories*? “I’M A VERY IMPORTANT PERSON – PEOPLE SHOULD TREAT ME ACCORDINGLY!” Some people insist that everyone else should recognize them, know how rich they are and how many degrees they’ve got. While you demand that other people think you’re important, you suffer because your happiness is in their hands. Forget about “being important” – it’s too stressful. The minute you don’t have to “be important”, you can relax. The less you demand appreciation from others, the more you get. “I’M THE SORT OF PERSON WHO NEVER... (travels first class, goes skinny dipping, goes to the theatre, wears dinner suits, eats sashimi).” When we tell ourselves “I	Suffer /ˈsʌf.ər/ **(v)** đau khổ, chịu khổ Appreciation /əˌpriː.ʃiˈeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự đánh giá cao First class /ˌfɜːrst ˈklæs/ **(adv)** bằng vé hạng nhất Skinny dipping /ˈskɪn.iˌdɪp.ɪŋ/ **(n)** việc bơi khỏa thân

never" or "I always" it keeps us in the box, but it's only our *story* talking. We have other stories, like "I'm very sensitive – things upset me." "I'm a real man." "I'm a Sagittarian so I always..."

"I'M TOO OLD TO..." My mother started to write her first book when she was sixty-seven. She died at sixty-eight, and never finished the book. But she made a start, and was happier for it. There's only one way to go, and that is to be learning, and loving what you do, right up to the last minute. If you have a book half written, or a house or a business half built, and you get hit by a bus, are you going to worry?

Sashimi /sæʃˈiː.mi/ **(n)** món cá sống ăn với nước tương của Nhật

Sensitive /ˈsen.sə.ţɪv/ **(adj)** nhạy cảm

Sagittarian /ˌsædʒ.əˈter.i.ən/ **(n)** người cung Nhân Mã

IN A NUTSHELL

Ask yourself: "What would I do if I had no story?"



SO WHICH OF MY BELIEFS SHOULD I REJECT?

Any beliefs that keep you poor and miserable! If your beliefs don't help you, scrap them! It's not to say they are wrong – they just cause you pain. For a start, beware of beliefs with "should" in them:

People SHOULD return favors!

People SHOULD praise me! If I do a good job, my husband ought to notice.

People SHOULD love me back!

People SHOULD be more considerate!

People SHOULD be grateful!

This *"should list"* might seem a reasonable set of expectations. But what if you didn't hold any of these beliefs? What if people didn't *have* to agree with you, return favors, notice your good work, love you back? How would that affect your life? You wouldn't get any less respect or appreciation. But when people didn't do these things, you would still be happy.

"Should" beliefs don't help us because reality doesn't

Scrap /skræp/ **(v)** bỏ đi, loại ra

Beware /bɪˈwer/ **(v)** coi chừng, chú ý đến

Favor /ˈfeɪ.vər/ **(n)** ân huệ (return favor - trả ơn)

Praise /preɪz/ **(v)** khen ngợi, tán dương

Considerate /kənˈsɪd.ər.ət/ **(adj)** chu đáo, ý tứ

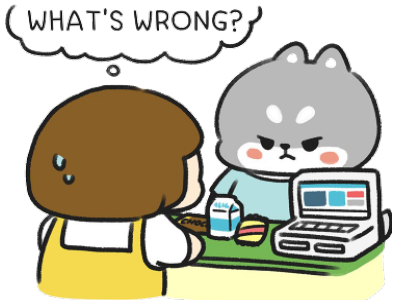
Reasonable /ˈriː.zən.ə.bəl/ **(adj)** hợp lý

Expectation /ˈskɪn.iˌdɪp.ɪŋ/ **(n)** kỳ vọng, niềm mong đợi

Criticize /ˈkrɪţ.ɪ.saɪz/ **(v)** phê bình, chỉ trích

understand “should”. Things are the way they are. When you criticize reality, reality wins.	
YOUR BELIEFS DETERMINE YOUR QUALITY OF LIFE For example: Let’s say you believe that fathers should praise their children and give them lots of presents. Whenever yours doesn’t do it, you are upset. So you want to *change Father*. Most people never consider the alternative solution: *change beliefs.* You say: *“But doesn’t everyone believe these things?”* No! Some people don’t, and they are happier because of it. Some people don’t *expect* others to behave in any particular fashion. As a result, they have more peace of mind. To see things differently, you don’t need willpower, self-confidence, or brain surgery. You just need the courage to think the unfamiliar. Next time you are upset, remember it’s not so much people who make you angry, as your beliefs. Whatever thoughts are causing you pain, they are only thoughts. You can change a thought.	Alternative /ɑːlˈtɜːr.nə.ţɪv/ **(adj)** khác, thay thế Fashion /ˈfæʃ.ən/ **(n)** kiểu, kiểu cách Willpower /ˈwɪl.paʊ.ər/ **(n)** nghị lực, ý chí Unfamiliar /ʌn.fəˈmɪl.i.jər/ **(adj)** => The unfamiliar **(n)** điều khác biệt, không quen thuộc

My job is the problem!



When we blame our job, it’s usually we who are the problem. Let’s say your work is a drag, and you have a matching belief that says *“Work is a drag”*. If you apply for a job that could be enjoyable, what will happen? Either (a) you won’t get the job because they’ll see that you are no fun, or (b) you’ll get the job and you’ll manage to make it boring. Let’s say you believe the opposite, that *“Work is fun”*. If you are in a dead-end-dull job, there will be a point at which you will say: “This is degrading to my spirit and contrary to everything I believe in. I cannot stay here another day.” Your most basic beliefs will drive you to find something better,	Drag /dræg/ **(n)** điều đáng chán, khó chịu Dead-end-dull job - công việc chán ngắt không có cơ hội thăng tiến Degrading /dɪˈgreɪdɪŋ/ **(v)** làm người ta cảm thấy giảm giá trị Contrary (to) /ˈkɑːn.treːri/ **(prep)** trái với, trái ngược với

however you do it. It's not the job, it's what you *believe* that makes the difference.	

Making money

But I don't make enough money!

Mary says: "You don't understand. *It's not my belief system. It's my job*. I don't make enough at my job." Well Mary, why are you working there? Mary says: "It's all I can do!" (Fine Mary, if that's what you *believe*). Change what you *believe*, and you'll get a new job or start a part-time business, rearrange your finances, develop more skills, work for a promotion. Mary says: "But times are bad. It says so in the newspaper." That's what you *believe*, Mary. What would happen if you didn't believe the newspaper? Prosperity involves you running your own mind – regardless of what your neighbors and the papers say.	Rearrange /ˌriː.əˈreɪndʒ/ **(v)** sắp xếp lại Prosperity /prɑːˈsper.ə.t̬i/ **(n)** sự thịnh vượng, sự thành công Regardless /rɪˈgɑːrd.ləs/ **(adv)** bất chấp, không đếm xỉa tới

But I'm on a fixed salary…

(Nhưng tôi đang hưởng một mức lương cố định…)

Whether or not you are on a salary, your beliefs determine your prosperity. Take eight people in the same company, on the same wage. We would find some with assets and living well, and some who need a bank loan to buy a sandwich. The difference – not the money they make but what they believe about money. If I haven't got the money I want, or if I'm losing it, there's a reason for it – and it's not in the outside world, it is in my inside world. Lottery winners are a stunning illustration of how belief systems control prosperity. People think money will fix their problems. Yet most people who win lotteries are deeper in debt two years after their windfall, than they were before they got the cheque. Why? Because a belief system which says, "I'm always broke", will soon erase a million dollars. Recently in Brisbane, Australia, I flicked on the TV to	Wage /weɪdʒ/ **(n)** tiền lương Assets /ˈæs.ets/ **(n)** tài sản, của cải (thường ở số nhiều) Stunning /ˈstʌn.ɪŋ/ **(adj)** đáng kinh ngạc, tuyệt vời Illustration /ˌɪl.əˈstreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) minh họa Windfall /ˈwɪnd.fɑːl/ **(n)** vận may bất ngờ, khoản tiền trên trời rơi xuống Flick /flɪk/ **(v)** bật, búng

see where a fellow had just won his second lottery. In the interview he said: “The 1.3 million will be very handy because I’m living on welfare at the moment...” And the guy won a lottery two years ago! Your bank balance will always match your belief system. When your self-image doesn’t fit your bank balance, it’s easier to change your bank balance. Again, it’s our thoughts which control our lives, not externals.	Welfare /ˈwel.fer/ **(n)** trợ cấp Balance /ˈbæl.əns/ **(n)** số dư (còn trong tài khoản) Externals /ɪkˈstɜːr.nəlz/ **(n)** bên ngoài, môi trường xung quanh (thường ở số nhiều)

The advantages of being broke

(Những lợi thế của việc bị túng thiếu)



People who wonder why they are broke, never ask the obvious question: “What do I like about being broke?” There are advantages to being broke. For example: ● “I can feel holy... God will love me – blessed are the poor.” ● “I can stay one of the gang. If I remain poor, I won’t feel guilty around my friends.” ● “I’ll get sympathy.” ● “I don’t have to discipline myself.” ● “I don’t have to change any habits.” ● And best of all... “I can *blame* other people – and the government!” If we are honest, we might concede that being broke suits us. Not many people admit to choosing poverty, but it’s quite a persuasive list isn’t it? Everything we do has a payoff, including “doing poverty”.	Holy /ˈhoʊ.li/ **(adj)** thánh thiện, thần thánh I can stay one of the gang - tôi có thể vẫn là một kẻ trong đám (nghèo túng) đó Sympathy /ˈsɪm.pə.θi/ **(n)** (sự) đồng cảm Concede /kənˈsiːd/ **(v)** thừa nhận Poverty /ˈpɑː.vər.ţi/ **(n)** sự nghèo túng Persuasive /pərˈsweɪ.sɪv/ **(adj)** có sức thuyết phục Payoff /ˈpeɪ.ɑːf/ **(n)** thành quả, lợi ích

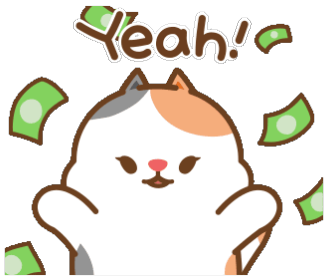
Our parents’ money beliefs

(Những niềm tin về tiền bạc của cha mẹ chúng ta)

Did your parents often say things like: ● “Money is easy to make.” ● “We always have more than enough.” ● “Whenever we spend it, more comes.” Or did they usually say things like: ● “Money is the root of all evil.” ● “We can’t afford it.” ● “Money doesn’t grow on trees.” If you are better acquainted with the second list, your parents’ belief system probably became your reality. Their struggle became your struggle.	Evil /ˈiː.vəl/ **(n)** điều ác, việc xấu, tai họa We can’t afford it - chúng ta không thể kiếm đủ tiền Acquainted /əˈkweɪn.ʈɪd/ **(adj)** quen, quen thuộc (với cái gì) Struggle /ˈstrʌg.əl/ **(n)** sự đấu tranh, sự vật lộn

Get comfortable with money!

Most people are more embarrassed about money than sex.



Have you ever noticed how hard it is to give some people money. They go crazy! “No, it’s OK, really. I don’t need it.” You know they are living on bread and water! They change personality! They get embarrassed. They get insulted! “I don’t need your money – I’m fine.” Some of us have trouble even talking about money! We lend a friend a week’s wages and when we need it back, we don’t know how to ask for it: “Ah, you know that... do you remember... well... this isn’t really important, and I don’t really need it... and it doesn’t matter if... how can I put this... I was just wondering about the...” Instead of asking in a sensible manner: “Can you return my money?” If you are uneasy in a job, or uneasy in a relationship, sooner or later you will part company. If you are uneasy with money – if you are nervous about even talking about it, if money doesn’t sit well with you – you will also part company. It’s not so much a conscious thing, its a subconscious thing. Things we are awkward with, we avoid.	Personality /ˌpɜːrsənˈæləʈi/ **(n)** tính cách Insult /ɪnˈsʌlt/ **(v)** sỉ nhục, xúc phạm Sensible /ˈsen.sə.bəl/ **(adj)** hợp lý Manner /ˈmæn.ər/ **(n)** cách, kiểu Part company - cắt đứt quan hệ, rời đi (công việc, người yêu) Conscious /ˈkɑːn.ʃəs/ **(adj)** (thuộc) ý thức Subconscious /ˌsʌbˈkɑːn.ʃəs/ **(adj)** (thuộc) tiềm thức

	Awkward /ˈɑː.kwərd/ **(n)** ngượng, xấu hổ, khó xử

IN A NUTSHELL

In order to have something in your life, and keep it, you have to be comfortable with it. TO MAKE MONEY – AND KEEP IT, YOU MUST BE COMFORTABLE WITH MONEY!

If you have plenty, others will go without

(Nếu bạn có nhiều (tiền), những người khác sẽ không có gì)

This is the silliest belief of all. How many of us grew up believing: "If I'm prosperous, other people will suffer." You know who spreads that idea? The people who don't have it! If Santa Claus strolled into your lounge room and dropped a million dollars cash on your coffee table, would it stay there? No! Unless you stuff it under your pillow, you can bet the car dealer will see some of it, your travel agent will see some of it, together with the local restaurants, florists, boutiques and probably the tax man – everyone around you will benefit. Yet many of us grow up believing it's not OK to be prosperous because it will deprive other people. That is nuts! If you get prosperous, it doesn't have to hurt other people. It can help them.	Stroll /stroʊl/ **(v)** đi dạo, tản bộ Lounge room /ˈlaʊndʒ ˌruːm/ **(n)** phòng khách (tiếng Anh Úc) Stuff /stʌf/ **(v)** nhét Bet /bet/ **(v)** đánh cược Florist /ˈflɔːr.ɪst/ **(n)** người bán hoa Boutique /buːˈtiːk/ **(n)** cửa hàng quần áo thời trang Deprive /dɪˈpraɪv/ **(v)** tước đoạt

Spoil yourself!

(Hãy chiều chuộng mình)

"It's a funny thing, life. If you refuse to accept anything but the best, you very often get it." *– W. Somerset Maugham*



For the world to treat you well, you have to treat yourself well. How can you feel like a mover and shaker when you have holes in your underwear? Fred says: "It doesn't matter if I have holes in my shorts because no one	Treat /triːt/ **(v)** đối xử Mover and shaker /ˈmu·vər ən ˈʃeɪ·kər/ **(n)** người có sức ảnh hưởng

can see them." But here's the crunch, Fred. You know it and your body can feel it. You are the only one who can make you feel special. If you have no pride, nobody can give it to you. Our home affects the way we feel. Create a space which will uplift you when you walk in the front door. Give your home your personality. Do a deal with your landlord – get him to supply materials and you paint the apartment. Neatness costs nothing. Better to live in a one-room apartment that is clean, than in a mansion that's a mess. A lady asked my wife Julie: "What can I do with a decorating budget of twenty dollars?" Julie said: "Buy a broom!"	Uplift /ˈʌp.lɪft/ **(v)** nâng lên (tinh thần) Landlord /ˈlænd.lɔːrd/ **(n)** chủ nhà Neatness /ˈniːt.nəs/ **(n)** sự gọn gàng, ngăn nắp Mansion /ˈmæn.ʃən/ **(n)** biệt thự
ENJOY WHAT YOU HAVE How many of us display our apples and bananas in scratchy old plastic bowls, while our beautiful dishes remain locked in the cupboard? Then we die and leave all the crystal to our kids, so they can smash it! I say, if you have something beautiful, smash it yourself! I know a fellow who wanted to preserve the resale value of his brand new Volvo, so he had a set of seat covers made out of old bed sheets. Very practical, except you feel like you're riding in a laundry basket! I learn a lot from Julie about this. Her philosophy is: "Pamper yourself, nourish your body, keep a clean home and you'll feel blessed by life." To quote her: *"Everything affects everything else. The way you walk affects the way you talk. The way you dress affects the way you feel. The care you give to yourself, you will also give to others."* She's the only person I know with shoulder pads in her pyjamas! And they are silk pyjamas. Spoil yourself a little. You say: "What does nurturing myself have to do with achieving my goals in life?" Everything! If we feel prosperous, we attract prosperity. Fred says: "When I get successful, I'll quit living like a rat!" Wrong! To be a success you have to begin to live it, you have to feel it now.	Scratchy /ˈskrætʃ.i/ **(adj)** (bị) xước, trầy xước Crystal /ˈkrɪs.təl/ **(n)** đồ pha lê Smash /smæʃ/ **(v)** phá, đập vỡ Preserve /prɪˈzɜːrv/ **(v)** giữ, bảo tồn, duy trì Resale /ˈriːˌseɪl/ **(n)** (sự) bán lại Practical /ˈpræk.tɪ.kəl/ **(adj)** thực tế, thiết thực Laundry basket /ˈlɑːn.driˌbæs.kɪt/ **(n)** giỏ đựng quần áo bẩn Philosophy /fɪˈlɑː.sə.fi/ **(n)** triết lý sống Pamper /ˈpæm.pər/ **(v)** nuông chiều Nourish /ˈnɜːr.ɪʃ/ **(n)** nuôi dưỡng Shoulder pad /ˈʃoʊl.dərˌpæd/ **(n)** miếng đệm cầu vai

IN A NUTSHELL

Prosperity is not necessarily a money thing. It is a lifestyle thing.

It's not what happens to you, it's how you see it

(Không phải là cái gì xảy ra với bạn, mà là cách bạn nhìn nó)

According to legend, the "alchemists" of the Middle Ages were the people who turned lead into gold – nice work if you can get it! In one sense, we all need to be alchemists: to see beyond surface appearances. Our daily challenge is to take situations which seem unfortunate – missed planes, car accidents, divorces, rude waiters – and transform those situations into lucky breaks.

Does this mean you should pray for a broken leg? No, but if you get one, find some opportunity within the "disaster".

You ask: "What good does this do me?"

It helps on several levels:

- You are more thankful for what life deals you
- You are more peaceful
- You are now riding on the bus of life instead of trying to push it!

The cynic says: "That is being naive. I don't want to be a Pollyanna." Wrong. As you cease to react in horror to the unexpected, you become more balanced and you move into a position of power.

Alchemist /ˈæl.kə.mɪst/ **(n)** nhà giả kim

Middle Ages /ˈmɪd.əl ˌeɪ.dʒɪz/ **(n)** thời trung cổ

Lead /led/ **(n)** chì

Unfortunate /ʌnˈfɔːr.tʃən.ət/ **(adj)** không may, bất hạnh

Cynic /ˈsɪn.ɪk/ **(n)** người hoài nghi

Pollyanna /ˌpɑː.liˈæn.ə/ **(n)** người lúc nào cũng lạc quan (tên một nhân vật nữ)

Cease /siːs/ **(v)** ngừng, không còn

Horror /ˈhɔːr.ər/ **(n)** (sự) kinh hoàng, khiếp sợ

AS LONG AS YOU BELIEVE SOMETHING IN YOUR LIFE IS A DISASTER, IT WILL UNFOLD AS A CONTINUING DISASTER.

Let's say you are recently divorced and you figure your life is in ruins. As long as you believe that, it will be so. Let's say you get fired at fifty and decide your best years are over. As long as you believe that, it will be so.

Am I saying that while your attitude is negative, you will do nothing to improve your life? Partly, but there's *more* to it. As long as you see only disaster, you will attract more

Partly /ˈpræk.tɪ.kəl/ **(adv)** phần nào, một phần

Hassle /ˈhæs.əl/ **(v)** làm phiền, làm bực mình

Evict /ɪˈvɪkt/ **(v)** đuổi (khỏi nhà ở)

Downward /ˈdaʊn.wərd/ **(adj)** đi xuống

disaster. Lovers will let you down, bosses will hassle you, accidents will find you, landlords will evict you and it will be a downward spiral. EVENTS WILL UNFOLD ACCORDING TO YOUR EXPECTATIONS. The minute you change your ***beliefs*** about the situation, your different thoughts will attract *different people and new opportunities*.	Spiral /ˈspaɪr.əl/ **(n)** đường xoắn ốc

IN A NUTSHELL

EVERY "DISASTER" IN YOUR LIFE IS NOT SO MUCH A DISASTER, AS A SITUATION WAITING FOR YOU TO CHANGE YOUR MIND ABOUT IT.

You say: "But does this apply to MY illness, MY bills and MY drunken husband?" You bet it does.

Life shouldn't be this much fun!

(Cuộc sống không nên vui vẻ như thế này!)

I had a woman say to me: "I've never done anything I wanted to all my life." It was as if she was saying: "I've sacrificed – I'm a martyr." I thought: "How sad!" Life is supposed to be fun! Birds wake up singing every day. Babies laugh for no reason at all. Watch dolphins. Watch dogs in the surf. Who said life is no fun? This is a playful universe. If you inherited the idea that life isn't meant to be fun, understand what that means. It's just a belief which you can *"unbelieve"*. Take time out to do things just because they're fun. Working yourself to the bone confirms the idea that "life is a struggle". Be patient with yourself. Even enjoying life takes practice. When life is sweet, and that little voice says: *"It can't last!"* Tell yourself: *"Maybe it's about to get better!"*	Sacrifice /ˈsæk.rə.faɪs/ **(v)** hy sinh Martyr /ˈmɑːr.ţər/ **(n)** (nghĩa gốc) người tử vì đạo, hi sinh vì nghĩa; (nghĩa châm biếm) người cố gắng kiếm sự cảm thông của người khác bằng cách than rằng cuộc sống của họ khổ thế nào, dù chính họ chọn như vậy Surf /sɜːrf/ **(n)** nước bọt trắng do sóng vỗ vào bờ Inherit /ɪnˈher.ɪt/ **(v)** thừa hưởng, thừa kế



4

THE MOMENT YOU GET TOO ATTACHED TO THINGS, PEOPLE, MONEY… YOU SCREW IT UP!

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The challenge of life is to appreciate everything and attach yourself to nothing.

ATTACHMENT

ATTACHMENT TO MONEY

GIVING

ATTACHMENT TO LOVERS



Attachment

(Ràng buộc)

When you chase things, they run away. This is true for animals, lovers... even money! Have you ever met someone cute at a party and they tell you “I’ll call you next week!” So you don’t go anywhere for a week – not even to the bathroom! You sit by the phone... and wait. Who calls? Everyone but them! Did you ever need to sell something, desperately? A	Desperately /ˈdes.pər.ət.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) tuyệt vọng Desperate /ˈdes.pər.ət/ **(adj)** tuyệt vọng

car, a house. Who wanted it? Nobody. So you dropped the price. Who cared? Nobody! The principle? When you're desperate, zilch!

Talk to any salesperson, whether they're in Lear jets or laundry detergent, and they will tell you the same story. Desperation pulls you into a descending spiral – and the more you worry, the less people buy! What happens when you are in a restaurant and in a hurry for your meal? They lose your order.

I learn about the law of attachment in airports. I have made dozens of author tours in different parts of the world. These trips are usually excursions from six weeks to four months. Until recently, my wife Julie ran her own business, and so I mostly went alone.

I found that I could catch a hundred flights, and ninety-nine would be roughly on time. But the one flight home, when I was so desperate to see her and counting the minutes, was always four hours late!

At the end of my last North American book tour, we decided to meet in San Francisco. Julie arrived in San Francisco from Australia while I was still in Portland. I was so used to these delayed departures, that I went up to the baggage counter and asked: "How late is the six o'clock to San Francisco?" And the fellow said: "It's not late!"

"Not late?" I was ecstatic. I was about to leap across the counter and hug him when he said: "Do you want to know why it's not late?... We've cancelled it!" At 10.30 pm I got a seat on a plane to San Jose, caught a bus to San Francisco and arrived at Julie's hotel at four in the morning – seven hours late!

Whenever we are desperately involved – emotionally attached to a transaction or a happening, we obstruct it. The flip-side to the principle? Relax a little and *"Bingo!"*

You spend a year and a half without a girlfriend, or boyfriend, and you're desperate. Not even a sniff! Then you give up. You tell yourself: "I don't have to have a partner. I can be happy, single." And suddenly it's feast or famine – they're coming over the walls and out from under the bed!

An argument is the classic example. What happens when you want someone to change their mind? Will they change it? Not on your life. But stop pushing them and

Desperation /ˌdes.pəˈreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) tuyệt vọng

Zilch /zɪltʃ/ **(n)** chẳng có gì

Jet /dʒet/ **(n)** máy bay phản lực

Laundry detergent /ˈlɑːn.dri dɪˌtɜːr.dʒənt/ **(n)** bột giặt, chất tẩy giặt đồ

Descending /dɪˈsen.dɪŋ/ **(adj)** đi xuống

Excursion /kˈskɜːr.ʃən/ **(n)** cuộc du ngoạn, chuyến tham quan

Roughly /ˈrʌf.li/ **(adv)** xấp xỉ, gần như là

Departure /dɪˈpɑːr.tʃər/ **(n)** (sự) khởi hành, (chuyến) rời đi

Ecstatic /ekˈstæţ.ɪk/ **(adj)** ngây ngất, sung sướng

Attach /əˈtætʃ/ **(v)** trói buộc, ràng buộc

Transaction /trænˈzæk.ʃən/ **(n)** sự giao dịch, công việc kinh doanh

Obstruct /əbˈstrʌkt/ **(v)** cản trở, làm tắc nghẽn

Flip-side /ˈflɪp ˌsaɪd/ **(n)** mặt trái

Not even a sniff /snɪf/ **(n)** Không một chút khả năng

Feast /fiːst/ **(n)** bữa tiệc

Famine /ˈfæm.ɪn/ **(n)** nạn đói

often they come round to your way of thinking. Whenever you are desperate for anything – for someone to call, for your husband to quit smoking, for a promotion, for your boss to show you some appreciation – you create an energy around you which pushes it away.	Feast or famine - khi thì không có gì, khi thì quá là nhiều Classic /ˈklæs.ɪk/ **(adj)** kinh điển, điển hình



"…There's such a thing as trying too hard… You've got to sing like you don't need the money – Love like you'll never get hurt – You've got to dance like nobody's watching – It's got to come from the heart if you want it to work."

Detachment versus disinterest

(Không ràng buộc so với không quan tâm)

Detachment is not disinterest. It is possible to be detached and still be very determined. People who are detached and determined know that effort and excellence are ultimately rewarded. They say: "If I don't win this time, I'll win the next time, or the time after that." Let's say you apply for a new job at Haywire Hardware. You are excited about the job and you prepare carefully. You write out your interview speech and you practise it in front of the bathroom mirror. You even get new shoes and a haircut. You arrive early for the interview and you give it your best shot. What next? You go home and you get on with your life. You enrol in extra study. You plan your next job application. If you get hired by Haywire, you're happy. If not, you are still moving forward. Disinterested people say: "Who cares and why bother?" Desperate people say: "If I don't get this I'll die!"	Detachment /dɪˈtætʃ.mənt/ **(n)** (sự) tách biệt, vô tư, không ràng buộc Disinterest /dɪsˈɪn.ţər.est/ **(n)** (sự) không quan tâm, thờ ơ Detached /dɪˈtætʃt/ **(adj)** tách rời, không lệ thuộc Determined /dɪˈtɜːr.mɪnd/ **(adj)** kiên quyết Ultimately /ˈʌl.tə.mət.li/ **(adv)** cuối cùng, rốt cuộc Enrol /ɪnˈroʊl/ **(v)** ghi danh Job application /dʒɑːb ˌæp.ləˈkeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự xin việc, đơn xin việc

When you are determined and detached, you say: “One way or another, I will get a good job – and I don’t care how long it takes.”	

Attachment to money

(Ràng buộc với tiền bạc)



“The only people who think more about money than the rich are the poor.”
– Oscar Wilde

Attachment, which the Buddhists call “grasping”, explains why many people struggle to make money. Because money is both a means of survival and a symbol of success, most of us are very attached to it – even those of us who insist it doesn’t matter. Unfortunately, our desperation for it screws up the whole thing. Put another way, the more emotional you are about things, the less control you have. Most people are very emotional about money – so they are out of control. Detachment is a major reason why rich people get richer. They don’t care so much – they’re not desperate. If you don’t have money, you’ve got to be relaxed enough to know you’re going to get it. When you do have it, you need to be comfortable enough with it to keep some of it – and know there’s more coming. Also, there’s a big difference between a poor person’s attitude – *wishing* you had it – and a wealthy person’s approach – *believing* you’ll get it.	Buddhist /ˈbʊd.ɪst/ **(n)** Phật tử (tín đồ đạo Phật) Grasping /ˈgræs.pɪŋ/ **(n)** chấp trước Means /miːnz/ **(n)** phương tiện Screw up /skruː/ **(ph.v)** làm hỏng Wealthy /ˈwel.θi/ **(adj)** giàu có
HOW DO I AVOID BEING DESPERATE WHEN I’M DESPERATE? What do you do specifically? It’s attitude. Never get into the trap of saying: *“I need ‘X’ to be happy.”* In general, if you are selling your computer, waiting on a phone call, hoping for a promotion, trying to sink a golf putt, waiting for a cheque in the mail, looking for a husband, relax! You do *everything you can* to make it work, and then you tell yourself: “I don’t need this to be happy.” Forget it	Specifically /spəˈsɪf.ɪ.kəl.i/ **(adv)** (một cách) cụ thể Sink a goft putt - đánh vào lỗ đánh gôn

and move on, and more often than not, the results will come.	

IN A NUTSHELL

On the mental and the physical level, we are dealing with natural laws. Nature doesn't understand desperation! Nature seeks balance, and you can't be desperate and balanced. Life doesn't have to be an endless struggle. Let things flow. This is not indifference; it's not forcing things.

You can say: "I don't understand how it all works!" You don't have to understand gravity either. Our challenge is to work with principles – we don't have to understand them.

Mental /ˈmen.təl/ **(adj)** tinh thần

Physical /ˈfɪz.ɪ.kəl/ **(adj)** thể chất

Indifference /ɪnˈdɪf.ər.əns/ **(n)** sự thờ ơ, sự không quan tâm

Gravity /ˈgræv.ə.ţi/ **(n)** trọng lực



Giving

If you want something, give it away! Does that sound crazy? You get more of what you want, by giving away some of what you have. When a farmer wants more seeds, he takes his seeds and gives them to the earth. When you want a smile, you give yours. When you want affection, you give affection. When you help people, they help you. When you want a smack in the mouth? You smack someone. And if you want people to give you money? Share some of yours. Think about it. If attachment hinders the flow of good things into your life, then the opposite of that would be unattachment – to the point where we give away some of what we value. What you give away will tend to come back to you. I've had people tell me: "I've given all my life, and got nothing back." I don't think they were giving, I think they	Affection /əˈfek.ʃən/ **(n)** cảm giác yêu mến Smack /smæk/ **(n)** cái tát, cái vả, cái đập Hinder /ˈhɪn.dər/ **(v)** cản trở, gây trở ngại Value /ˈvæl.juː/ **(v)** coi trọng Measure /ˈmeʒ.ər/ **(v)** đo lường Miser /ˈmaɪ.zər/ **(n)** người hà tiện, bủn xỉn

were *measuring*, and there's a difference. WHAT ABOUT THOSE WEALTHY OLD MISERS WHO NEVER GAVE ANYBODY ANYTHING? How often do we hear this kind of story... "A penny-pinching old tightfist, who lived on bread crusts, dies with a million dollars parked under his bed?" It begs the question: "If you have to give in order to receive, what happened here?" The balance in your bank book is not the measure of your abundance. Abundance is what's circulating through your life. Prosperity is a flow – giving and receiving. If you have a fortune in Swiss deposits, and you're not using it, then it's not enriching you. Technically it's yours, but in reality you're "receiving" nothing from it. It's not making you abundant and it might as well belong to someone else. So the principle of give and receive holds, even here.	Penny-pinching /ˈpen.iˌpɪn.tʃɪŋ/ **(adj)** keo kiệt, bủn xỉn Tightfist /taɪt.fɪst/ (n) người keo kiệt Abundance /əˈbʌn.dəns/ **(n)** (sự) giàu có, sung túc Circulate /ˈsɜːr.kjə.leɪt/ **(v)** luân chuyển, tuần hoàn Fortune /ˈfɔːr.tʃuːn/ **(n)** gia tài, tài sản Deposit /dɪˈpɑː.zɪt/ **(n)** khoản tiền gửi Enrich /ɪnˈrɪtʃ/ **(v)** làm giàu

IN A NUTSHELL

The trick to giving is to give without wanting anything back. If you expect something back, you are attached to a result – and when you are attached, less happens.

And should you enjoy your material possessions? Of course! Just make sure you own them and they don't own you.

Material /məˈtɪr.i.əl/ **(adj)** vật chất

Possession /pəˈzeʃ.ən/ **(n)** của cải

Attachment to lovers

(Ràng buộc với người yêu)

"The origin of sorrow is desire." *– Buddha*



Mary is desperate for a man to love and adore her. Is there much hope of finding him? Not likely. Firstly, her desperation will push all the guys away. Secondly, while	Adore /əˈdɔːr/ **(n)** quý mến, yêu thiết tha

she's desperate, she's not so loveable. Fred says to his girl: "I need you – and I can't live without you." But that's not love, it's hunger. You can't need someone desperately and love them at the same time. (And if you literally can't live without someone, you're a basket case! Who needs that?) Loving people means giving them the freedom to be who they choose to be and where they choose to be. Love is allowing people to be in your life out of choice. Again, we're talking unattachment. To have something or someone, you let go.	Loveable /ˈlʌv.ə.bəl/ **(v)** đáng yêu, dễ thương Literally /ˈlɪt̬.ər.əl.i/ **(adv)** thực sự, đúng là, theo nghĩa đen Basket case /ˈbæs.kɪt ˌkeɪs/ **(n)** người quá căng thẳng và không quản lý được cuộc sống của mình

Attachment – and hating things…
(Ràng buộc – và ghét những cái gì đó…)

"We cannot change anything unless we accept it." *– Carl Jung*

Hating things is a bad idea. While you hate something, you remain invisibly connected to it – so it will tend to hang around. EXAMPLE: Let's say you are in debt and you hate it. That's a difficult position from which to improve your finances. You put so much energy into hating it, that you stay stuck – you're drained. Once you accept your debt, free of the emotional turmoil, you can move out of it. Acceptance does not mean "giving up" – it means understanding what is. EXAMPLE: Until you accept that you are overweight, you either: (a) deny you are fat, or (b) hate yourself for being fat. In either case, you stay fat. You only begin to lose weight once you accept you are fat. When the Bible says, "Resist not evil", it makes this point. Getting angry, or fighting doesn't work. You overcome what you don't like by accepting what is – not resisting – and replacing it with something positive.	Invisibly /ɪnˈvɪz.ə.bli/ **(adv)** (một cách) vô hình Hang around /hæŋ əˈraʊnd/ **(ph.v)** quanh quẩn, tồn tại xung quanh Drain /dreɪn/ **(v)** làm kiệt quệ, kiệt sức Turmoil /ˈtɜːr.mɔɪl/ **(n)** sự rối loạn, sự hỗn độn Bible /ˈbaɪ.bəl/ **(n)** Kinh thánh Resist not evil - đừng chống lại cái xấu

5

WHAT YOU FOCUS ON EXPANDS...

.

so think about what you want!

WHY THINK POSITIVE?

HOW POSITIVE THINKING SHAPES YOUR SUBCONSCIOUS

THOUGHT REAPS RESULTS



Why think positive?

(Tại sao phải suy nghĩ tích cực?)

Imagine you are sitting in a jumbo somewhere over Europe, and an engine falls off the wing. How would you want the pilot to react? Would you want your pilot saying: “Stay calm and buckle up! This will be bumpy but we’ll find a way home?”

Or would you want your captain running up and down the aisle yelling: “We’ll all be killed! We’ll all be killed?” Which fellow is more likely to get you down safely?

Now think about your everyday life in which you are your own pilot. Which approach is most likely to solve your problems: *“We’ll find a way”* or *“We’ll all be killed?”* This is the essence of positive thinking. It doesn’t offer guarantees, but it gives you your best chance.

Jumbo /ˈdʒʌm.boʊ/ **(n)** máy bay phản lực lớn

Buckle up /ˈbʌk.əl/ **(ph.v)** thắt dây an toàn

Bumpy /ˈbʌm.pi/ **(adj)** xóc, dằn xóc, xóc nảy

Aisle /aɪl/ **(n)** lối đi (giữa các dãy ghế)

Essence /ˈes.əns/ **(n)** bản chất

Losers focus on what's impossible until all they see is impossibility. Positive thinkers think about what's possible. In concentrating on the possibilities, they make things happen.	

How positive thinking shapes your subconscious

(Suy nghĩ tích cực định hình tiềm thức của bạn như thế nào)

Our subconscious mind is a collection of all our thoughts. Our most common thoughts have created our strongest subconscious behaviours.



To understand positive thinking better, we need a picture of the subconscious. Imagine your brain as split into a top half and a bottom half, much like a large walnut. The top half is your conscious mind, containing your passing thoughts. The bottom half is your subconscious. In your subconscious are the various programmes you were born with – like breathing and digestion – and programmes you've created – like walking and talking. Now, let's imagine you are learning to drive. Each time you approach a corner, you have a conscious thought in the "top" of your brain: "Lift the right leg, move it 12 cm to the left, and press gently on the pedal." As you continue to have that *conscious* thought over a period of months, you develop an automatic programme where you brake without thinking. The braking programme has taken root in the bottom half of your brain – your subconscious. You have a new *subconscious* programme. This explains how, as an experienced driver, you can arrive home after driving for five hours – and say to yourself: "I don't even remember *driving* the car!" Your subconscious did the whole thing. ANY CONSCIOUS THOUGHT, REPEATED OVER A PERIOD OF TIME BECOMES A PROGRAMME.	Split /splɪt/ **(v)** chia, tách ra Walnut /ˈwɑːl.nʌt/ **(n)** quả óc chó (một loại hạt cứng) Digestion /daɪˈdʒes.tʃən/ **(n)** (sự) tiêu hóa Pedal /ˈped.əl/ **(n)** bàn đạp Brake /breɪk/ **(v)** thắng lại, phanh lại
So what happens if, for example, you have a conscious thought over a period of years... "I'm always broke?" You develop an automatic programme where you don't have to	Sabotage /ˈsæb.ə.tɑːʒ/ **(v)** phá hủy, phá hoại, phá ngầm

think. You can make yourself broke without any conscious effort. How does this fit in with positive thinking? Simple. We have about 50,000 thoughts a day. For most of us, they are mainly negative thoughts: “I’m getting fat! I’ve got a bad memory. I can’t pay my bills! Nothing I do ever works.” With mostly negative thoughts, what kind of subconscious behaviour do we get? Mostly negative behaviour – which sabotages our life and health without our even thinking. People wonder why they end up broke and miserable, yet they have created their own automatic patterns through their repetitive thoughts. In the same way that we programme ourselves to drive a car without thinking, we can programme ourselves to be late, miserable or send ourselves broke without thinking. And then we blame God.	Repetitive /rɪˈpeţ.ə.ţɪv/ **(adj)** lặp đi lặp lại
Now here’s what’s exciting. When you understand about subconscious patterns, you realize that no-one *has* to be a loser. Your future depends on your conscious thoughts. As you begin to discipline your mind, your new conscious thoughts create new subconscious programmes. In the same way you can develop subconscious behaviour to drive a car, you can develop subconscious behaviour to be more successful. But it takes disciplined thinking... and some *time*. Now take Fred who attends a motivational seminar, and goes on a positive thinking kick. Fred says: “I’m going to turn my life around!” He writes out a few goals before breakfast... “Get promoted, get a Rolls Royce, buy the Taj Mahal...” and then spends the rest of the week in his usual negative spiral. By Friday he says: “I don’t think this positive thinking stuff is working!” He has perhaps moved from 48,000 negative thoughts per day to 47,500 – and can’t believe he hasn’t won the lottery, cured his arthritis, and quit fighting with his wife. *Being positive for one day won’t do it*. Strengthening your mind is like strengthening your body. If you do twenty push-ups, and then race over to the mirror, you won’t see any difference. Similarly, if you think positive for 24 hours, you will see little difference. But discipline your thinking for a few months and you will see even bigger changes in your life than	Motivational /ˌmoʊ.ţəˈveɪ.ʃən.əl/ **(adj)** truyền động lực Seminar /ˈsem.ə.nɑːr/ **(n)** hội thảo Kick /kɪk/ **(n)** một cảm giác phấn khích mạnh mẽ Turn around **(ph.v)** thay đổi hoàn toàn (từ tình cảnh xấu sang tốt) Cure /kjʊr/ **(v)** chữa khỏi Arthritis /ɑːrˈθraɪ.ţəs/ **(n)** chứng viêm khớp Strengthen /ˈstreŋ.θən/ **(v)** tăng cường, làm cho mạnh Push-up /ˈpʊʃ.ʌp/ **(n)** hít đất Similarly /ˈsɪm.ə.lər.li/ **(adv)** tương tự, cũng như vậy

you will ever see at the gym. Cleaning up our thinking is lifelong work. It is huge! It's made even harder because, often, we don't even know we are being negative when we're being negative. If you want to check your thinking, check your life. Your prosperity, your happiness, the quality of your relationships, and even your health are a reflection of your most common conscious thoughts.	Reflection /rɪˈflek.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) phản ánh

IN A NUTSHELL

Fred says: "I think like I do because my life is a mess!"
No Fred, your life is a mess because you think like you do!



Thought reaps results

(Suy nghĩ gặt những kết quả)

If there is something in your life you don't want, stop worrying about it and stop talking about it! The energy you put into it keeps it alive. Withdraw your energy and it goes away. An argument is the perfect example. If your husband comes home looking for an argument and you refuse to fight, what happens? He can't argue by himself! Whenever you're worried about something – or embarrassed – or even just thinking about it, other people will keep talking about it. As a child this used to fascinate me. I could never understand why, whenever I had been smoking Dad's cigarettes, Mum would want to kiss me good night! When you truly let go of something emotionally, it evaporates. This leads to another principle...	Withdraw /wɪðˈdrɑː/ **(v)** rút Cigarette /ˈsɪg.ə.ret/ **(n)** điếu thuốc lá
WHEN YOU LET GO OF THINGS, THEY LET GO OF YOU. As long as you are defending yourself, people will attack you. Why? Because we only defend ourselves when we are unsure of our position. Really! EXAMPLE – Let's say your neighbour accuses you of being a Martian from outer space. Would you leap headlong into an argument about aliens? No. You know you're not a	Accuse /əˈkjuːz/ **(n)** buộc tội, cáo buộc Martian /ˈmɑːr.ʃən/ **(n)** người sao Hỏa

Martian, so you would probably laugh. EXAMPLE – Let's say you are the subject of office gossip. If you start issuing public statements and declaring your innocence, you'll fuel the fire. Ignore it and it will pass. Am I saying, don't defend yourself? I'm saying that while we protest and agonize, and jump up and down, we keep an issue alive. I remember watching the protest marchers on TV in the 1960s. I asked Dad: "Why are they thumping each other?" He said: "Because they want peace!" You don't fight war. You focus on peace.	Headlong /ˈhed.lɑːŋ/ **(adv)** một cách thiếu suy nghĩ, lao đầu vào Gossip /ˈgɑː.səp/ **(n)** chuyện phiếm, chuyện bàn tán về ai đó Issue /ˈɪʃ.uː/ **(v)** đưa ra Declare /dɪˈkler/ **(v)** tuyên bố Innocence /ˈɪn.ə.səns/ **(n)** sự vô tội Protest /proʊˈtest/ **(v)** phản đối, phản kháng Agonize /ˈæg.ə.naɪz/ **(v)** đau khổ (về tinh thần) Marcher /ˈmɑːr.tʃər/ **(n)** người diễu hành Thump /θʌmp/ **(v)** đấm

IN A NUTSHELL

If you turn your life into a campaign against things, the things you fight will expand.

Decide what you are for.

Campaign /kæmˈpeɪn/ **(n)** chiến dịch



We choose how we see people

Fred and Mary go on their first dinner date. Fred is determined to have a good time. Mary drops potato salad in her lap, and Fred says: "Here, let me help you wipe that up." She loses her house keys, and Fred says: "I do that all the	Wipe STh up /waɪp/ **(ph.v)** lau sạch gì đó (thường là chất lỏng)

time!”

Three years go by. Mary and husband Fred are out to dinner. She drops the potato salad in her lap. Fred says: “You’re disgusting!” She forgets her keys. He says: “You bird brain!”

Same people, same circumstances, different attitude! We choose how we see people. When we *want* to like someone, we can be so tolerant. When we want to be irritated by people, we focus on their faults. It’s not other people’s behaviour that determines how we feel about them – it’s *our attitude*.

Most of us spend more time thinking about what’s wrong than what’s *right*: Mary has two mental lists about Fred. The first is the *wife’s short list* – a brief inventory of Fred’s shortcomings. The second is the widow’s long list – a complete catalogue of Fred’s qualities: his friendliness, his sense of humour, his generosity, his cute backside.

She spends her whole married life concentrating on the short list – the few things which irritate her... “he leaves the newspaper spread all over the breakfast table”, “he leaves the toilet seat up”. Then one day poor Fred gets hit by a truck. Overnight she switches to the long list... “Fred was such an angel... kind, generous, hard working... he was such a good husband.”

If we want to have lists, shouldn’t we at least do it the other way round?

Focus on all the things we adore about people, and when they’re gone console ourselves with thoughts like “He snored anyway”.

If I asked you: “What’s wrong with your mother?” Wouldn’t you find something? If I said: “List another five things you don’t like about her appearance, her attitude, her behaviour”, could you do it? I bet you could. Given time you might think of a hundred things, or maybe a thousand. You might get to the point where you never want to see her again!

People who concentrate on the negatives usually defend themselves by saying: “I’m just being realistic.” The fact is YOU CREATE YOUR REALITY. You choose how you see your mother, and everybody else. Take anybody in your life and concentrate on what you like about them, and your relationship will improve. It can be hard, and even scary, but it

Disgusting /dɪsˈgʌs.tɪŋ/ **(adj)** kinh tởm, ghê tởm

Tolerant /ˈtɑː.lər.ənt/ **(adj)** dung thứ, khoan dung

Irritate /ˈɪr.ə.teɪt/ **(v)** chọc tức, làm phát cáu

Inventory /ˈɪn.vən.tɔːr.i/ **(n)** bản tóm tắt, sự kiểm kê

Shortcoming /ˈʃɔːrtˌkʌm.ɪŋ/ **(n)** khuyết điểm, điều thiếu sót

Widow /ˈwɪd.oʊ/ **(n)** góa phụ

Switch /swɪtʃ/ **(v)** chuyển sang

Console /kənˈsoʊl/ **(v)** an ủi

Snore /snɔːr/ **(v)** ngáy

Realistic /ˌriː.əˈlɪs.tɪk/ **(adj)** thực tế

works.	

Gratitude and abundance

(Lòng biết ơn và sự đầy đủ)

"Show me one happy, ungrateful person!" *– Zig Ziglar*

All spiritual teachings encourage us to give thanks. Fred says: "Why should I spend my life satisfying God's ego?" Actually, I doubt God has an ego problem – when you can move mountains, make universes and do time travel, you don't need to prove anything! We give thanks for *our* benefit, and here's why. We receive in life what we dwell upon. As we express gratitude for what we have, so we feel richer, and so more comes our way. When I met my wife Julie, I noticed that for all her beautiful qualities, she has one shortcoming. She can't add up! But although she is never quite sure what she has earned, what she is owed and what she has spent, she has always enjoyed prosperity. Julie is a living demonstration that, as far as quality of life is concerned, *a sense of gratitude, and an inner knowing that life will bless you*, are more important than logic and mathematics.	Satisfy /ˈsæţ.ɪs.faɪ/ **(v)** làm hài lòng, thỏa mãn Dwell upon /dwel/ **(ph.v)** suy nghĩ nhiều, tập trung nhiều vào Gratitude /ˈgræţ.ə.tuːd/ **(n)** lòng biết ơn Demonstration /ˌdem.ənˈstreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** minh chứng Inner /ˈɪn.ər/ **(adj)** bên trong, trong thâm tâm



6

FOLLOW YOUR HEART.

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Your mission in life is not to be without problems - your mission is to get excited.

DOING WHAT YOU LOVE

YOUR CAREER

CHANGING DIRECTION

WHAT'S YOUR EXCUSE?



Doing what you love

There are two themes in this chapter:

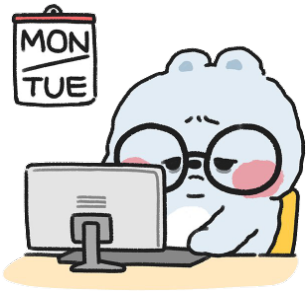
(1) You choose your attitude. If you want to, you can enjoy almost any job, and (2) If you work at something you love, you'll be happier, you'll be more likely to succeed and you'll probably make more money.

So first I say: *"Choose to like whatever you are doing at the moment."* Then I say: *"Go follow your heart."* Is there a contradiction here? No. In the short term, you often need to make the best of a situation. If you need the cash, you may need to stay with your current job while you plan your future.

Contradiction /ˌkɑːn.trəˈdɪk.ʃən/ **(n)** sự mâu thuẫn, sự trái ngược

Fulfilled /fʊlˈfɪld/ **(adj)** thỏa mãn, mãn nguyện

In the long term, you will only be fulfilled if you do what feels right for you.	



Perfect jobs

It usually seems that other people's jobs are easier and more fun – and pay more! Nurses think doctors have it easy. Sales people think sales managers have it easy. Everyone thinks politicians have it easy. Eventually we discover there are no perfect jobs. Why? Because people only pay us to do things they can't, or don't want to do. If there were no problems to solve, our jobs wouldn't exist. If you don't like your work, you have two options – CHANGE YOUR ATTITUDE or CHANGE YOUR JOB. In daydreams, we say: *"If my job was easier, I'd be happy!"* but in reality, we don't like easy jobs. When work gets too easy, we usually leave! We relish challenge so much that we go looking for it, even in our leisure time. Why do you think golf is so popular? Because it's designed to drive you nuts. Fred says: *"If I can get me a job that isn't repetitious, then I'll be happy!"* Most jobs are repetitious. If you are a secretary, you type one letter after another. If you are a movie star, you do one take after another. All repetition. When we label parts of our life as "work" or "play", we limit ourselves. It's like we say: "I'm off to work now, so I expect to suffer until five o'clock." Instead of thinking "work" or "play" – think of it as all *your life*. Loving a job is like loving a person – you might be infatuated in the beginning, but "loving" long term is a decision you make.	Politician /ˌpɑː.ləˈtɪʃ.ən/ **(n)** nhà chính trị Daydream /ˈdeɪ.driːm/ **(n)** cơn mơ mộng, mơ tưởng Relish /ˈrel.ɪʃ/ **(v)** thích, thích thú Repetitious /ˌrep·ɪˈtɪʃ·əs/ **(n)** lặp đi lặp lại = repetitive Infatuated /ɪnˈfætʃ.u.eɪ.ʈɪd/ **(adj)** mê đắm, cuồng dại

"Don't go around saying the world owes you a living. The world owes you nothing. It was here first." *Mark Twain.*

Giving your best

(Hãy cố gắng hết sức mình)

"There is dignity in work only when it is freely accepted."
– Albert Camus



There are two good reasons to do your best.

Firstly, when you give one hundred percent, you are happier. Remember back to when you were at school. Remember what it felt like walking to school, on those days when you had done all of your homework – and done your best. Didn't you feel just a bit more enthusiastic?

It doesn't matter whether you've been out of school for fifty years, the "homework principle" still applies. Your teachers told you to work hard, your parents told you to work hard, bosses tell you to work hard – but you don't work to please parents and teachers and to keep your boss off your back. You do it for you.

Secondly, the universe has a way of punishing laziness and arrogance. Enough things will go wrong in your life – and work – without your giving a half-hearted effort. When we get casual, things start to collapse. Ask the boxer who underestimates his opponent. Ask the businessman who underestimates his competition. There's a word to describe giving it your best shot every time – it's called professionalism.

Have you ever noticed how some taxi drivers make a trip a pleasure, and some make it a pain? Same repetitious job. So where's the difference?

Happy cabbies have a different philosophy. Fred says: "But good cabbies give good service because they're cheerful." No! They're cheerful *because* they give good service.

People who enjoy their work wake up saying: *"Today, I am going to be more effective and more caring than I was yesterday."* They don't always hit the bull's-eye, but it's their aim.

I recently spoke at a conference in Singapore with Mr.

Keep your boss off your back - để sếp không làm phiền hay chỉ trích bạn

Arrogance /ˈer.ə.gəns/ **(n)** tính kiêu ngạo

Half-hearted /ˌhæfˈhɑːr.ʈɪd/ **(adj)** nửa vời, miễn cưỡng, không nhiệt tình

Collapse /kəˈlæps/ **(v)** sập, sụp đổ

Underestimate /ˌʌn.dərˈes.tə.meɪt/ **(v)** đánh giá thấp

Opponent /əˈpoʊ.nənt/ **(n)** đối thủ

Professionalism /prəˈfeʃ.ən.əl.ɪ.zəm/ **(n)** sự chuyên nghiệp

Cabby /ˈkæb.i/ **(n)** người lái taxi

Hit the bull's-eye – ném trúng hồng tâm (phóng phi tiêu); đạt được mục tiêu một cách hoàn hảo

Regard /rɪˈgɑːrd/ **(v)** đánh giá, xem là

Field /fiːld/ **(n)** lĩnh vực

Zig Ziglar. Zig has been speaking professionally for over twenty-five years and he is internationally regarded as a man at the very top of his field. His busy schedule and sizeable speaking fees are testament to this. Before his speech I said to him: “Zig, you must have given this talk a thousand times. How long did you prepare for today’s presentation?” He said: “Three hours.” Despite his success, Zig takes no chances and no short cuts. He is committed to his craft and dedicated to constant improvement. To call Zig “talented” would be to underestimate the man, because it takes so much more than talent to stay at the top.	Sizeable /ˈsaɪ.zə.bəl/ **(adj)** khá lớn, đáng kể Testament /ˈtes.tə.mənt/ **(n)** bằng chứng, minh chứng Committed /kəˈmɪţ.ɪd/ **(adj)** tận tụy Craft /kræft/ **(n)** nghề Dedicated /ˈded.ə.keɪ.ţɪd/ **(adj)** tận tâm, hết lòng

Who do you work for?

Always do more than you are paid for,
and one day you will be paid for more than you do.



Recently I was served by a rude waiter. His body language said something like: “Who gave you permission to come into this restaurant?” It took twenty minutes to get my cappuccino, and when it arrived, most of it was in the saucer. In conversation, I asked him about his job and his boss. He said: “I sure don’t want to work for this turkey for the rest of my life.” Unfortunately, he had missed one major point about life in the workplace. YOU DON’T WORK FOR YOUR BOSS. YOU WORK FOR YOURSELF. None of your employers will be perfect and your colleagues may be lazy. But when you sign on as an employee, your job is to give your best, not to pick holes in the guy who signs the cheques. When you only give fifty percent effort, you suffer much more than your boss. He only loses a few dollars. You lose your enthusiasm and your self-esteem, and a whole chunk of your life. IF I HAD A GOOD JOB... Some people believe that there are “happy” things to do	Saucer /ˈsɑː.sər/ **(n)** đĩa (đặt dưới chén / tách) Hole /hoʊl/ **(n)** khuyết điểm, thiếu sót Enthusiasm /ɪnˈθuː.zi.æz.əm/ **(n)** (sự) hăng hái, nhiệt tình Self-esteem /ˌself.ɪˈstiːm/ **(n)** lòng tự trọng Out-of-work **(adj)** thất nghiệp Affluence /ˈæf.lu.əns/ **(n)** (sự) giàu có, sung túc Retrenched /rɪˈtrentʃt/ **(adj)** bị giảm biên chế

and “unhappy” things to do. *Not so*. An interesting person can make a dull job interesting. This doesn’t mean that an out-of-work banker ought to wash cars for twenty years – but a few months might be good therapy! With our affluence comes arrogance. The retrenched architect says: “I do buildings but I don’t do windows.” Dismissed executives attach themselves to the government nipple, never considering they might wait on tables rather than draw a dole cheque. Enjoying your work is a choice. My brother, Christopher, knows how to make even lousy jobs memorable! If I had to pick someone to help me dig a ditch or paint a roof, or smash concrete, I would choose him. He just assumes it will be enjoyable. You can have more fun plucking chickens with Chris than you have at some cocktail parties.	Dismissed /dɪˈsmɪst/ **(adj)** bị sa thải Dole /doʊl/ **(adj)** trợ cấp Lousy /ˈlaʊ.zi/ **(adj)** tồi tệ, tệ hại Ditch /dɪtʃ/ **(n)** mương Concrete /ˈkɑːn.kriːt/ **(n)** bê-tông Assume /əˈsuːm/ **(v)** cho rằng, giả sử Pluck /plʌk/ **(v)** nhổ lông (gà)

IN A NUTSHELL

You give your best not because you need to impress people. You give your best because that’s the only way to enjoy your work.

Your career



This book is not a career guide. It is a philosophy of life – i.e. you have one life: spend it doing things you care about. To do this, you need to accept two ideas. 1. *“It’s possible to do what you love – if not yet in your job, at least in your leisure time.”* Some of us play the martyr, never putting time aside just for ourselves. If you can’t do things you love in your leisure time, it’s doubtful you’ll ever allow yourself to work in a job you really love. 2. *“It’s possible to be paid to do what you love.”* Many of us grow up believing that work is meant to be a	Doubtful /ˈdaʊt.fəl/ **(adj)** đáng nghi ngờ, không chắc Tropical /dɪtʃ/ **(adj)** (thuộc) nhiệt đới Risk /rɪsk/ **(n)** (sự) rủi ro, mạo hiểm Uncertainty /ʌnˈsɜːr.tən.ti/ **(n)** sự

drag. Wrong! Millions of people have a ball at work and get paid for it.

Let us define what “doing what you love” is *NOT*. Doing what you love is not pulling in a pay cheque for lying on a tropical beach. It is having a passion for something – and putting all your love, energy and creativity into making it work. It is taking risks. And usually, it is having to make it work just so you can feed yourself!

The uncertainty is half the fun. When there is no struggle, there is something missing. That’s why so many children of the rich and famous overdose on heroin and blow their brains out. They have no challenge. Whether they work or not, their material needs are met.

YOUR LIFE WILL ONLY WORK WHEN YOU TAKE FULL RESPONSIBILITY FOR YOUR CHOICES. YOUR CHOICE OF VOCATION IS AT THE TOP OF THE LIST.

Ask Fred: “Why are you doing this job?” He says: “Everybody has to be somewhere, doing something!” Not good enough, Fred. There are no medals for spending a lifetime doing something you hate. If you know in your heart that you are in the wrong kind of work, change your job. Do something you love.

không chắc chắn, sự bấp bênh

Overdose /ˈoʊ.vər.doʊs/ **(v)** dùng quá liều

Vocation /voʊˈkeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** nghề nghiệp (mà bạn thấy phù hợp với mình)

I don’t know what I want to do

If you don’t know what you like doing, maybe you stopped listening to yourself years ago. Many of us became different people in order to please our family... you wanted to play baseball *but* mother made you play piano, you dreamed of sports cars *but* always bought something “practical”, you wanted to be a journalist *but* you became an accountant, you ached to travel South America *but* always vacationed at Uncle Ted’s.

You took up “appropriate” hobbies. You did what was “expected”. Then one day you woke up saying: “I don’t know who I am, but I know I don’t want to do this any more.”

If you smother your passion for long enough, you won’t even remember what you really love. A voice inside will remind you that it’s selfish to do what you really want. That little voice might even be saying: “You hate your job and it serves you

Journalist /ˈdʒɜːr.nə.lɪst/ **(n)** nhà báo, ký giả

Ache /eɪk/ **(v)** khát khao

Smother /ˈsmʌð.ər/ **(v)** dập tắt, bóp ngạt, không cho phát triển

Minor /ˈmaɪ.nər/ **(adj)** nhỏ, không đáng kể

Consideration /kənˌsɪd.əˈreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự suy nghĩ, sự cân nhắc

right.” It’s also possible to *think* you like doing something because everybody expects you to like it. Here’s what you notice when you *really* like doing something: ● It’s easy to get out of bed in the morning and you never want to take a rest. ● You forget about time and you forget yourself. ● Effort is a minor consideration. You can talk about it for hours – and usually do!	Effort is a minor consideration - Sự nỗ lực không tốn nhiều đắn đo suy nghĩ



How do I rediscover my passion?
(Làm thế nào để tôi khám phá lại niềm đam mê của mình?)

Simplify your life. Quit doing things out of habit. Eliminate some of the garbage from your routine so you can see more clearly. Switch off the TV for a month. Notice what you think about, notice what you read. Listen to yourself. Next time a little voice inside says: “I love that, this excites me.” LISTEN! Go to the city library, start at one end and walk to the other. Look at every shelf. What grabs you? Try new things... try oil painting, bonsai, coach a kids’ soccer team, learn Italian. Try ten things and nine may not excite you, but number ten may open up a whole new world. If that doesn’t work, try another ten things. To find, you have to seek. If you have lost your life direction, you probably won’t find it between drinks at the local bar. Give yourself a break, give yourself some time and space to examine what counts for you. Go to the mountains or the beach for a week *by yourself*. Fred says: “I haven’t got time for that.” That’s like saying “I’m lost – but I’m running so late, I can’t look at a road map.” Most importantly, get comfortable with the idea of doing what you like. To do what you love doing, you have to believe it’s possible. As you discover what you like to do with your time, you begin to find answers to the question, *“What do I*	Simplify /ˈsɪm.plə.faɪ/ **(v)** đơn giản hóa Eliminate /iˈlɪm.ə.neɪt/ **(v)** loại trừ, loại ra Switch off /swɪtʃ/ **(ph.v)** ngắt, tắt Excite /ɪkˈsaɪt/ **(v)** gây hứng thú, làm cho phấn khích Grab /græb/ **(v)** chộp lấy; thu hút sự chú ý Count /kaʊnt/ **(v)** có giá trị, quan trọng

want to do with my life?”	

IN A NUTSHELL

Many people don’t know what they want - and they are upset because they are not getting it. If you don’t know exactly what you want, figure out what is closest to it - and go from there.



Talent

“Talent” doesn’t have to mean you paint masterpieces. Caring for people is a talent. Teaching is a talent. Making people feel welcome is a talent. Solving problems is a talent. Managing is a talent. Parenting is a talent.

Too often we underestimate our own talents. The potter says: “If only I could make music, now *that* would be something.” The pianist says: “If only I could make things with my hands...” Don’t measure your abilities against others. Do what you can do. Accept what talents you have. Fulfilment comes from developing *your* gifts, not wishing for someone else’s.

Mary says: “I have a God-given talent with kids, but maybe I’m supposed to be a banker.” If you are literally God’s gift to pre-schoolers, why would he want you to be a number cruncher? Give him some credit! If you can figure out where your gifts are, he can too.

Another thing I notice: most people who tell you they have no talent haven’t tried many things.

Having said this, *talent is useful, but it isn’t everything!* When people talk about Jack Nicklaus’ golfing success, they generally talk of his *extraordinary talent*. When Jack talks of his success, he talks about the *extra practice balls he hit*. Jack knew that the difference between Jack Nicklaus and a thousand other talented golfers was attitude and hard work.

Masterpiece /ˈmæs.tər.piːs/ **(n)** tác phẩm lớn, kiệt tác

Potter /ˈpɑː.ţər/ **(n)** thợ gốm

Fulfilment /fʊlˈfɪl.mənt/ **(n)** sự thỏa mãn, hài lòng

Pre-schooler /ˈpriːˌskuː.lər/ **(n)** trẻ chưa đến tuổi đi học; trẻ học trường mầm non

Number cruncher /ˈnʌm.bərˌkrʌn.tʃər/ **(n)** người làm việc với số liệu

Give + ai đó + some credit /ˈkred.ɪt/ Công nhận, khen ngợi khả năng của ai đó.

Extraordinary /ɪkˈstrɔːr.dən.er.i/ **(adj)** phi thường

Onlookers and underachievers put major emphasis on talent. For them, talent, or the lack of it, is a great excuse to do nothing. If there is an outstanding quality common to great artists, scientists, sports stars, humanitarians and business tycoons it is not their talent – it is their focus. Once you know what you want to do, get focused! You can't do everything. You can't save the whales, heal the sick and plug the ozone layer all at the same time. Leave some chores for the rest of humanity.	Onlooker /ˈɑːnˌlʊk.ər/ **(n)** người đứng ngoài xem Underachiever /ˌʌn.dər.əˈtʃiː.vər/ **(n)** người làm kém hơn khả năng có thể làm Emphasis /ˈem.fə.sɪs/ **(n)** (sự) nhấn mạnh Humanitarian hjuːˌmæn.ɪˈter.i.ən/ **(n)** nhà hoạt động nhân đạo Tycoon /taɪˈkuːn/ **(n)** ông trùm Plug /plʌg/ **(v)** bít, bịt kín Chore /tʃɔːr/ **(n)** việc vặt

Use your spare time

(Sử dụng thời gian rảnh rỗi của bạn)

"Work is love made visible." *– Kahlil Gibran*



Many people turn their hobby into their full time work, and the transition from "hobby" to livelihood is very often gradual... Frank loves photography and devotes his spare time to it. He photographs friends' weddings. He wins some local amateur competitions. Gradually, he gets more and more work. Within a couple of years he's making more money on weekends than at the office. Sure, some weddings get cancelled, some clients don't pay their bills, he has some lean months, but for Frank, it's all worth it. Maria loves languages. She speaks Italian and English and decides to learn Spanish. She vacations in Barcelona. To improve her Spanish, she teaches South American migrants English after work – for free. Within two years, she's fluent in three languages. Maria applies for three travel jobs and misses out – but she doesn't quit. She does a translators' course to refine her skills. Finally she lands a position in a language	Transition /trænˈzɪʃ.ən/ **(n)** sự chuyển đổi, quá trình chuyển biến Livelihood /ˈlaɪv.li.hʊd/ **(n)** sinh kế, nghề nghiệp Devote /dɪˈvoʊt/ **(v)** hiến dâng, dành Client /ˈklaɪ.ənt/ **(n)** khách hàng, người sử dụng dịch vụ Lean /liːn/ **(adj)** ít tiền, ít việc, khó khăn

school.

Jim loves hiking and camping, and has all the gear: boots, tents, rucksacks. He notices that some people want to camp, but they have no gear. He rents them his gear. Sometimes he organizes their whole camping trip, takes the people in his van – and charges them. Sometimes campers lose his ropes and burn his tents, but Jim reasons: "No job is perfect – it's better than my last job at the morgue!"

What do we learn from these people?

- That it is possible to make a living doing something you like.
- The world is a market place. Once you develop a skill, people will pay you for it.

Also we learn that real life is not like the soaps. TV goes like this –

- 7.30 pm Scene 1: Samantha decides to start a modeling agency.
- 7.34 pm Scene 2: Samantha rents an office the size of a tennis court.
- 7.36 pm Scene 3: Samantha appoints a manager and retires to Hawaii.

In real life Samantha would visit eight banks to get finance. In real life Samantha would work weekends in a hamburger joint. In real life Samantha would start out with an office the size of your bathroom.

Real life is more frustrating. Real life takes a little longer.

Speaking of soaps, people who turn pastimes into professions don't spend much time watching them.

Living other people's lives is no match for living your own.

Migrant /ˈmaɪ.grənt/ **(n)** người di cư

Fluent /ˈfluː.ənt/ **(adj)** lưu loát, trôi chảy

Refine /rɪˈfaɪn/ **(v)** trau dồi, mài dũa, tinh luyệt

Land /lænd/ **(v)** kiếm được, đạt được

Gear /gɪr/ **(n)** dụng cụ

Rucksack /ˈrʌk.sæk/ **(n)** ba-lô = backpack

Van /væn/ **(n)** xe tải nhỏ

Morgue /mɔːrg/ **(n)** nhà xác

Soap (soap opera) /soʊp/ **(n)** phim truyền hình dài tập về cuộc sống của một nhóm nhân vật, tập trung vào các mối quan hệ tình cảm, cường điệu hóa cảm xúc; được chiếu mỗi ngày hoặc nhiều lần trong một tuần (ví dụ: *Cô dâu tám tuổi*)

Appoint /əˈpɔɪnt/ **(v)** bổ nhiệm

Hamburger joint /ˈhæmˌbɜːr.gər ˌdʒɔɪnt/ **(n)** tiệm bán thức ăn nhanh

Pastime /ˈpæs.taɪm/ **(n)** điều tiêu khiển, trò giải trí, làm cho vui

IN A NUTSHELL

If you want to earn a living doing what you love, your hobby is a possible source of income. Until you have leisure interests, you limit your options.

Changing direction

My father always did what he wanted to do. At different times he was a sailor, a butcher, a farmer, an inventor, a landscape artist and a real estate developer. I grew up believing that work was *whatever you wanted to do*. I assumed that whenever you wanted a different occupation, you started one. So whereas many people need courage to resist pressure from their parents and follow their dreams, I didn't. When I told my Dad: "I'm quitting law studies to become an artist!" He said: "If that's what you want to do, wonderful!"

I painted portraits until my mid-twenties when I got excited about the benefits of "positive attitude". At that point I decided to make oil painting my hobby rather than my profession, and I began teaching personal development seminars for a living. Approaching thirty, I began writing books, and in order to illustrate my books, I became a cartoonist. I now spend most of my working time speaking to conferences and conventions.

I outline my own experience to explain in part why I wrote this book. It saddens me that more people don't see the possibility to do the work they love. To find meaning and excitement in your work, you have to follow your heart. I believe it, and I live it.

Of course, everybody doesn't want to be self-employed. For some occupations, it's almost impossible to run your own business – you don't meet many self-employed bank managers or jumbo pilots! And many people prefer to have one career rather than several. But I'm stunned that so many people actually get work that they hate, often with rather limp excuses! What I notice is that we choose careers that fit our belief system.

Many of us had our career path chosen by an ignorant teenager – ourselves! If you chose your first career at seventeen, maybe it's time to choose again. Consider having more than one career in your life.

Let's say you wanted to teach music, but you became an

Butcher /ˈbʊtʃ.ər/ **(n)** người bán thịt

Real estate developer /ˈrɪəl ɪ.steɪt dɪˌvel.ə.pər/ **(n)** nhà phát triển bất động sản

Whereas /werˈæz/ **(conj)** trong khi

Pressure /ˈpreʃ.ər/ **(n)** áp lực, sự ép buộc

Portrait /ˈpɔːr.trɪt/ **(v)** chân dung

Cartoonist /kɑːrˈtuː.nɪst/ **(n)** họa sĩ vẽ tranh biếm họa

Conference /ˈkɑːnfərəns/ **(n)** hội nghị (thiên về giải quyết vấn đề, học hỏi từ chuyên gia)

Convention /kənˈvenʃən/ **(n)** hội nghị (thiên về kết nối, cùng nhau chia sẻ, bàn luận)

Sadden /ˈsæd.ən/ **(v)** làm cho (ai) buồn

Stun /stʌn/ **(v)** làm choáng, làm kinh ngạc

Limp /lɪmp/ **(adj)** yếu, không vững

engineer to please your Dad. Every day, Dad's words are ringing in your ears: "You've had opportunities I never had. I wish I could have built bridges." What should you do? Tune up the piano! Firstly, do it *for your father's benefit*. You can't live your life through someone else. Dad has to find interest in his own life. While you are sacrificing yourself to please him, you are postponing his growth and yours. You are not here to fulfil the dreams of frustrated parents. And do it *for your benefit*. Just because you spent four years becoming an engineer, why should you spend the next forty years doing something you hate? It's bad for your spirit, it's bad for your health and you are doomed to mediocrity! Do you really have to love something to do it well? Did Beethoven love music? Did Ferrari like fast cars? Take two doctors. One is passionate about his patients. The other is passionate about his BMW. Which doctor would you choose to remove your gallbladder? You say: "So should I quit my job at the post office and start a rock band?" Not without music lessons and a few gigs! There is such a thing as a calculated risk. You develop your abilities, you expand your knowledge, you study, you create a demand for your skills... and then you move to doing what you love. Fred says: "I've got a family to support. Do you want me to just quit the office?" Well Fred, if your heart is somewhere else, it seems a long term option.	Ignorant /ˈɪg.nər.ənt/ **(adj)** thiếu hiểu biết, ngu dốt Fulfil /fʊlˈfɪl/ **(v)** thực hiện, hoàn thành Doomed /duːmd/ **(adj)** chắc chắn sẽ (gì đó tiêu cực) Mediocrity /ˌmiː.diˈɑː.krə.ţi/ **(n)** sự tầm thường Passionate /ˈpæʃ.ən.ət/ **(adj)** hăng hái, nhiệt tình Gallbladder /ˈgɑːl.blæd.ər/ **(n)** túi mật Gig /gɪg/ **(n)** buổi trình diễn

Working for money

"Many men go fishing all of their lives without knowing that it is not the fish they're after." *– Henry David Thoreau*



If you are working just for the money, you won't be happy and you probably won't make much money. It's the universe's way of prodding you to do something you really love. In Chapter Four I talked about unattachment. When you	Prod /prɑːd/ **(v)** đẩy, thúc, chọc Dedication /ˌded.əˈkeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)**

really love what you do, you are less attached to money, and so you usually find you make more of it. Money is a game – you win by playing the game and not agonising over the score. You may appreciate money, but dedication goes way beyond money. Whatever work you are doing at the moment, *you are competing against people who love what they are doing*. If you don't love your work, you will be blown away by the competition. Is there room for you? There's always room for excellence. Eighty percent of people are very nice, and also a bit mediocre. How often do you get picked up in a clean taxi? When did you last get to see your doctor on time? How often do you get fine service in a restaurant? Doing what you love doesn't have to involve years of training and big expense – and it can often grow out of apparent disaster. Julie has a manicurist, Danielle, who used to rent a corner of a hairdressing salon. When the hairdresser doubled her rent, Danielle was devastated. Then she piled all her nail polishes into a fishing tackle box, and started doing home manicure visits on her motor scooter. She's punctual, gives great service and she's booked weeks ahead.	(sự) cống hiến, tâm huyết Apparent /əˈper.ənt/ **(adj)** rõ ràng, thấy rõ Manicurist /ˈmæn.ə.kjʊr.ɪst/ **(n)** thợ làm móng tay Nail polish /ˈneɪl ˌpɑːl.ɪʃ/ **(n)** sơn móng tay / chân Manicure /ˈmæn.ə.kjʊr/ **(n)** việc làm móng Motor scooter /ˈmoʊ.ţər ˌskuː.ţər/ **(n)** xe tay ga Punctual /ˈpʌŋk.tʃu.əl/ **(adj)** đúng giờ

But if I did what I love, I could never make the same money I'm making now
(Nhưng nếu tôi làm điều mình yêu thích, tôi không bao giờ có thể làm ra số tiền như tôi đang kiếm được bây giờ)

Doing what you love will very often offer you greater prosperity in the long term. But sometimes it won't. Sometimes, when you do what you love, you *need* less money. Let's say you are a company president. You have a huge apartment, plus a weekender on a little farm, plus the fancy cars, plus the expense accounts that go with being a top executive. Your real love is breeding horses, and teaching horse riding, but you say: "I have to keep my job to maintain all this stuff!" When you become a riding instructor, you might find that you don't need the penthouse and the sports cars. Sometimes we buy a lot of toys to take our mind off the fact that we hate our job. When you follow your heart, you might discover that	Weekender /ˈwiːk.end.ər/ **(n)** nhà nghỉ cuối tuần Breed /briːd/ **(v)** chăn nuôi Maintain /meɪnˈteɪn/ **(v)** duy trì Penthouse /ˈpent.haʊs/ **(n)** căn hộ sang trọng, ở trên tầng cao nhất của một khách sạng hoặc tòa nhà

one little farm and one little Jeep are enough.	



It's not the job…

You'll notice something about good nurses – they like people even more than medicine. There is a clue here about finding meaning in your career. THE JOB ISN'T IT! Whatever you do for a living is a vehicle to connect with people. Whether or not you are fulfilled depends on how you serve the people. Albert Schweitzer said: *"...the only ones among you who will be truly happy will be those who have sought and found how to serve."* Unfortunately, "serving people" sounds like slavery or sacrifice. It's not. It is simply knowing that there's joy in giving something of yourself which is uniquely yours. "Serving" can be teaching or nursing people. It can be selling them beautiful flowers, or repairing their radiators with a smile. It's not about your job description. It's about your philosophy. Society often evaluates careers in terms of Ph.Ds and master's degrees, and we are in danger of missing the point. It's the people connections. Let's say you are coaching a basketball team of twelve-year-olds. You might love basketball, and that's fine. But as soon as you understand that *it's not about basketball at all*, then you can really do something for those kids. You might say: "Basketball coaches don't change the lives of twelve-year-olds." Wrong! Some do – and they are the coaches who understand they are teaching kids about life, and basketball is just the excuse. Meanwhile, too many teachers tell themselves: "What do I matter? The kids don't care about algebra." Of course they don't! If you are teaching sixth grade, your mission is not algebra. It is children. If you are a banker, your mission isn't balance sheets, it's people.	Vehicle /ˈviː.ə.kəl/ **(n)** phương tiện Slavery /ˈsleɪ.vər.i/ **(n)** sự nô lệ, cảnh nô lệ Uniquely /juːˈniːk.li/ **(adv)** độc nhất Radiator /ˈreɪ.di.eɪ.ţər/ **(n)** lò sưởi, bộ tản nhiệt Evaluate /ɪˈvæl.ju.eɪt/ **(v)** đánh giá In terms of STh - dưới dạng, về mặt Ph.D (Doctor of Philosophy) **(n)** bằng tiến sĩ Master's degree /ˌmæs.tərz dɪˈgriː/ **(n)** bằng thạc sĩ Algebra /ˈæl.dʒə.brə/ **(n)** đại số

“I do!”



Some years ago, I was a guest author at Books and Co. bookstore, in Dayton, Ohio. As I was drawing cartoons in the store, the staff told me a romantic story about two of their customers...

One day Rebecca Battles and Ray Cwikowski were browsing in the grief recovery section of the store. Ray and Rebecca had both recently lost their spouses to illness. They began talking and decided to attend some grief counselling sessions together. Ultimately, the two struck up a friendship.

Some months later, Rebecca was back at Books and Co. The assistant asked Rebecca: “Did you get what you wanted?” Rebecca said: “I got more than I dreamed of – I got the book I wanted and my fiancée, all in the same section! We’re getting married on September 15th.”

Books and Co. were so excited, they volunteered to hold the wedding reception in the bookstore! Bookshelves were moved, tables and chairs were hired, flowers were brought in, decorations were hung, and the gift wrap section became a restaurant.

Proprietors Annye and Joe stopped selling books and served wedding cake. It was a special and touching event.

Books and Co. are a living demonstration that joy comes from combining effort and imagination. It comes from choosing to be involved, and saying: “I can help.” It would have been so much easier for Annye and Joe to say: “That’s not our department. We’re a bookstore. We don’t do weddings.”

Besides having fine books, Books and Co. invite jazz bands weekly. They hold poetry readings, fishing workshops and lectures. They even have pet days. The Sunday before I visited they had five hundred dogs in the store!

It’s not ***what*** you do, it’s ***how*** you do it. If you are a bookstore owner, or a boat builder or a baby sitter, you can either do what everyone else does, or you can use some

Browse /braʊz/ **(v)** xem lướt qua

Grief /griːf/ **(n)** nỗi đau buồn

Spouse /spaʊs/ **(n)** chồng / vợ

Counselling session /ˈkaʊn.səl.ɪŋ/ /ˈseʃ.ən / **(n)** buổi tư vấn

Strike up STh /straɪk/ **(ph.v)** bắt đầu (một mối quan hệ, một cuộc nói chuyện)

Fiancée /ˌfiː.ɑːnˈseɪ/ (n) vị hôn thê
Fiancé /ˌfiː.ɑːnˈseɪ/ (n) vị hôn phu
*Rebecca nói mình tìm được vị hôn phu nhưng có thể do lỗi chính tả nên sách ghi “Fiancée”.

Wedding reception /ˈwed.ɪŋ rɪˌsep.ʃən/ **(n)** tiệc cưới

Proprietor /prəˈpraɪə.ʈər/ **(n)** người chủ, người sở hữu

Babysitter (baby-sister) /ˈbeɪ.biˌsɪʈ.ər/ **(n)** người giữ trẻ

imagination.	

IN A NUTSHELL

The joy is in doing your thing – and stretching because you choose to, not because you have to.

Stretch /juːˈniːk.li/ **(v)** kéo dài, mở rộng

I don't care what I do, so long as I get rich and famous!
(Tôi không quan tâm tôi làm gì, miễn là tôi trở nên giàu có và nổi tiếng!)



The Sanskrit word for "your purpose in life" is *dharma*. According to the *Law of Dharma*, we each have unique talents which we are here to discover. When we express those talents, we find joy. According to the law, we are most likely to discover those talents when we ask: "What can I give?" rather than: "What can I get?" Bill Gates is one of the world's richest men. To hear him speak, it's obvious he is more excited by software than money. Elvis Presley didn't set out to make a fortune, he set out to make a record. Being rich is not a goal, it's a by-product. As for fame, most famous people find it irritating and inconvenient. Why would you want armies of strangers climbing your back fence? What's the point in having fifty photographers across the street with telephoto lenses aimed at your bathroom window?	Sanskrit /ˈsæn.skrɪt/ **(n)** tiếng Phạn Set out **(ph.v)** khởi sự By-product /ˈbaɪˌprɑː.dəkt/ **(n)** kết quả phụ, phụ phẩm Army /ˈɑːr.mi/ **(n)** đội quân, đoàn, đám đông Telephoto lens /ˌtel.əˌfoʊ.t̬oʊ ˈlenz/ **(n)** ống kính chụp xa

What if everybody did what they loved? Who would patch the roads?
(Điều gì xảy ra nếu mọi người đều làm việc họ yêu thích? Ai sẽ sửa những con đường?)

Although it may not be your calling, some people love patching roads... no telephones, open air, big trucks, country	Patch /pætʃ/ **(v)** vá, sửa

music... it has its advantages. Our neighbour Wolfgang is a surgeon. Recently, over a Spaghetti Bolognaise dinner, he told us about an exhilarating haemorrhoid operation he had performed that afternoon. As I tried to imagine myself operating on someone's backside, I thought: "Wolfie is a real comic!" And then I realized he wasn't joking. Wolfie is passionate about cutting people up – and he loves a good haemorrhoid. When Wolfie describes haemorrhoids, they come alive! Different people like doing different things. We are all moving in different directions at a different pace. When you move to do what you love, there will be someone to step into your shoes.	Exhilarating /ɪgˈzɪl.ə.reɪ.ʈɪŋ/ **(adj)** đầy phấn khích, khiến vui vẻ Haemorrhoid /ˈhem.ər.ɔɪdz/ **(n)** bệnh trĩ Pace /peɪs/ **(n)** tốc độ, nhịp độ Step into your shoes - thay thế bạn

If I start doing what I love will I have fewer problems?
(Nếu tôi bắt đầu làm việc tôi yêu thích, tôi sẽ gặp ít vấn đề hơn phải không?)

No! Your mission in life is not to be without problems, your mission is to get excited!

Your best chance for prosperity is in doing what you love. Love is energy. Everything you do with love is infused with that "quality energy", and that kind of energy is more likely to translate into dollars. But that doesn't mean no frustration and no pain. I have a problem with some new age books which paint such rosy pictures. Their message is: "Just follow your dream and carry home the cash in a wheelbarrow."	Infuse /ɪnˈfjuːz/ **(v)** truyền, ngấm Wheelbarrow /ˈwiːlˌber.oʊ/ **(n)** xe cút kít

IN A NUTSHELL

Doing what you love is not a recipe for an easier life, it is a recipe for an interesting life. Most likely you'll take on more responsibilities and more problems!

Recipe /ˈres.ə.pi/ **(n)** công thức

“Being Happy!”



When I took the manuscript of my first book, “BEING HAPPY!”, to publishers, they all said: *“The last thing the world needs is another self-improvement manual.”* They also said that, to be writing books like “BEING HAPPY!”, I should be a psychiatrist – except for one fellow, and he thought I should see one!

But after a year and a half of rejections I found Media Masters, a publisher with a vision, in Singapore. Media Masters soon told me that the book market is extremely competitive, and that newspapers and TV have little interest in unknown authors. We needed a strategy.

We decided to take “BEING HAPPY!” direct to the people. When we launched the book in Singapore, I took my easel and microphone into almost every book store in the city. I drew my cartoons, talked about my philosophies and signed books. In the high schools and universities, I talked to the students, and in the corporations, I talked to the staff. We stuck with this plan until “BEING HAPPY!” hit the Singapore best-seller lists, and then we used the same strategy in Malaysia, then Australia, and so on.

I spent six years travelling countries all over the globe. I spoke in warehouses and prisons, and cartooned in a thousand shopping centres – my next book should be “Shopping Malls of the World”. For the most part I revelled in the project. But there were days when I would wake up in some hotel room and think: “If I go into another book store I’ll vomit!”

One book store at a time, one city at a time, one country at a time, we took “BEING HAPPY!” to the international marketplace. And gradually, the newspapers and TV stations began to call us!

We had some fun along the way. We did a whole promotional tour of Australia during an airline strike. In New Zealand, they had me drawing cartoons on radio!

Manuscript /ˈmæn.jə.skrɪpt/ **(n)** bản thảo

Publisher /ˈpʌb.lɪ.ʃər/ **(n)** nhà xuất bản

Manual /ˈmæn.ju.əl/ **(n)** cẩm nang, sách hướng dẫn

Psychiatrist /saɪˈkaɪə.trɪst/ **(n)** bác sĩ tâm lý

Rejection /rɪˈdʒek.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) từ chối

Strategy /ˈstræţ.ə.dʒi/ **(n)** chiến lược

Launch /lɑːntʃ/ **(v)** ra mắt, tung ra

Easel /ˈiː.zəl/ **(n)** giá vẽ

Warehouse /ˈwer.haʊs/ **(n)** cửa hàng, nhà kho

Revel /ˈrev.əl/ **(v)** say sưa, miệt mài

TV station /ˈsteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** đài truyền hình

Promotional /prəˈmoʊ.ʃən.əl/ **(adj)** (thuộc) quảng cáo

To launch “BEING HAPPY!” in America, we organized a cocktail party for the media at the Australian Embassy on Fifth Avenue in Manhattan. We sent out invitations to what seemed like every newspaper, news bureau, TV station and radio station on the East Coast of the U.S.A. We catered for two hundred people. I flew to New York for the launch on June 20th, 1990. As it happened, June 20th, was the day a fellow called Nelson Mandela also flew to New York. How many media people thought little Andrew was bigger news than Nelson Mandela? Zero. If you have ever had a cocktail party by yourself, just you and eleven waiters, you’ll know that the service is unforgettable. People ask me: “What did you do to sell a million books?” I tell them: “I flew a million miles, gave five hundred speeches, a thousand interviews – and lost my baggage twenty-three times!” This story is not about books or business – it’s about any successful project you care to name. You start wherever you can. You do everything you can. It’s more about effort than luck.	Strike /straɪk/ **(n)** cuộc đình công Embassy /ˈem.bə.si/ **(n)** đại sứ quán Bureau /ˈbjʊr.oʊ/ **(n)** văn phòng, cục Cater /ˈkeɪ.ţər/ **(v)** phục vụ cho, cung cấp thức ăn



Passion

When you care about what you do, enthusiasm carries you through. When you are passionate, no one else has to motivate you. If you open your “dream restaurant”, and no one comes to eat, you keep trying new recipes, ideas, and locations until the place is crammed. If you run out of money first, you take your enthusiasm to someone who has more money than you – and	Cram /kræm/ **(v)** nhồi / nhét đầy (khách) Determination /dɪˌtɜːr.mɪˈneɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) quyết tâm, kiên định

you get a partner. You go through frustrations – and a few chefs – but in your heart, you know you're on course. Sure you need plenty of determination, but your passion is your foundation. Vitality comes from a sense of purpose. You owe it to yourself and you owe it to other people to do what excites you. There are already enough lukewarm people in the world who get burned out without ever having been on fire. Following your dream is no guarantee of an easy ride. Life usually becomes more challenging, but you embark on an outer journey which starts the inner journey. You have a chance to blossom – to see who you really are.	Vitality /vaɪˈtæl.ə.ţi/ **(n)** khí lực, sức mạnh Lukewarm /ˈluːk.wɔːrm/ **(adj)** thờ ơ, lãnh đạm Embark on STh /ɪmˈbɑːrk/ **(ph.v)** bắt đầu (việc gì lớn / quan trọng), dấn thân

IN A NUTSHELL

Wherever you are, you aren't stuck - you are a human being, not a tree!

"What's your excuse?"

(Lời biện hộ của bạn là gì?)

You may have read this chapter with a touch of irritation, thinking: "Andrew, it's fine to do what you love but you don't know *my* situation." If you have unfulfilled dreams, analyse your excuses. Usually we are not very honest with ourselves. We say things are *impossible* when the truth is, they're *very inconvenient*. Mary says: "I would really love to study archaeology – but of course it's impossible." What she really means is: "To study archaeology, I would need to either: (a) get the necessary entry qualifications; (b) waitress part-time at Greasy Joe's; (c) get a loan; (d) stop going out to dinner for four years; or (e) all of the above." She decides that archaeology is not worth that kind of effort. In fact, Mary says: "If you think I'd go through all that, you've got rocks in your head!" Jim says: "I would love to own my own little apartment." He has been saying the same thing for twenty-three years. What Jim means is: "I'd love to have my own apartment if: (a) I	Irritation /ˌɪr.əˈteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** (tình trạng) phát cáu, bị chọc tức Analyse /ˈæn.əl.aɪz/ **(v)** phân tích Archaeology /ˌɑːr.kiˈɑː.lə.dʒi/ **(n)** khảo cổ học Understandable /ˌʌn.dərˈstæn.də.bəl/ **(adj)** có thể hiểu được Destructive /dɪˈstrʌk.tɪv/ **(adj)** mang tính phá hoại, phá hủy, tiêu cực Otherwise /ˈʌð.ər.waɪz/ **(adv)**

didn't have to save any harder, (b) I didn't have to work harder, or (c) I didn't have to live where apartments are cheaper." Jim keeps renting. Mary and Jim have made understandable decisions which are neither right nor wrong, and that's fine. What is destructive is when they pretend they had no choice. How many people swear it's impossible to change careers – until a heart attack convinces them otherwise? Either we call the tune, or circumstances and other people call it for us. WHY WAIT FOR A DOCTOR TO TELL YOU YOU'VE GOT SIX MONTHS LEFT BEFORE YOU START DOING WHAT YOU LOVE IN LIFE?	khác đi, một cách khác

What if my dream is impossible?
(Điều gì xảy ra nếu ước mơ của tôi là không thể?)

Humans do incredible things. Consider Roger Crawford, the American born with one leg and two arms, but no hands. Roger became a professional tennis player. That is, he earned professional status and coached tennis for a living. You can read his story in his book, *Playing from the Heart*. Roger's story makes you take a second look at your limitations. Digital Dan, of Ferndale, California, was a carpenter until he got cancer of the throat and had his voice box removed. When he could no longer speak, he became a disc jockey! Dan types his words into a laptop computer, and the laptop does the talking! There is a pattern amongst people who achieve their dreams – they often start from a long way behind. You find sickly asthmatics who became champion athletes, you find tycoons who were bankrupts. You find a thousand stories of illiterate immigrants who became college professors and company presidents. When the odds are stacked against you, you develop a mental toughness just to survive. The strength you develop to survive becomes your secret weapon.	Incredible /ɪnˈkred.ə.bəl/ **(adj)** phi thường Carpenter /ˈkɑːr.pɪn.ʈər/ **(n)** thợ mộc Voice box /ˈvɔɪs ˌbɑːks/ **(n)** thanh quản Asthmatic /æzˈmæʈ.ɪk/ **(n)** người mắc bệnh hen Illiterate /ɪˈlɪʈ.ər.ət/ **(adj)** mù chữ When the odds are stacked against you - Khi khó khăn chồng chất lên bạn Toughness /ˈtʌf.nəs/ **(n)** sự bền bỉ

IN A NUTSHELL

We always have choices. If you are not doing something, it's because you are putting your energy elsewhere. The question is not: "Why is this impossible?"

The question is: "What am I unwilling to do?"

When you say: "I'll do this thing. I don't care how hard it is", life then start to support you.

Unwilling /ʌnˈwɪl.ɪŋ/ **(adj)** không sẵn lòng, không muốn



7

GOD IS NEVER GOING TO COME DOWN FROM A CLOUD AND SAY: "YOU NOW HAVE PERMISSION TO BE SUCCESSFUL!"

.

You have to give yourself permission.

MAKE A START!

COURAGE

TRYING NEW THINGS

THE SECRET OF POWER

WHY NOT YOU?

Make a start!

"A man of knowledge lives by acting, not thinking about acting." *– Carlos Casteneda*
"You can't build a reputation on what you're GOING to do." *– Henry Ford*



Has this ever happened to you? You are sitting at your desk – either at home or at work – and the phone rings. The caller asks you to write down his number. You apologize: “Just a minute while I find something to write with.” Searching for a pencil, you start rotating stacks of junk around your desk… piles of medical receipts, airline tickets, insurance policies, pizza cartons, nose drops, coffee cups and old newspapers. “Sorry to keep you waiting, there’s a pencil here somewhere...”

You plough into the drawers amongst torch batteries, tooth picks, golf tees, weight loss brochures, wedding photos, loose change from Hong Kong, a kid’s crayon. A crayon! You scribble the number in lemon yellow and hang up.

You think to yourself: “Now that I’ve found those insurance policies, I’ll put them into a folder.” Then you file the airline tickets under “travel” and the coffee cups in the dishwasher. Before you know it, you’re on a roll... erasers into the top drawer, telephone books onto the shelf, pizza cartons into the bin. You even wipe the chocolate caramel off the telephone.

Suddenly you have a vision... “I could have a *tidy* office.” You feel a surge in your chest and you begin to plan: “I’m going to make fresh files with color coded labels, I’ll have a special jar for ball-points. I’ll even empty my waste basket every week!” Now you’re on a mission that’s bigger than writing utensils. You’re creating the world’s cleanest workspace! By midnight you’ve found a dozen pencils, but does it matter? No! You’re having too much fun with the vacuum cleaner.

This is the *office cleaning principle*, and it applies to writing reports, digging ditches, doing your tax, washing the car. You get excited about doing things *after* you start. You take the plunge, and *then* you feel the energy and excitement.

We often make the mistake of saying: “When I get the energy, I’ll begin jogging every morning!” No! You start first. “When I feel more enthusiastic, I’ll do my homework.” Wrong. “When I get the energy, I’ll start my own little business!” No!

You get the energy and the enthusiasm for the job *after* you begin. You get the energy as a *result* of your involvement. The secret is to *make a start*.

Another thing about starting things... you will never ever be absolutely ready for anything! For example, a public

Rotate /ˈroʊ.teɪt/ **(v)** xoay, chuyển qua lại

Junk /dʒʌŋk/ **(n)** rác, đồ tạp nhạp

Receipt /rɪˈsiːt/ **(n)** đơn (thuốc)

Policy /ˈpɑː.lə.si/ **(n)** hợp đồng

Nose drop /noʊz/ /drɑp/ **(n)** thuốc nhỏ mũi

Plough into /plaʊ/ **(ph.v)** lao vào

Torch /tɔːrtʃ/ **(n)** đèn pin

Loose change /ˌluːs ˈtʃeɪndʒ/ **(n)** tiền vặt, tiền lẻ

Scribble /ˈskrɪb.əl/ **(v)** viết nguệch ngoạc

Surge /sɜːrdʒ/ **(n)** sự dấy lên, sự tràn dâng

Ball-point /ˌbɑːl.pɔɪnt/ **(n)** bút bi (= ballpoint pen)

Utensil /juːˈten.sɪl/ **(n)** dụng cụ, đồ dùng

Vacuum cleaner /ˈvæk.juːm ˌkliː.nər/ **(n)** máy hút bụi

Take the plunge /plʌndʒ/ ra quyết định, bắt tay vào làm

speech? Are you ever one hundred percent prepared for a speech? No. No matter how many times you rewrite it, no matter how long you spend learning it, you will be telling yourself: “If only I had a little more time...” Take marriage. Are you ever ready for the walk down the aisle? Are you ever totally prepared for what follows? Not likely. You prepare as best you can, and then you take a deep breath and jump in. Fred says: “Give me some kind of guarantee that I won’t fail. Then I’ll start.” No Fred. You commit to do something. You prepare as best you can, and then you *start without all the answers and without any guarantees.*	

IN A NUTSHELL

You get motivated by doing things, not thinking about them. Action gets you excited and action reveals opportunity. Take the plunge.

Get serious

(Hãy nghiêm túc)



All the motivators and psychologists say you have to “believe in yourself”. That makes sense. But before you can *believe in yourself*, you have to *believe yourself*. So many people are wimps when it comes to promises and commitment. They say they’ll do something, and they don’t. They promise they’ll help you, and they go fishing. They promise they’ll pay their bills, and they leave the country! Then they wonder why their lives don’t work. Only commit to something if you know you will follow through. If necessary, make fewer promises and fewer commitments, but *whatever you say you’ll do, do it*. Gradually your word becomes law for you – and that’s when you really believe in yourself.	Psychologist /saɪˈkɑː.lə.dʒɪst/ **(n)** nhà tâm lý học Believe in yourself - tin vào bản thân (tin rằng mình có năng lực, có khả năng thành công) Believe yourself - tin bản thân (bản thân mình phải đáng tin) Wimp /rɪˈsiːt/ **(n)** kẻ nhút nhát, yếu đuối Commitment /kəˈmɪt.mənt/ **(n)** sự cam kết

	Commit /kəˈmɪt/ **(v)** cam kết

Courage

"Comfort starts as a servant and becomes a master." *– Kahlil Gibran*

People write songs about singing in the rain, but in real life, when they get wet, they moan. People love to watch Indiana Jones wading knee-deep through snakes and spiders – but when their office air conditioning fails, they explode. Perhaps if we had fewer adventures on our video recorders we would look for more adventure in everyday life. "Being comfortable" is overrated. I'm not talking about "money" comfortable – I'm talking "situation" comfortable. Much of our stress is created by our addiction to comfort... "planes should always be *punctual*, the workload should always be easy, the bank overdraft should be *comfortable*." Too much comfort gets boring. Our brains seize up! The less rules you make for how life ought to be and how you ought to feel, the easier it is for you to respond to whatever happens. If you follow any kind of dream you'll sometimes be uncomfortable – you'll get rejected, criticized, short of cash and exhausted. When adversity comes your way, see it as part of the process. Be fascinated. Be interested. Be amused. See the fun in being behind the eight ball. Something else about comfort. You'll notice that, very often, *courage* is better rewarded than *IQ* – and this frustrates some people. Fred says: "I'm highly intelligent, I've got two degrees – and I can't believe that less intelligent people get better jobs and make more money!" As a rule, rewards come when we risk our reputation or our money – or both.	Moan /moʊn/ **(v)** than vãn, rên rĩ Wade /weɪd/ **(v)** lội, lội qua Knee-deep /ˌniːˈdiːp/ **(adj)** đến đầu gối Overrated /ˌoʊ.vərˈreɪ.ţɪd/ **(adj)** được đánh giá quá cao (hơn mức phù hợp) Addiction /əˈdɪk.ʃən/ **(n)** thói nghiện Overdraft /ˈoʊ.vər.dræft/ **(n)** thấu chi (rút tiền nhiều hơn số tiền gửi) Seize up /siːz/ **(ph.v)** bị đông cứng, bị đơ Adversity /ədˈvɜːr.sə.ţi/ **(n)** nghịch cảnh Amused /əˈmjuːzd/ **(adj)** thích thú, vui vẻ

IN A NUTSHELL

Courage is not the absence of fear – courage is acting in spite of fear.
People who do nothing with their lives are just as scared as people who take major risks.

It's just that the first group get scared over tiny things.
Why not get scared over something significant?

Absence /ˈæb.səns/ **(n)** sự vắng mặt

Significant /sɪgˈnɪf.ə.kənt/ **(adj)** quan trọng, có ý nghĩa

"Have you learn'd lessons only of those who admired you, and were tender with you? ***Have you not learn'd great lessons from those who reject you, and brace themselves against you?"*** *– Walt Whitman* The temptation is to surround ourselves with friends and colleagues who tell us what we want to hear. Then, when things are falling apart, we've got someone who'll say: "It's not your fault!" There's value in having people who will challenge us – it's just less comfortable.	Tender /ˈten.dər/ **(adj)** dịu dàng Temptation /tempˈteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự cám dỗ

Take a stand
(Hãy có quan điểm)

"If you feel you are getting screwed, you probably are!" *– Chin-Ning Chu*



"Following your heart" doesn't mean being *soft*. The world is a tough place and nature's laws are severe. The weak lamb gets eaten by the fox. Weak people get eaten too! When you are weak, the foxes see you as an easy target – and you get picked on and you get stung. – – – One day a frog was sitting by a stream. A scorpion came by, and said: "Mr. Frog, I would like to cross the stream, but I am a scorpion and cannot swim. Would you be so kind as to swim across with me on your back?" And the frog said: "But you are a scorpion and *scorpions sting frogs*!" Said the scorpion: "Why would I sting you? I want to get to the other side!"	Severe /səˈvɪr/ **(n)** khắc nghiệt Lamb /læm/ **(n)** cừu non Fox /fɑːks/ **(n)** con cáo; kẻ xảo quyệt Pick on /pɪk/ **(ph.v)** ăn hiếp (get picked on - bị ăn hiếp) Scorpion /ˈskɔːr.pi.ən/ **(n)** bọ cạp Sting /stɪŋ/ **(n)** chích, đốt (v2: stung /stʌŋ/)

"OK", said the frog, "Climb on my back and I will take you." They were just halfway across the stream when the scorpion stung the frog. Writhing in agony, and with his last breath, the frog said: "Why did you do that? Now we'll both drown!" "Because," said the scorpion, "I am a scorpion, and *scorpions sting frogs!*" – – – Look out for scorpions! There are people around who don't mind drowning if they can drag you down too. Some people are to be avoided. Sometimes you have to stand and fight. When do you make a stand? You can only ask yourself: "What do I feel is fair?" Then take your position, irrespective of whether other people are going to like you or think you are nice. You can wear yourself out trying to get everyone to like you, or agree with you, and in the end, *they don't like you* and *you don't know who you are*. Ultimately, you can only depend on your inner guidance – in other words, follow your own heart.	Writhe /raɪð/ **(v)** quằn quại Agony /ˈæg.ə.ni/ **(n)** đau đớn cực độ Drown /draʊn/ **(v)** chết đuối Irrespective /ˌɪr.əˈspek.tɪv/ **(adj)** bất kể, bất chấp Wear out /weər/ **(ph.v)** làm kiệt sức Guidance /ˈgaɪ.dəns/ **(n)** (sự) hướng dẫn

Trying new things

If you do what you've always done, you'll get what you've always gotten.



Ask "courageous" people how they find the nerve to quit jobs, start businesses, buy real estate, move to different countries, do *anything* new, and you'll find a common approach. They ask themselves the question: "IF THE WORST HAPPENED, COULD I DEAL WITH IT?" When the answer is: "Yes." They take the plunge. It's the secret for the big risks and small risks... EXAMPLE: Ted is unsure about buying an apartment. He	Courageous /kəˈreɪ.dʒəs/ **(adj)** can đảm, dũng cảm Loss /lɑːs/ **(n)** (sự) thua lỗ, tổn thất Somehow /ˈsʌm.haʊ/ **(adv)** bằng cách này hay cách khác, theo một cách nào đó

asks: “What’s the worst that could happen?” Answer: “I could lose my job and be forced to sell the apartment at a loss. I might lose my savings, and have to start all over again.” He says to himself: “Starting over would be frustrating but I’d somehow handle it.” He buys. EXAMPLE: Ian wants to ask Jane for a date. He asks himself: “What’s the worst that could happen?” Answer: “She might throw her Coke in my face.” Ian says: “I’m used to that sort of treatment! I’ll ask!” EXAMPLE: Louise wants to quit medicine to study archaeology. She asks: “What’s the worst that could happen?” Answer: “My father might hit the roof, my friends might say I’m crazy, I might have to study twice as hard.” She says: “If the worst happened, I’d survive it.”	Treatment /ˈtriːt.mənt/ **(n)** (sự) cư xử, đối xử

IN A NUTSHELL

It is not a negative approach to ask: “What is the worst that could happen?” It is a way of measuring your commitment. Break your vague fears into specific possibilities, and risk-taking becomes more fun.

Vague /veɪg/ **(adj)** mơ hồ

Specific /spəˈsɪf.ɪk/ **(adj)** cụ thể

Risk-taking /ˈrɪsk.teɪ.kɪŋ/ **(n)** (sự) chấp nhận rủi ro

The secret of power

“When an archer shoots for nothing, he has all his skills.
If he shoots for a brass buckle, he is already nervous…
The prize divides him. He cares. He thinks more of winning than of shooting – and the need to win Drains him of power.”
– Chuang Tzu



Archer /ˈɑːr.tʃər/ **(n)** cung thủ

Brass buckle /bræs/ /ˈbʌk.əl / khóa (thắt lưng) bằng đồng (ở đây ám chỉ phần thưởng)

If you have ever swung a bat or kicked a goal, you will know that sport is more than a game. And you will know why grown adults – accountants, truck drivers, brain surgeons and check-out clerks – spend weekends in the blazing sun and the pouring rain, playing ball. At the ping pong table, on the badminton court, on the ski slopes, you can educate yourself about the laws of life. More than great fun, sport teaches us about our personal power. Some of the things we learn...

Live in the present moment. It is possible to think too much. You bowl your best ball, throw your best pitch, shoot your best shot when you forget about the score. The less you worry about winning and about what other people think, the better you perform.

Forcing things never works. Real power comes when you are relaxed. Try clubbing a golf ball down the fairway with brute strength! You are most powerful when you are not trying to prove you are powerful! This also applies to people management.

Keep your cool. Getting angry never works. Have you ever seen a golfer get angry? He's history. What about irate boxers and race car drivers? Dead meat! The same goes for parents and school teachers.

Don't hate your opponent – lift your performance! Hating things and people drains your energy and takes your mind off what you are meant to be doing.

If you think the world is against you, it is. Blaming other people doesn't work. Once you decide that everything is going wrong – that the umpires, the referees, the wind and the ball are trying to ruin your life, they will. Successful athletes are like any other effective people – they take maximum responsibility. They don't blame their mothers.

Extraordinary performance stems from extraordinary commitment. The casual observer assumes that a Michael Jordan or a Steffi Graf was simply born with more talent. But many people are born gifted. A closer look reveals that the stars demand more of themselves than anybody else.

In sport and life you must concentrate on what you want. When you think about what you *don't* want to happen, e.g. a double fault, a slice into the water hazard, a dropped catch, it happens! Why? Your mind works on pictures. You tell yourself: *"Don't hit the ball into the net!"* You get a mental

Swing /swɪŋ/ **(v)** vung (gậy)
(v2: swung /swʌŋ/)

Blazing /ˈbleɪ.zɪŋ/ **(adj)** nóng rực, chói chang

Pouring /pɔː.rɪŋ/ **(adj)** như trút nước, xối xả

Ping pong /ˈpɪŋˌpɑːŋ/ **(n)** bóng bàn

Slope /sloʊp/ **(n)** dốc

Bowl /boʊl/ **(v)** lăn (quả bóng)

Pitch /pɪtʃ/ **(n)** đường ném bóng, cú ném

Fairway /ˈfer.weɪ/ **(n)** vùng cỏ ngắn để đánh bóng, từ điểm phát bóng đến lỗ bóng

Brute /bruːt/ **(adj)** thô bạo

Irate /aɪˈreɪt/ **(adj)** nổi giận, giận dữ

Dead meat! - tiêu rồi!, xong rồi!, vấn đề lớn rồi!

Umpire /ˈʌm.paɪr/ **(n)** trọng tài (trong một số môn như quần vợt, bóng chày)

Referee /ˌref.əˈriː/ **(n)** trọng tài

Stem (from) /stem/ **(v)** bắt nguồn, nảy sinh từ

Gifted /ˈgɪf.tɪd/ **(adj)** có năng khiếu, có tài

Slice /slaɪs/ **(n)** cú đánh xoáy (bóng gôn)

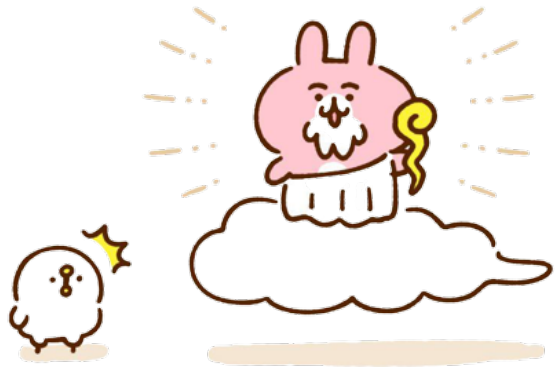
picture of the ball going into the net. You tell yourself: *"I don't want that!"* Your mind creates a picture of the bad shot. It then goes to work with the only mental picture it has – a picture of a ball in the net. And you make it happen! Fear is a killer, not just in sport, but during a job interview, during a speech, during anything where you want to perform. When you concentrate on what you fear, and create those disaster pictures in your head, you are heading for disaster. Concentrate on what you want.	Water hazard /ˈwɑː.ţər/ /ˈhæz.ərd/ **(n)** chướng ngại nước (trong gôn) Dropped catch /ˌdrɑːpt/ /kætʃ/ **(n)** cú bắt bóng hỏng (bóng chày)

IN A NUTSHELL

All children should have a chance to play some sport – not for the trophies they get, but for the lessons they learn. Not the least of these is, it's not where you start, it's how you finish.

Why not you?

"When I was young I thought that people at the top really understood what the hell was happening... whether they were cardinals or bishops or generals or politicians or business leaders. They knew. Well, I'm up there, and now I know they don't know." *– David Mahoney*



Cardinal /ˈkɑːr.dɪ.nəl/ **(adj)** hồng y

Bishop /ˈbɪʃ.əp/ **(n)** giám mục

When I was a kid, we used to visit family friends, the Zerners. They always had Coca-Cola in their refrigerator. (Mum said it was because they were rich. At home, we drank water.) So I figured once you had Coke at your house, you had really "made it". Then one day we got some Coke in our refrigerator. Only then did I realize Coca-Cola didn't make you a superstar. For a while it seemed to me people who wore suits had really "made it". Dad only wore suits to funerals, and I figured that didn't count. Then gradually it dawned on me that wearing a suit didn't make you a genius. When I was twelve, I wanted to be Prime Minister of	"Make it" - trở nên thành công Funeral /ˈfjuː.nər.əl/ **(n)** lễ tang Dawn on/upon /dɑːn/ **(ph.v)** bắt đầu lóe ra, hiện ra trong trí It dawned on me - tôi đã nhận ra

Australia. “Prime Ministers would know it all!” That idea more or less took care of itself. Until I started writing books, I thought authors must have all the information. Maybe, at times, you have thought the same – that there are experts who have all the answers. *There aren’t*. Successful people aren’t superhuman. They have one brain, twenty-four hours in the day, and usually, two arms and legs. They have developed skills and disciplines and taken them to the market place. You can develop your own skills and disciplines and take them to the market place.	Genius /ˈdʒiː.ni.əs/ **(n)** thiên tài Prime Minister /ˌpraɪm ˈmɪn.ɪ.stər/ **(n)** thủ tướng

IN A NUTSHELL

Nobody is born with special permission to succeed. God doesn’t come down form a cloud and say: “Now is your time!” He doesn’t say: “You can,” of “You can’t.” YOU DO!

When the student is ready…

When the student is ready, the teacher will appear.



When you are absolutely committed to changing your life or reaching a goal, the means to help you get there present themselves – people show up, friends lend you books, advertisements “jump out and hit you”, you find yourself in the right place at the right time... Am I saying you are more *aware* of opportunities, or that you literally *attract* opportunities? It’s both. I remember on October 19, 1983, I made a decision that, whatever it took, I was going to be a much happier person than I had been for my first twenty-five years. Three days later, for no reason at all, I tuned into a radio station I never listened to, and heard about a coming seminar. I attended that course and it was a turning point in my life. My experience is not uncommon – it’s more the norm. The key is commitment. Commitment is not wishing for something – it is a decision deep within yourself to do whatever it takes.	Present /prɪˈzent/ **(v)** xuất hiện, lộ ra Uncommon /ʌnˈkɑː.mən/ **(n)** hiếm thấy, bất thường Norm /nɔːrm/ **(n)** sự bình thường, tiêu chuẩn thông thường

IN A NUTSHELL

ONCE WE MAKE A DECISION TO DO A THING, THE MEANS APPEAR. We might explain away these lucky breaks as coincidence. But with keen observation, we notice it happens regularly.

Break /breɪk/ **(n)** cơ hội, dịp may

Coincidence /koʊˈɪn.sɪ.dəns/ **(n)** (sự) trùng hợp ngẫu nhiên

Keen /kiːn/ **(n)** nhạy bén

8

WHEN YOU FIGHT LIFE, LIFE ALWAYS WINS.

.

If you want more peace of mind, stop labelling everything that happens as "good" or "bad".

LUCK

THOUGHTS

PEACE OF MIND

THE WHOLE PICTURE



Luck

There once lived a farmer. He had a son and a horse. One day the farmer's horse ran away, and all his neighbors came to console him, saying: "What bad luck that your horse has run away!" And the old man replied: "Who knows if it's good luck or bad luck." "Of course it's bad luck!" said the neighbors. Within a week, the farmer's horse returned home, followed by twenty wild horses. The farmer's neighbors came to celebrate, saying: "What good luck that you have your horse back – plus another twenty!" And the old man replied: "Who knows if it's good luck or bad luck!" The next day the farmer's son was riding amongst the wild horses, and fell and broke his leg. The neighbors came to console him, saying: "What bad luck!" And the farmer said: "Who knows if it's good or bad luck!" And some of the neighbors were angry, and said: "Of course it's bad luck, you silly old fool!" Another week went by, and an army came through town, enlisting all the fit young men to fight in distant lands. The farmer's son, with his broken leg, was left behind. All the neighbors came to celebrate, saying: "What good luck that your son was left behind!" And the farmer said: "Who knows?" We can spend our whole lives figuring everything out. "This is good, that is bad..." It is futile. We label events as "disasters" when we only see one percent of the picture.	Enlist /ɪnˈlɪst/ **(v)** tuyển quân Futile /ˈfjuːţəl/ **(adj)** phù phiếm, vô ích
So long as you *believe* that everything is going wrong, it will keep going wrong. As long as you go through your day kicking and screaming, nothing works. But the minute you	Point of view /ˌpɔɪnt əv ˈvjuː/ **(n)** quan điểm, cách nhìn

change your point of view, *everything* changes.

You are bumped off a plane and you say: “This is terrible. I’m in a hurry. People are waiting for me. I have to be on that flight.” While you stay with that thought pattern, people will trip over you, spill coffee in your lap and lose your baggage. WHEN YOU FIGHT LIFE, LIFE ALWAYS WINS.

Things will improve the minute you say: “There are no accidents in my life. I am where I am meant to be.” You meet an old friend, you make a new friend, you take time to read a book and life begins to improve.

Taking the logical point of view doesn’t always work. You apply for a job, and miss out. If you tell yourself: “That was *my* job. I had the qualifications and the experience and now my life is ruined”, you can be a wreck. You can be a wreck for a week or if you want, a lifetime. You can argue your case with wonderfully logical reasoning. Your argument will work but your life won’t, because life isn’t logical!

If you want more peace, stop labelling everything that happens as good or bad! In his book *The Frogship Perspective*, Dean Black quotes two true stories:

“A sixteen year old all-star basketball player loses both legs in a farming accident.”

“A middle aged man gains sight after being blind since birth.”

The basketballer, Curt Brinkman, becomes an outstanding wheelchair athlete. Interviewed, Curt says: “I’d just as soon be in the situation I’m in now as have legs. I don’t know what I’d be like if I still had my legs... I know what I’ve done. I know what I want to do. And it’s exciting. There’s no way I’d want to see it any different.”

And the fifty-two-year-old man who has his sight restored by a surgeon’s knife... “As a blind man he had gotten on very well,” says his psychologist Richard Gregory. “But when he finally could see, his previously remarkable achievements seemed paltry and his position almost foolish.”

The man finds seeing a great disappointment and dies depressed within a year.

Bump (off) /bʌmp/ **(v)** đẩy khỏi (tình huống máy bay bán nhiều vé hơn số hành khách)

Trip over **(ph.v)** vướng chân

Wreck /nɔːrm/ **(n)** người suy nhược, phế vật

Restore /rɪˈstɔːr/ **(v)** phục hồi, khôi phục

Previously /ˈpriː.vi.əs.li/ **(adv)** trước đây

Remarkable /rɪˈmɑːr.kə.bəl/ **(adj)** đáng kể, vượt trội, nổi bật

Paltry /ˈpɑːl.tri/ **(adj)** tầm thường, không đáng kể

Thoughts



In simplest terms, we have two ways of looking at the world:

- The world is a mess.
- The world is OK as it is.

“THE WORLD IS A MESS” It takes so much energy to find fault with everything, agonising that some people cheat and steal, that some people are lazy, that some people eat too much and some spend too much, that some people get caviar and some get beans. And criticising makes you miserable too. We might point to the starving in Calcutta as if to say: “Everything is going wrong.” That can be an excuse for not making our own lives work. If you are an Indian – or if you’re living in Calcutta and helping the Indians, perhaps the situation makes a little more sense. But to judge situations we don’t fully understand from a distance isn’t helpful. If you want to make a difference, and do something about it, that’s another matter. But agonising doesn’t help. The Mother Teresas of the world don’t agonize – they act.	Caviar /ˈkæv.i.ɑːr/ **(n)** trứng cá muối Starving /ˈstɑːr.vɪŋ/ **(n)** nạn đói Mother Teresa - Mẹ Têrêsa, được trao Giải Nobel Hòa bình năm 1979, đã đến Ấn Độ và dành hơn 40 năm để chăm sóc người nghèo, người bệnh...
“THE WORLD IS OK AS IT IS” The alternative option is to accept the world as it is. You say: “What is the evidence to suggest that the world is fine?” Because it is the way it is! The moon rolls around the earth and the earth rolls around the sun, roses bloom, birds sing, people marry... and divorce, neighbors fight. It’s all part of the grand scheme of things. To say: “People shouldn’t get sick, people shouldn’t tell lies.” That is like saying: “The sun is too big!” Things work the way they are. Mary says: “I’ll never be happy until there is world peace.” That may seem noble, but it’s not very intelligent! Better to be happy in the meantime and work at making your little corner of the world more peaceful. It is possible to accept the world as it is and still accept a share of responsibility to improve things.	Evidence /ˈev.ə.dəns/ **(n)** bằng chứng Scheme /skiːm/ **(n)** hệ thống, sự phối hợp Noble /ˈnoʊ.bəl/ **(adj)** cao thượng, cao cả Meantime /ˈmiːn.taɪm/ **(n)** trong khi ấy, trong khi chờ đợi



If not for this, I'd be happy!
(Nếu không phải vì điều này, tôi sẽ hạnh phúc)

A retired executive told me: "I used to worry about million dollar take-overs. Now I get stressed out over dirty windows and lawn clippings!" He said: "Now that I have fewer major worries, I worry about minor things that don't matter."

It's true. We *find* things to worry about. Picture yourself on a twelve-hour plane trip. You've just taken off, and you are hoping to relax and maybe even get some sleep. And then you notice it. The fellow next to you is sniffing, and he's doing it like clockwork, every six seconds. "One, two, three, four, five, *sniff*, one, two, three, four, five, *sniff*... " Oh no! This guy's a sniffing metronome!" You say to yourself, "If I didn't have to put up with this turkey, I'd be happy!"

You take out your calculator – "Ten sniffs a minute multiplied by... that's seven thousand two hundred sniffs until Frankfurt. This could be the worst night of my life!"

Until now you hadn't noticed the sleeping baby behind you. But now he's wide awake and testing his lungs. Non-stop howling infants on non-stop flights are hard to ignore. This is when you say to yourself: "And I was worried about 'Sniffer!' I can tolerate bad manners, but wailing babies? No wonder I'm upset!"

It's about now that things take a turn for the worse. Without warning your jumbo jet shudders and plunges earthward. You feel the blood drain from your face as your stomach lodges in your throat. Everyone is screaming. Reaching for your life jacket you make a deal with God: "Get me out of this power dive and I'll never be irritated by sniffers again. I'll happily suffer screaming infants all the way to Europe."

The plane levels out and begins to climb. The captain apologizes for the unexpected turbulence. Baby stops crying and Sniffer falls asleep. You resume your crossword in peace – and guess what! Sniffer starts to snore. "Oh no! If I

Take-over /ˈteɪkˌoʊ.vər/ **(n)** sự tiếp quản

Lawn clipping /lɑːn/ /ˈklɪp.ɪŋ/ **(n)** mảnh cỏ nhỏ còn lại sau khi bị cắt khỏi sân

Sniff /snɪf/ **(v)** khịt mũi

Clockwork /ˈklɑːk.wɜːrk/ **(n)** bộ máy đồng hồ
Like clockwork - đều đặn như một cái máy

Metronome /ˈmet.rə.noʊm/ **(n)** máy đếm nhịp

Howling /ˈhaʊ.lɪŋ/ **(adj)** hú lên, gào lên

Infant /ˈɪn.fənt/ **(n)** đứa trẻ sơ sinh

Wailing /weɪ.lɪŋ/ **(adj)** khóc lóc (dài và cao độ)

Shudder /ˈʃʌd.ər/ **(v)** giật mạnh, rung lắc

Plunge /plʌndʒ/ **(v)** lao xuống, đâm vào

Life jacket /ˈlaɪfˌdʒæk.ɪt/ **(n)** áo phao, áo cứu hộ

Power dive /ˈpaʊ.ərˌdaɪv/ **(n)** sự bổ nhào xuống của máy bay,

didn't have to put up with this, I'd be happy!"

Here's how life is. We have a "worry hierarchy" and the most important things get worried about. While we've got a broken leg we don't worry about a headache – until the broken leg has healed. Snoring husbands only irritate us until the bedroom catches fire.

So how do we get less irritated? We recognize that our stress is caused by rules in our own head. As soon as we relax some of the rules, or drop them altogether, we don't get so annoyed when the real world ignores our rules.

We can make a conscious decision: "No one is going to ruin my day." We make a pact with ourselves that "No arrogant bank clerk, no parking meter attendant, no traffic cop, no waitress with a chip on her shoulder is going to mess with my twenty-four hours." We remind ourselves that in the context of world events, a confrontation with a rude checkout clerk is not that dramatic.

tăng tốc bởi cả trọng lực và động cơ

Level out **(ph.v)** giữ ổn định

Turbulence /ˈtɜːr.bjə.ləns/ **(n)** sự hỗn loạn, nhiễu loạn

Resume /rɪˈzuːm/ **(v)** tiếp tục, bắt đầu lại

Hierarchy /ˈhaɪ.rɑːr.ki/ **(n)** hệ thống cấp bậc

Pact /pækt/ **(n)** hiệp ước, giao kèo

Arrogant /ˈer.ə.gənt/ **(adj)** kiêu ngạo

Attendant /əˈten.dənt/ **(n)** người phục vụ

Confrontation /ˌkɑːn.frənˈteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự đối đầu, cãi cọ

IN A NUTSHELL

There are alternatives to getting angry. It is possible to be fascinated or amused. The fewer rules you have about how life ought to be, and how other people ought to behave, the easier it is to be happy.

Alternative /ɑːlˈtɜːr.nə.t̬ɪv/ **(n)** lựa chọn / giải pháp thay thế, lựa chọn / giải pháp khác

Why should I learn to control my thoughts?

(Tại sao tôi nên học cách kiểm soát suy nghĩ của mình?)

For two reasons:

- You can't control your environment, the weather or other people's opinions about you. The one thing over which you have total control – and the most important – is your thoughts.

Bitch (about) /bɪtʃ/ **(v)** than vãn, nói xấu

Little punk /pʌŋk/ **(n)** đứa trẻ láo xược

• Externals don't make us happy! I say: *"If I had 'X' I'd be happy!"* Wrong. I'd be happy for about twenty- four hours, and then find something else to bitch about... I pray for a new Porsche, and it falls out of the sky. I'm ecstatic. I drive it to the supermarket where some kid attacks it with a shopping cart... Now I'm saying: *"I won't be happy until I catch the little punk!"* Recall an incident in the last week which disturbed you: you were abused in traffic, your boyfriend forgot your birthday, your wallet was stolen. Realize it wasn't the incident that was disturbing, it was your thoughts about it. You say: "*Anybody* would have been upset." Wrong. *Most* people. All our lives we've been conditioned to think certain thoughts about things. It's the thoughts that make us unhappy – and we can change our thoughts.	Incident /ˈɪn.sɪ.dənt/ **(n)** sự việc, việc bất ngờ xảy ra, việc rắc rối Disturb /dɪˈstɜːrb/ **(v)** làm phiền não, làm khó chịu Condition /kənˈdɪʃ.ən/ **(v)** điều kiện hóa, (huấn luyện cho) quen với (việc gì đó)

IN A NUTSHELL

You improve your quality of life by working on your thoughts, and your thoughts affect your feelings.

Peace of mind



Why do I want peace?

Most people agree they want more love in their life, but why work at peace of mind? Because LOVE AND PEACE ARE INSEPARABLE. Love is not an emotion. Love is not "owning" a girlfriend or boyfriend. Love is experiencing without judgement. If you look for love, you'll find more peace – and if you look for peace you'll find more love. Peace is not Valium. Peace is *balance*.	Inseparable /ɪnˈsep.rə.bəl/ **(adj)** không thể tách rời Valium /ˈvæl.i.əm/ **(n)** thuốc dùng giảm căng thẳng thần kinh

Lesson One for martial artists is balance. In karate you learn that your power depends on balance and a still mind. Get too excited and you're a dead duck. Golfers know about balance. At the tee, furious swings count for zero. Instead, you relax, sense your power, clear your head of the chatter, and bingo – it all comes together. Balance, or peace of mind, is your source of power. Peaceful doesn't mean sleepy! Peaceful means aligning with forces rather than fighting them. Peaceful means seeing the broader picture and not getting hung up on details.	Martial artist /ˌmɑːr.ʃəl ˈɑːr.ɾɪst/ **(n)** võ sĩ Furious /ˈfʊr.i.əs/ **(adj)** giận dữ, hung dữ Chatter /ˈtʃæɾ.ər/ **(n)** tiếng nói huyên thuyên Align /əˈlaɪn/ **(v)** đứng thẳng hàng, đứng cùng Hung up /ˌhʌŋ ˈʌp/ **(adj)** bận tâm, lo quá nhiều
AS SOON AS I PAY OFF THE CAR, I'LL BE MORE PEACEFUL. Fred says: "Let me take care of all the bills and *then* I'll look for some peace." Sounds good in theory, but the results are usually disappointing. This is because our main mission in life is not to eliminate the mortgage and extend the swimming pool. We are here to help one another. Because of this, the universe gives us the following cues: • WE ARE HAPPIEST WHEN WE ARE HELPING OTHER PEOPLE WITH THEIR LIVES. • WE ARE LONELIEST WHEN OUR PRINCIPAL GOAL IS OUR OWN PERSONAL SECURITY. And if you want absolute security in this life, you chose the wrong planet. Fred says: "If I can get my little house in the suburbs and if I can get a nest egg for my retirement, I'll be secure." Sure, Fred. Try telling that to a runaway bus at an intersection! Your only security is within yourself – security anywhere else is a myth. Banks collapse, companies disappear, jumbo jets fall out of the sky. So how do you deal with the uncertainty of life? You accept it. Enjoy it. You say: "Half the fun of being here is knowing that anything could happen next." You make an agreement with yourself: "Whatever happens, I'll handle it." You look fear in the face. You say: "If my house burns down, I'll move. If I get fired, I'll quit! If I get hit by a bus, I'm out of here." End of story.	Cue /kjuː/ **(n)** tín hiệu, sự ra hiệu, gợi ý Principal /ˈprɪn.sə.pəl/ **(adj)** chính, chủ yếu (chú ý phân biệt với Principle /ˈprɪn.sə.pəl/) Security /səˈkjʊr.ə.ɾi/ **(n)** sự an toàn, sự đảm bảo Nest egg /ˈnest ˌeg/ **(n)** tiền tiết kiệm Secure /səˈkjʊr/ **(adj)** an tâm, an toàn Runaway /ˈrʌnəweɪ/ **(adj)** mất kiểm soát Intersection /ˌɪn.ɾərˈsek.ʃən/ **(n)** ngã tư, giao lộ Myth /mɪθ/ **(n)** chuyện tưởng tượng Flippant /ˈflɪp.ənt/ **(adj)** khiếm nhã, xấc xược

This isn't flippant. It's realistic. Earth is a dangerous place. Lots of people die here! That doesn't mean you have to live life like a frightened rabbit.	

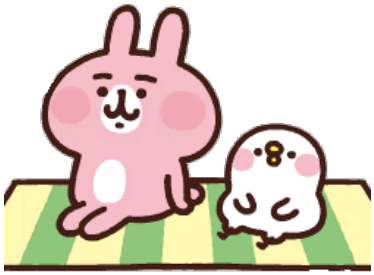


So how do I get peace of mind?

It's partly attitude. It's partly developing the daily habit to relax your mind. You'll notice something about people who have peace of mind: they each have a daily discipline for maintaining equilibrium. Many pray, some meditate, some walk on the beach at dawn. Each finds sanctuary and silence. In going inside themselves, they see outside of themselves. For four years I ran weekend seminars, teaching mind and body relaxation. I continued to be amazed at the changes in people who learned to really relax. They would report: "My headaches have gone." "My backache has disappeared." "Business has prospered." "The children are happier." "My husband is behaving." "My golf has improved." For the most part, the participants hadn't "done" anything. They had simply let go. In the western world, we are taught to "do" things. I have no argument with that. But before we start *doing anything*, we have to stop *fighting everything*. We grow up believing in struggle. We learn to force things and push people. We wear ourselves out and we screw it up. I learnt about this the hard way. When I set out to be a portrait artist, I decided nothing would get in my way. My recipe was "paint ten hours a day, seven days a week – and if that doesn't work, paint all night". I painted some woeful pictures. As I became exhausted and frustrated, it began to dawn on me that desperation doesn't work. Life remains a struggle while you insist it's a struggle. There is such a thing as letting things unfold. A young boy travelled across Japan to see a great martial artist. Given an audience with the Sensei, he said: "I	Equilibrium /ˌiː.kwəˈlɪb.ri.əm/ **(n)** trạng thái cân bằng Meditate /ˈmed.ə.teɪt/ **(v)** thiền Sanctuary /ˈsæŋk.tʃu.er.i/ **(n)** nơi tôn nghiêm, nơi trú ẩn Prosper /ˈprɑː.spər/ **(v)** phát đạt Behave /bɪˈheɪv/ **(v)** cư xử đàng hoàng, phải phép Participant /pɑːrˈtɪs.ə.pənt/ **(n)** người tham gia Woeful /ˈwoʊ.fəl/ **(adj)** rất tồi tệ Audience /ˈɑː.di.əns/ **(n)** (sự) yết kiến, tiếp kiến Sensei /ˈsen.seɪ/ **(n)** sư phụ, võ sư Keen /kiːn/ **(adj)** say mê, hăng hái

want to be the best in the land. How long will it take?" And the Sensei said: "Ten years." The student said: "Master, I am very keen. I will work day and night. Now how long will it take?" And the Sensei said: "Twenty!"	
MINDFULNESS Most of us have discovered how hard it is to live in the present, and much of our time is spent either regretting the past or fearing the future. Living in the moment is like walking a tightrope. You're bound to fall off, but with practice, you manage to keep your balance longer and longer. Here are two strategies to keep your mind on the present: • TAKE AS MUCH TIME AS YOU NEED TO DO EVERYTHING YOU DO Refuse to live life in a hurry. When our belief system says: "There is never enough time", guess what! *There never is enough time*. We run for the bus, we run for the elevator, we eat lunch between phone calls. Whatever you have to do, tell yourself: "While I'm writing this letter, (ironing this shirt, pumping these weights), my full attention is on what I'm doing. *How long it takes is how long it takes.* I refuse to hurry." • PRACTISE "DOG AWARENESS" Take your dog for a walk and you'll observe something. Dogs notice *everything*... every bush, every flower and weed, every fire hydrant. Take the same pooch on the same walk as many times as you like, and it's always a new experience for him. Dogs live in the present. When we practise "dog awareness", we notice that our mind is usually somewhere else. Try eating a meal and tasting every mouthful. Talk to a friend and hear every word. Listen to a song and hear every note. Take a walk and see every tree. Gradually we get better at it. Affirm to yourself: "I HAVE PLENTY OF TIME." An affirmation, repeated over and over becomes part of our	Mindfulness /ˈmaɪnd.fəl.nəs/ **(n)** sự chú tâm Tightrope /ˈtaɪt.roʊp/ **(n)** dây kéo căng (dành cho người xiếc đi trên dây) Walk a tightrope - đi trên dây Bound /baʊnd/ **(adj)** chắc chắn (làm gì đó) Weed /wiːd/ **(n)** cỏ dại Fire hydrant /ˈfaɪr ˌhaɪ.drənt/ **(n)** trụ nước cứu hỏa Pooch /puːtʃ/ **(n)** chó (từ lóng) Affirm /əˈfɜːrm/ **(v)** khẳng định, quả quyết Affirmation /ˌæf.ərˈmeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) khẳng định, quả quyết Pressed /prest/ **(adj)** chịu áp lực Sufi /ˈsuː.fi/ **(n)** Sufi giáo / Hồi giáo Sufi / Hồi giáo mật tông Mystic /ˈmɪs.tɪk/ **(n)** nhà thần bí Motion /ˈmoʊ.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) chuyển động

subconscious. When you feel pressed, remind yourself: "I have plenty of time." The Sufi mystics say that *we are born asleep, we live our lives asleep, and we have to die before we wake up*. I think they are talking about our awareness. So often we are just going through the motions while our mind is out to lunch. The longer you can stay on the tight rope, the better life gets.	Go through the motions - làm một cách tự động, không chú tâm



Why Relax?

With almost everything we do in life, we are chasing results. But with deep relaxation, meditation or prayer, it's different. You can't chase results. You may know there are long-term benefits, but your full attention must be in the present. *The act itself is its own reward.* For once, you are not trying to "get" something – you are *"being"* rather than *"doing"*. When you practise deep relaxation over time, you will notice that the quality of your quiet experience filters into your daily life. You become more relaxed and more intuitive. It's like dipping a cloth into scented water – each time you do it, a little more of the perfume remains. We all have access to an inner voice – but it is very subtle. When life gets too busy and noisy, we can't hear it. When we quiet what's happening on the outside, we hear the inside. Our intuition is always there, but often we don't listen. Research continues to confirm that resting your mind is good for your health. In one study, research teams from two world-famous universities studied seventy-three residents in homes for the elderly. Subjects were assigned to either (a) no treatment, or (b) daily meditation. After four years a quarter of the non-meditators had died. All of the meditators were still alive. In 1978, Robert Keith Wallace completed a ten-year study of meditators, evaluating their biological age via three indicators – blood pressure, hearing and near point vision. He	Meditation /ˌmed.əˈteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự thiền định Filter /ˈfɪl.tər/ **(v)** thấm vào Intuitive /ɪnˈtuː.ɪ.ʈɪv/ **(adj)** có tính trực giác, trực giác tốt Dip /dɪp/ **(v)** nhúng, ngâm Scented /ˈsen.ʈɪd/ **(adj)** có mùi thơm Subtle /ˈsʌʈ.əl/ **(adj)** tinh tế, khó nhận thấy Intuition /əˈwer.nəs/ **(n)** trực giác Assign /əˈsaɪn/ **(v)** chỉ định Meditator /ˈmed.ə.teɪ.tər/ **(n)** người thực hành thiền

found that subjects who had meditated for five years or less were on average five years younger biologically, and that subjects who had meditated more than five years were on average twelve years younger biologically, e.g. sixty-year-olds had forty-eight-year-old bodies. I find that when I take time out to relax, meditate or pray, I feel more balanced and in control. Soon I get complacent and quit my prayer and meditation. Gradually life gets more stressful and I get frustrated. I lose my cool. Then I resume my daily relaxation regimen and life run more smoothly. Many busy people go through this cycle. The moral is: *"If you haven't time to relax, you absolutely must do it."* You would think we would learn – but we don't. Obviously, relaxation gives us a sense of well-being, but there are other benefits. We *attract people into our lives who feel much as we do*. When we are feeling peaceful, we attract peaceful people and more peaceful situations. Angry people look at peaceful people and think they are a bit peculiar – so they go looking for fights elsewhere. If you are relatively peaceful, and you do have to deal with angry people, they'll usually follow your lead and behave themselves much better! If you need help to learn a relaxation or meditation technique, there are plenty of books and groups around which can help you to develop whatever discipline appeals to you.	Non-meditator - người không thiền Biological /ˌbaɪ.əˈlɑː.dʒɪ.kəl/ **(adj)** (về) sinh học Indicator /ˈɪn.də.keɪ.ţər/ **(n)** yếu tố (cho biết) Blood pressure /ˈblʌd ˌpreʃ.ər/ **(n)** huyết áp Complacent /kəmˈpleɪ.sənt/ **(adj)** tự mãn Regimen /ˈredʒ.ə.mən/ **(n)** chế độ Well-being /ˌwelˈbiː.ɪŋ/ **(n)** sự khỏe mạnh, hạnh phúc Peculiar /pɪˈkjuːl.jər/ **(adj)** lập dị, kỳ dị Appeal /əˈpiːl/ **(v)** hấp dẫn, làm cho hứng thú

Tips for relaxing/meditating:

• HEALING IS A DAILY EVENT. So aim to do it every day and at the same time every day. Early morning is best because you avoid distractions and set yourself up for the day. • DO IT WHILE SITTING UP – if you lie down, you'll fall asleep. • IF YOU HAVEN'T GOT TIME TO RELAX, DO IT ANYWAY! Meditation gives you back more time than it takes. See it as "tuning" yourself like you tune a car – twenty minutes each	Distraction /dɪˈstræk.ʃən/ **(n)** sự sao lãng, việc gây sao lãng Efficiency /ɪˈfɪʃ.ən.si/ **(n)** năng suất, sự hiệu quả Project /prəˈdʒekt/ **(v)** hướng (suy nghĩ)

day to improve your efficiency. AND WHEN PEOPLE ARE HORRIBLE... Try this. Every time you get into arguments, have major problems with bosses, husbands, in-laws, pull away. Sit quietly by yourself. Relax. Feel yourself accepting them. Project love to them in whatever imaginative way you choose. If this seems a radical, new age technique for you, try it anyway. Don't try to figure it out – just use it. Many people do. You may be surprised by the results.	Radical /ˈræd.ɪ.kəl/ **(adj)** (tiêu cực) chỉ những người hoặc tư tưởng mang tính cấp tiến, muốn tạo ra những thay đổi về xã hội và chính trị một cách nhanh chóng, cực đoan

IN A NUTSHELL

Start every day with an intension to be balanced and peaceful. Some days you will cruise through until bedtime, and some days you won't make it past breakfast. If peace of mind is your daily goal, you will get better and better.

Intension /ɪnˈten.ʃən/ **(adj)** quyết tâm cao, tính kiên quyết

Give yourself a break!
(Hãy cho bản thân một sự nghỉ ngơi!)



Have you ever noticed that you can hike all day in the wilderness and feel energized – or spend a morning in a shopping mall, and feel like you've been hit by a truck? Everything around us has a vibration, be it grass, concrete, plastic or polyester. We pick up the vibrations. Forests and gardens have healing vibrations: they replace our energy. Concrete shopping malls and car parks have different vibrations: they sap our energy. Cathedrals have elevated vibes. Dirty restaurants with plastic table cloths are low energy places. Smoky bars and strip joints are low energy places – they "strip" your energy. You don't need to be a genius to realize that your health	Wilderness /ˈwɪl.dər.nəs/ **(n)** vùng hoang dã Vibration /vaɪˈbreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự rung động Sap /sæp/ **(v)** làm tiêu hao, làm suy yếu Elevate /ˈel·əˌveɪt/ **(v)** nâng lên, nâng cao Vibe /vaɪb/ **(n)** rung cảm, không khí

and feelings are affected by the subtle energies of your environment. When your energy is up, you are resistant to disease and other people's bad moods. When your energy is down, you attract depression and disease.	Strip joint = strip club – CLB có múa thoát y Strip /strɪp/ **(v)** tước đi, vắt cạn Resistant /rɪˈzɪs.tənt/ **(adj)** có sức đề kháng / chống lại

IN A NUTSHELL

It pays to be selective about where you take your body. It's better to go without than to eat in some restaurants, it's better to stay home than sleep in some hotel rooms. Guard yourself jealously and trust your intuition. Stay out of places which drain you. When a place doesn't feel right, keep walking!

Guard yourself jealously /ˈdʒel.əs.li/ **(adv)** bảo vệ mình một cách cẩn thận



Get some space!

(Hãy kiếm một chút không gian!)

It is no coincidence that in cultures the world over, there is a tradition and respect for time alone. During adolescence, the young American Indian and African bushman would leave his people and sit on a mountain top or walk the bush, to find his purpose. The master teachers like Christ, Buddha and Mohammed all drew inspiration from solitude, as have the millions of monks, mystics and seekers who have followed in their footsteps. We each need a sacred place where the phone doesn't ring, where there's no newspaper or clock, where we can forget about the bank balance. Be it a corner of the bedroom, a spot on the balcony or in a forest, it is our place for contemplation and creation.	Adolescence /ˌæd.əˈles.əns/ **(n)** thời niên thiếu Bushman /ˈbʊʃ.mən/ **(n)** người sống trong rừng Solitude /ˈsɑː.lə.tuːd/ **(n)** trạng thái đơn độc, nơi tĩnh mịch, vắng vẻ Monk /mʌŋk/ **(n)** thầy tu Sacred /ˈseɪ.krɪd/ **(adj)** thiêng liêng Contemplation /ˌkɑːn.ţəmˈpleɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** (sự) suy tư, trầm ngâm

The whole picture

(Bức tranh toàn cảnh)

"When we try to pick out anything by itself, we find it hitched to everything else in the Universe." – *John Muir*

Hitch /hɪtʃ/ **(v)** buộc vào, móc vào



Since the seventeenth century, science has taken the (Sir Isaac) Newtonian approach, i.e., if you want to understand anything, you break it into pieces, and examine the pieces. If you still don't understand, break it into smaller bits... go from molecules and atoms to electrons, to quarks and bozons... and eventually you'll understand the universe. Really?

Take a Wordsworth poem and divide it into prepositions and pronouns, then break the words into letters. What more do you understand about the poem? Analyse the "Mona Lisa" into brushstrokes.

Science has done wonders for us, but it's one side of the spectrum. Science dissects. The intellect pulls things apart. The heart brings things together.

There are questions to which information and intelligence have no answers. When you analyse your friends, you lose sight of their beauty. When you analyse and dissect the universe, you separate yourself. When you empathize, you see the larger picture, and you feel closer. Care, and you are instantly connected. Everything in the cosmos is connected. The more we break things down, the more we lose the essentials.

Molecule /ˈmɑː.lɪ.kjuːl/ **(n)** phân tử

Atom /ˈæţ.əm/ **(n)** nguyên tử

Quark, bozon - các loại hạt sơ cấp (vật lý)

Brushstroke /ˈseɪ.krɪd/ **(n)** nét vẽ, nét cọ

Spectrum /ˈspek.trəm/ **(n)** toàn cảnh, toàn bộ

Dissect /dɪˈsekt/ **(v)** mổ xẻ, phân tích

Intellect /ˈɪn.ţəl.ekt/ **(n)** trí tuệ, sự hiểu biết

Cosmos /ˈkɑːz.moʊs/ **(n)** vũ trụ

IN A NUTSHELL

The opposite of analysis is synthesis. Health comes from looking at things as a whole – looking at your body as a whole, looking at humanity as a whole.

Synthesis /ˈsɪn.θə.sɪs/ **(n)** sự tổng hợp

Gratitute and peace of mind



"If the only prayer you say in your whole life is 'Thank you', that would suffice." *– Meister Eckhart*

Suffice /səˈfaɪs/ **(v)** đủ (để đáp ứng)

For a moment, suspend all judgements about your life and the people in it. Imagine you woke up tomorrow morning and said to God, Allah, The Great Spirit, Jehovah, Jim or whatever you like to call the universal power: "Thank you for my life, my family, my home, my friends, my breakfast and thank you for another day." Wouldn't you feel more contented than usual? And before you argue: "But you haven't seen my family", imagine you were able to feel grateful the next day, and the next. Wouldn't you find some extra serenity?

Most of us grow up with feedback that we are not OK. We soon decide that our families, our lovers, our cars and jobs are not OK. We dwell on what's missing. "If only I had some respect at work, if only I had a Mercedes Benz..." Is it any wonder we find peace of mind so elusive?

Every time we feel thankful for something, we become more peaceful. Every time we say "Thank you", we are affirming: "I accept what I have and where I am. I'm learning what I need to learn."

PEACE OF MIND COMES FROM CONCENTRATING ON WHAT YOU HAVE, NOT ON WHAT'S MISSING. When you accept your life, you see how everything in it serves you.

Suspend /səˈspend/ **(v)** tạm dừng

Contented /kənˈten.ţɪd/ **(adj)** hài lòng, thỏa mãn

Serenity /səˈren.ə.ţi/ **(n)** (sự) thanh thản, thanh bình

Elusive /iˈluː.sɪv/ **(adj)** khó tìm được, khó đạt được

IN A NUTSHELL

If you are serious about peace of mind, at some stage you'll need a sense of gratitude. And here's the crunch – if you want to be grateful, you wake up grateful. If you say: "When my life gets better, then I'll be grateful", you never will be!

And then what?
(Và rồi thì sao?)



In a book about finding meaning in life, death deserves a mention. Wouldn't life seem fairer if we never died? Then, at least we could learn from our mistakes! How can you apply all your new-found knowledge – i.e., "that you should avoid buses travelling at high speed", when you've just been hit by one? It would be comforting to have proof that seventy-five years wouldn't see us at the end of the road.

Einstein is encouraging here. Einstein demonstrated that *energy is neither created nor destroyed.* Therefore, when you die, something has to happen to your spirit. Sure, your bones might fertilize the daisies, but there's more to you than bones and gristle. Your spirit must go somewhere!

Out of body experiences also suggest something beyond... Even if you haven't had an "O.B.E.", you probably know people who have. Aunt Molly tells you: "There I was on the operating table, and suddenly I left my body. I was looking down on my *own* operation. I remember everything the doctors said – and would you believe it, they were talking about the Chicago Bulls?"

You are more than just a body! So what happens to that part of you which isn't "body"?

Einstein and Aunt Molly both give weight to the premise that life goes on. Eastern and Western thinking agree that there is more to learn after we turn up our toes. One thing is certain – while we don't know exactly what is on the other side, death is an incentive to enjoy life while we have it. Quite a clever system, really.

The worst approach you can take is: "I'll suffer in this life but heaven will be my compensation." That's a big chance to take! So much better to say: "Whatever eternity has up it's sleeve, my current goal is to make my life work here and now!"

Proof /pruːf/ **(n)** bằng chứng

Spirit /ˈspɪr.ət/ **(n)** linh hồn

Fertilize /ˈfɜːrtəlaɪz/ **(v)** làm cho màu mỡ, bón phân cho

Daisy /ˈdeɪ.zi/ **(n)** hoa cúc

Gristle /ˈgrɪs.əl/ **(n)** xương sụn

O.B.E = Out of body experience - trải nghiệm ngoài cơ thể / trải nghiệm thoát xác

Weight /weɪt/ **(n)** ảnh hưởng, sức thuyết phục, sự tôn trọng

Premise /ˈprem.ɪs/ **(n)** giả thuyết, tiền đề

Turn up SB's toes - die

Incentive /ɪnˈsen.ʈɪv/ **(n)** sự khích lệ, động lực

Compensation /ˌkɑːm.penˈseɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự đền bù, bồi thường

Eternity /ɪˈtɜːr.nə.ʈi/ **(n)** sự vĩnh cữu, vĩnh hằng

Have STh up SB's sleeve - có kế hoạch / ý tưởng bí mật

IN A NUTSHELL

It seems reasonable to assume that any qualities and talents you develope in this life – love, determination, compassion, basket weaving – you'll get to take with you. So our best bet is to develop ourselves to our full potential here and now – and hope the benefits are transferable!

Basket weaving /ˈwiː.vɪŋ/ **(n)** nghề đan / dệt giỏ

Transferable /trænsˈfɜːr.ə.bəl/ **(adj)** có thể chuyển tiếp



9

HOW DO YOU LOVE PEOPLE? JUST ACCEPT THEM.

.

Complete acceptance is unconditional love.

WHY ARE WE HERE

FORGIVENESS

FAMILY

LOVE AND FEAR



Why are we here?

Imagine you came across a competition on your corn flakes packet: *"In ten words or less, answer the question... 'WHAT IS THE PURPOSE OF LIFE?'"* What would you write?

"Get a freehold house and cram it full of stuff?"

"Make a million and retire to Bermuda?"

"Get my golf handicap down to single figures."

Secretly, each of us knows that there's more to life. We know that PEOPLE COME FIRST – that the BMW's and the Gucci shoes are just trimmings. But sometimes we get side-tracked and the details get the attention – the leather lounge suite and the new entertainment system.

Competition /ˌkɑːmpəˈtɪʃən/ **(n)** cuộc thi

Corn flakes = cornflakes /ˈkɔːrn.fleɪks/ **(n)** bánh bột ngô nướng

Packet /ˈpæk.ɪt/ **(n)** gói

*Kiểu quảng cáo bằng cách in một thử thách gì đó ngay trên hộp sản

What is the theme of almost every song and every movie? Caring for people. How often does it take a tragedy to remind us of our real priorities?

Marianne Williamson makes this point when she talks about people on their deathbeds. In those final hours, when they are surrounded by their loved ones, how often do people say: “If only I had made an extra twenty grand?” They tend to say things like: “Take good care of your mother, the children...” They don’t often say: “Look after my car.” In answer to the question: “Why are we here?”, wouldn’t it make sense to say: “WE ARE HERE TO LEARN TO LOVE ONE ANOTHER.”

Experiments have been carried out in American hospitals where new-born babies in one group are held and stroked for ten minutes, three times a day. Babies in the second group aren’t stroked. The first group gains weight at twice the rate of the second. Medical science has a long name for this kind of treatment. We don’t need scientific words – because we’re talking about *love*. The fact is, without love babies don’t grow and without love adults suffer exactly the same.

I’ve lost count of the number of grown men who have said to me at one time or another: “All I wanted my whole life was for my dad to tell me he was proud of me. All I wanted my whole life was for my dad to tell me he loved me.”

If we’re honest, almost *everything* we do is an attempt to get more love. Everyone you pass on the street, everyone who has ever walked into your office is aching for love and acceptance – and some of us are doing crazy things to get it.

Why even worry about this? Because to make our lives really work, we need to know why we are here. If you don’t agree that our number one priority is *to love one another*, you may be prompted to clarify what is most important to you, and that’s a useful step.

If you do agree, then you can evaluate everything you do by the criteria: *“If I do ‘X’, will it bring more love into my life, into the lives of my family, friends and neighbors?”*

To love people you don’t have to kiss everyone you meet. To love people you don’t necessarily have to hand out rice bowls in the Third World. It is judging people less. It is allowing them to wear what they want, live how they want and

phẩm, nếu làm được thì nhận quà.

Freehold /ˈfriː.hoʊld/ **(n)** quyền sở hữu hợp pháp vô thời hạn

Handicap /ˈhæn.dɪ.kæp/ **(n)** điểm chấp (trong thể thao)

Trimming /ˈtrɪm.ɪŋ/ **(n)** đồ trang trí

Side-track /ˈsaɪd.træk/ **(v)** đánh lạc hướng

Lounge suite /ˈlaʊndʒ ˌswiːt/ **(n)** bộ nội thất phòng khách

Tragedy /ˈtrædʒ.ə.di/ **(n)** bi kịch, thảm kịch

Priority /praɪˈɔːr.ə.ţi/ **(n)** ưu tiên

Grand /grænd/ **(n)** A grand = $1000 or £1000

Stroke /stroʊk/ **(v)** vuốt ve (âu yếm)

Acceptance /əkˈsep.təns/ **(n)** sự chấp nhận

Prompt /prɑːmpt/ **(v)** gợi ý, thúc đẩy

Clarify /ˈkler.ə.faɪ/ **(v)** làm rõ

Criteria /kraɪˈtɪr.i.ə/ **(n)** tiêu chuẩn (số ít: criterion /kraɪˈtɪr.i.ən/)

Criticism /ˈkrɪţ.ɪ.sɪ.zəm/ **(n)** (sự) phê phán, chỉ trích

be who they are without our criticism.	

Forgiveness



"Forgiveness is the fragrance the violet sheds on the heel that has crushed it." *– Mark Twain*

Fragrance /ˈfreɪ.grəns/ **(n)** mùi thơm, hương thơm ngát

Shed /ʃed/ **(v)** tỏa ra

Here's what happens. We create rules inside our head for how people should behave. When people break the rules, we resent them. Resenting people for ignoring *our* rules is absurd. Most of us grow up believing that we can punish other people by refusing to forgive them – that is: "If I don't forgive you, *you* suffer." Actually, it's me that suffers. I get the knot in my stomach, I lose the sleep. Next time you are resenting someone, close your eyes and experience your feelings. Experience your body. Making people guilty makes you miserable. People do what they do, knowing what they know. Whether you make them guilty makes no difference – except that *it ruins your life*. Things are the way they are. If a hurricane floods your basement, do you say: "I'll never forgive the weather?" If a seagull craps on your head, do you resent the seagull? Then why resent people? We are no more meant to control people than we are meant to control rainstorms and seagulls. The universe doesn't operate on guilt and blame – guilt and blame are just stuff we've made up. While we're talking about forgiveness, the first step to making your life work is to forgive your parents. Sure they weren't perfect. But when you were a kid, your mum and dad didn't have all the pop psychology books on "successful parenting", and they had a lot of other things to worry about besides raising you! Whatever they got wrong, it is history. Every day that you refuse to forgive your mother is a vote to screw up your life.	Resent /rɪˈzent **(v)** bực tức, bực bội, không bằng lòng Absurd /əbˈsɜːrd/ **(adj)** vô lý, ngớ ngẩn Get the knot in one's stomach - có cảm giác khó chịu trong bụng, do lo lắng hoặc buồn bực Hurricane /ˈhɜːr.ɪ.kən/ **(n)** bão (v > 119km/h) Basement /ˈbeɪs.mənt/ **(n)** tầng hầm Seagull /ˈsiː.gʌl/ **(n)** chim mòng biển Crap /kræp/ **(v)** ị Rainstorm /ˈreɪn.stɔːrm/ **(n)** mưa dông



Pain is inevitable, misery is choice
(Đau đớn là điều không thể tránh khỏi, đau khổ là sự lựa chọn)

You say: “What if someone does something terrible? Do I forgive him?”

I have a friend called Sandy McGregor. In January 1987, a young man with a shotgun walked into his lounge room and murdered his three teenage daughters. The tragedy saw Sandy descend into a personal hell of pain and anger. Few of us could imagine what he went through.

With time, and the help of friends, he decided that his only chance to make his life work was to let go of the anger, and somehow forgive the offender. Sandy now spends his life helping others to achieve forgiveness and peace of mind. His experience is evidence that it is humanly possible to let go of our resentments, even in the most horrific circumstances. Sandy would also tell you that he let go of his anger for *his own* benefit and *his own* survival.

I notice that people who have had experiences like Sandy, fall into roughly two groups. The first group remains prisoners of their own anger and bitterness. The second group achieves an uncommon depth and compassion.

The events that transform us are usually not the things we would choose. As someone said, *we never want to go through what we need to go through, to become what we want to become.* Heartbreak, illness, loneliness, desperation... we each get our share. After any major loss, there is always a mourning process. But ultimately, the question is whether the experience makes you harder or softer.

For those of us who are less challenged than Sandy, the choice is the same. *“Do you want your life to work or don’t you?”*

Shotgun /ˈʃɑːt.gʌn/ **(n)** súng săn

Murder /ˈmɜːr.dər/ **(v)** giết, sát hại

Descend into /dɪˈsend/ **(ph.v)** rơi vào (dùng cho trạng thái tệ hơn)

Offender /əˈfen.dər/ **(n)** kẻ phạm tội

Humanly /ˈhjuː.mən.li/ **(adv)** trong khả năng của con người

Humanly possible - hoàn toàn có thể làm được

Resentment /rɪˈzent.mənt/ **(n)** (sự) oán giận

Horrific /həˈrɪf.ɪk/ **(adj)** khủng khiếp

Bitterness /rɪˈzent.mənt/ **(n)** (sự) cay đắng, đau khổ, bực tức

Mourning /ˈmɔːr.nɪŋ/ **(n)** sự đau buồn, thương tiếc, than khóc

Do I have to love (or at least like) myself?

(Tôi có phải yêu (hoặc ít nhất là thích) bản thân mình không?)

Yes! People who don't like themselves are a pain in the neck! Many people are uncomfortable with the idea of "loving themselves". At the same time, they expect their partners to love them! Isn't that a little odd? To say: *"I couldn't possibly love myself"*, and then get angry with my wife when she doesn't love me? Obviously, to have a healthy relationship, we have to like/love ourselves. We can't give anyone else something that we don't have. We can never accept other people *as they are* until we accept ourselves *as we are*. When we are mesmerized by our own faults, we look for the same faults in other people in the hope it will make us feel better. And we find them, but we don't feel better. While we concentrate on our own faults, the world will keep punishing us, and we will keep punishing ourselves. We do it with ill health, with poverty, with loneliness. As long as we don't like ourselves, the world won't like us. And then we blame the world.	Pain in the neck - người gây phiền toái (khiến người khác khó chịu) Mesmerize /ˈmez.mə.raɪz/ **(v)** mê hoặc, làm mụ mị
WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO LOVE MYSELF? In its simplest form, loving yourself means forgiving yourself. It means admitting that to this point you've lived your life the best way you know how. Stop seeing yourself as guilty. Forget perfection and aim for improvement. Forgive yourself for your own shortcomings and automatically you begin to let others off the hook for the same things. People reflect back to us what we are. If we pay attention, we are always getting messages, showing us how we need to grow. *The issue is always with ourselves.* For the sake of our children, we have to accept ourselves. Children follow our example. If you give yourself a hard time, they'll give themselves a hard time – and they'll give you a hard time too!	Let SB off the hook - bỏ qua / tha cho ai đó (để ai đó thoát khỏi tình huống khó khăn) For the sake of SB - vì lợi ích của ai đó

IN A NUTSHELL

When we forgive ourselves, we stop criticising other people.

What does it mean to "love thy neighbour?"
("Hãy yêu người láng giềng của mình" có nghĩa là gì?)

"Love cures two people, the person who gives it and the person who receives it." *– Karl Menninger*



I believe loving your neighbors means:

- Not judging them
- Not putting labels on them
- Expecting nothing of them

This turns out to be a very practical strategy which can save us a lot of frustration and disappointment. Like most spiritual principles, it is also excellent psychological advice.

We tend to say: "If I understood why Frank is so arrogant, then perhaps I could love the guy." If we make the choice to love Frank, we begin to understand him. Forgiveness and love are one and the same. That's why we find it easier to love babies – because we perceive them as innocent.

Whenever we choose to see love in a situation, we are making progress mainly because we can't love and resent people at the same time!

Perceive /pərˈsiːv/ **(v)** thấy, nhận thấy

Innocent /ˈɪn.ə.sənt/ **(adj)** ngây thơ, vô tội

IN A NUTSHELL

How do you love someone? Try substituting the word "acceptance". Total acceptance is unconditional love.

Substitute /ˈsʌb.stə.tuːt/ **(v)** thay thế bằng

Unconditional /ˌʌn.kənˈdɪʃ.ən.əl/ **(adj)** vô điều kiện

Family



“Why do I have a family?”

Families were invented to teach us about unconditional love. You can leave your colleagues at the office and your buddies at the bar. But with families it’s different. You are stuck with these people who know how to push all your buttons – and you have to learn to love them anyway. In families, we learn to appreciate people regardless of what they look like or what they can do for us. We learn to love on the inside. In the story The Velveteen Rabbit, the Skin Horse seems to be talking about unconditional love: *“Real isn’t how you are made. It’s a thing that happens to you. When a child loves you for a long, long time, not just to play with, but REALLY loves you, then you become Real... It doesn’t happen all at once. You become. It takes a long time. That’s why it doesn’t often happen to people who break easily, or have sharp edges, or have to be carefully kept. Generally, by the time you are Real, most of your hair has been loved off, and your eyes drop out and you get loose in the joints and very shabby. But these things don’t matter at all, because once you are Real you can’t be ugly, except to people who don’t understand.”*	Buddy /ˈbʌd.i/ **(n)** bạn Push SB’s buttons - tạo ra cảm xúc / phản ứng rất mạnh cho ai đó (chọc tức, làm điên tiết) Love off ~ Rub off - chà xát (làm trầy xước, làm mất kết cấu vốn có) Loose /luːs/ **(adj)** lỏng lẻo Joint /dʒɔɪnt/ **(n)** khớp Shabby /ˈʃæb.i/ **(adj)** tệ, xấu, tồi tàn

* Đây là lời của chú ngựa nói với chú thỏ đồ chơi. Chú ngựa dùng cách chơi chữ ***love off*** thay cho ***rub off*** (có phát âm gần tương tự). Như vậy, bộ lông của chú thỏ đã bị tay đứa trẻ chà xát (vì yêu thương) nhiều đến mức không còn mịn nữa. Đồ chơi bị mất kết cấu và hình thức vốn có của nó (lông bị hư, mắt rơi ra, các khớp lỏng lẻo). Tuy nhiên, bằng việc tạo niềm vui và sự thoải mái cho đứa trẻ, món đồ chơi thật sự có được một cuộc sống, nó được đứa trẻ yêu vô điều kiện mặc cho nó trông như thế nào.

Taking family for granted

(Xem gia đình như là điều hiển nhiên [xem nhẹ, không biết quý trọng])

Isn’t it funny how we often treat strangers who come to our home for dinner a whole lot better than we treat family?	Entertain /en.ʇərˈteɪn/ **(v)** tiếp đãi, chiêu đãi

Have you ever entertained strangers? You spend two days setting the table with your best silver and crockery, you serve seafood, strawberries and French champagne – and you never see those people again! Next week, Mum and Dad come over – and they get leftovers. We are more polite to people we hardly know! Perhaps we should turn it around sometimes – save the lobster for Mum and Dad. It was only in the last few years of his life that I learned to hug my father. Like many fathers and sons, I quit hugging my dad when I was about eight. I wanted to be "manly". It took me another twenty years to discover that *real* men can show affection. As an author, I see my face on television and in the newspapers from time to time. I have discovered that Sunday's headline is Monday's garbage. The question I ask myself is: "What do I mean to those who really know me and rely on me – my family and close friends? Am I dependable, trustworthy, caring and decent?" That's what matters.	Crockery /ˈkrɑː.kər.i/ **(n)** bát đĩa bằng sành sứ Leftovers /ˈlefˌtoʊ.vərz/ **(n)** thức ăn thừa Sunday's headline is Monday's garbage – tiêu đề chính (trên báo) Chủ Nhật sang thứ Hai là không còn giá trị gì Rely on /rɪˈlaɪ/ **(ph.v)** tin cậy vào, dựa vào Dependable /dɪˈpen.də.bəl/ **(adj)** = Trustworthy /ˈtrʌstˌwɜːr.ði/ **(adj)** đáng tin cậy Decent /ˈdiː.sənt/ **(adj)** tử tế, tốt

Supporting your partner

(Hỗ trợ người bạn đời của bạn)



There are two ways to run a relationship – one is like a team, and the other is like a contest.

Fred is due home at six pm, and he is already two hours late. Mary is worried sick. "What's happened to my Fred?" At eight-fifteen, Fred walks in the door. On seeing that he is healthy and all in one piece, she screams at him as if to say: "If you are going to come home this late, you could have at least had an accident!" Fred begins to shout and Mary switches to the dreaded *silent treatment*. Soon they quit talking to each other altogether. She goes to bed to find a note pinned to her pillow: "I have to be at the office early. Wake me at seven." Fred wakes at nine-thirty to find a note on his pillow: "It's seven o'clock.	Due /duː/ **(adj)** đáng lẽ phải Dreaded /ˈdred.ɪd/ **(adj)** đáng sợ Idiot /ˈɪd.i.ət/ **(n)** kẻ ngốc Counsel /ˈkaʊn.səl/ **(n)** lời khuyên, góp ý

Wake up!” So many couples are dedicated to making each other look like idiots. I can recommend *teamwork*. I am blessed with a partner who spends her life helping and encouraging me. I seek Julie’s counsel on every page I write and everything I do. Without her support, I wouldn’t be doing what I’m doing. As we grow closer together, it is remarkable how often waiters and flight attendants ask us: “Are you on your honeymoon?” We take that as a huge compliment. If you have chosen to live together, support each other. If you can’t support your partner, it’s time to examine why you are in the relationship.	



Love and fear

A Course in Miracles points out that we have two principal states of mind – *love* and *fear*. It suggests that fear is the source of our negative emotions. It’s a beautifully simple concept, and a useful starting point for examining our feelings: Jane says: “If I’m angry, it’s anger! It’s not fear!” Let’s see. Husband Bill arrives home reeking of alcohol and perfume. Jane is very angry. She screams and shouts and hurls plates across the kitchen. Actually, she’s screaming because she’s *scared*. She’s *scared* he doesn’t care, *scared* she’s losing Bill and *scared* about those long blonde hairs on his sports coat! *When we’re angry, we’re scared.* Jim is worried about his mortgage. Jim says: “But when I’m worried, I’m worried.” “Worried” is another word for *scared*. How can you worry about something if you have no fear? *When we’re worried, we’re scared.* What about jealousy? Jealousy is *fear.* It’s thinking you’re inferior to other people and fearing they agree with you. *When we’re jealous, we’re scared.* Lurking behind anger, jealousy, worry, depression, we always find fear. So how is this love/fear concept useful? It	Reek /riːk/ **(v)** sặc mùi, nồng nặc Hurl /hɜːrl/ **(v)** ném (mạnh) Inferior /ɪnˈfɪr.i.ər/ **(adj)** thua kém Lurk /lɜːrk/ **(v)** ẩn nấp Enable /ɪˈneɪ.bəl/ **(v)** cho phép, làm cho (ai đó) có khả năng (làm gì)

enables us to be more honest with ourselves. We discover that we are usually not upset for the reasons we think.	
If I want to eliminate my fears I have to admit they exist. While I'm saying: "You are inconsiderate for making me jealous", I stay stuck. Only when I can ask myself: "Why am I scared when you talk to handsome strangers?", then I begin to be unstuck. Now I recognize *my fears* instead of *your faults*. When I admit my fears, I have a chance to move beyond them. Admitting our fears helps us to explain our feelings to people we care about: *"Darling the reason I got angry is because I'm scared. I'm scared that if you buy that three thousand dollar outfit, we won't eat for a year."* *"I scream at you when you are so late home because I'm terrified that something may have happened to you on the road. If I lost you I don't know what I would do. I get scared."* When we admit our fears, we move away from making other people wrong. In essence, we say: *"I want you to know I'm scared. I'm not saying it's your fault."* When we accept that we don't have to be perfect any more, and explain our feelings in terms of our fears, our loved ones respond. Admitting vulnerability beats hurling abuse. Remember also, that other people aren't upset for the reasons they think. When they attack you, they are actually scared. Knowing they are scared, you are not so frightened. You say: "But if love and fear are the two principal emotions, wouldn't that mean many people are scared?" You bet! Lots of people are scared out of their wits – scared of looking silly or looking fat, scared of losing jobs, scared of losing face or losing money, scared of being burgled, scared of growing old, scared of being alone, scared of living and scared of dying. That's why they act so crazy! What makes them feel better? Being loved.	Inconsiderate /ˌɪn.kənˈsɪd.ər.ət/ **(adj)** thiếu chu đáo, thiếu quan tâm, thiếu suy nghĩ Vulnerability /ˌvʌl.nər.əˈbɪl.ə.ţi/ **(n)** (tính chất) dễ bị tổn thương Hurling abuse /ˈhɜːr.lɪŋ əˈbjuːz / **(n)** việc lăng mạ, xỉ vả To be scared out of SB's wits - hoảng sợ chết khiếp đi được, sợ đến bần thần Burgle /ˈbɜːr.gəl/ **(v)** ăn trộm



10

YOUR MISSION IN LIFE
IS NOT TO
CHANGE THE WORLD.
YOUR MISSION
IS TO
CHANGE YOURSELF.

.

There are no "outside" solutions,
only "inside" solutions.

WHEN YOU CHANGE…
YOU'RE NOT ALONE!



When you change…

When you get sick and tired of being sick and tired, you'll change.

Have you noticed that you have days on the freeway when everyone is trying to kill you? Whenever you leave the house angry, it seems people want to run you off the road! When you leave the office feeling irate, people abuse you in the subway. The reverse is also true. How different the world looks when we fall in love! The world is a mirror – what you feel inside, you get on	Freeway /ˈfriː.weɪ/ **(n)** đường cao tốc Run you off the road – đẩy bạn bay khỏi đường

the outside – which is why YOU CAN'T FIX LIFE BY WORKING ON THE OUTSIDE. If people on the street are unfriendly, changing streets doesn't help! If nobody at work gives you any respect, changing jobs won't fix it. Most of us learned things inside out! We learned: "If you don't like your job, change it. If you don't like your wife, change her." Sometimes it's appropriate to change your job or your partner. But if you don't change too, you are setting yourself up for more of the same.	Inside out **(adv)** bị ngược, lộn trong ra ngoài
Captain Gerald Coffee spent seven years as a prisoner of war in North Vietnam. Reflecting on changes in his attitude, he said: "In the beginning, I would pray to God to change my situation – *God give me the last five minutes prior to my capture, and I'll fly somewhere else... God, please let the Americans win and get me out of here."* "As time passed," he said, "my prayers changed... I began to pray that I might become a better person, that I might not only endure, but even benefit from my experience as a POW." His prayers of "change my *circumstances*" became "change *me*". He had discovered a fundamental principle, and from that point he began to see some purpose in his condition. Whatever situation we are in, we are in it because we have lessons to learn from it. *That's why we're there!* Asking God to change our situation makes absolutely no sense. Until we have changed, we still need the situation! If Mary is struggling in a marriage, *she* has to change. Mary says: "Lord, if you'll just change my husband Fred, I'll be happy!" Wrong! Fred resents Mary and refuses to change. Mary divorces Fred. Next year Mary is saying: "If you'll just change Chuck..." When we say: "God, please change my circumstances and save me the trouble of changing myself", we demonstrate a lack of understanding. The request needs to be: "Change me, change my thoughts about this." As our thoughts about circumstances alter, the circumstances alter.	Prior /praɪr/ **(prep)** trước khi Capture /ˈkæp.tʃər/ **(n)** sự bắt giữ, sự bị bắt Endure /ɪnˈdʊr/ **(v)** chịu đựng, chịu được POW = Prisoner of war - tù binh Fundamental /ˌfʌn.dəˈmen.ţəl/ **(adj)** căn bản, cơ bản
Does this all seem a bit "new age" and goofy? Look at it in the light of physics. Three hundred years ago Newton proclaimed that all objects have a defined, unchanging reality.	Goofy /ˈguː.fi/ **(adj)** ngốc ngếch, ngớ ngẩn

But today's Quantum physics, and the Heisenberg uncertainty principle present a different picture, i.e. *The nature of a thing is actually altered by its observer!* What does this mean to you in your everyday life? That physics confirms what the spiritual masters have always taught – that a thing, a situation is transformed by the observer. As you change your thinking, your life will change. Your fixing your life is an *inside* job. You don't need to wait for anyone else to get their act together. When you move the world moves. To the extent that you change, the other players in your life change – or are replaced by new players. While they are helping to teach you your lessons, you are helping to give them theirs.	Proclaim /proʊˈkleɪm/ **(v)** tuyên bố Quantum physics /ˈkwɑːn.ʈəm/ /ˈfɪz.ɪks/ **(n)** vật lý lượng tử Uncertainty principle /ʌnˈsɜːr.tən.ti/ /ˈprɪn.sə.pəl/ **(n)** nguyên lý bất định Extent /ɪkˈstent/ **(n)** mức độ

IN A NUTSHELL

In relationships: WORKING ON YOURSELF WORKS, AND TRYING TO CHANGE OTHER PEOPLE DOESN'T.



The WORLD doesn't have to change…

Have you ever been sick in bed, and then ventured outside for the first time in weeks? Isn't it exhilarating just to see sky, trees, even grass? When you meet old friends for the first time in five years, isn't it wonderful? Life is suddenly richer, but not because the world has changed. We have. Joy comes from fresh vision. Happiness doesn't require that you take something else up, but that you drop something – those thoughts that don't help you. If you go through life taking inventory of people's shortcomings... "She's too fat, he's got a big nose, she's got a big mouth", it interferes with your peace of mind. Sure, it may give you an illusion of superiority, but you are affirming to yourself that *the world and the people in it are not OK.* When you choose to accept people, warts and all, you	Venture /ˈven.ʧər/ **(v)** liều, mạo hiểm Interfere /ˌɪn.ʈərˈfɪr/ **(v)** can thiệp, xen vào, quấy rầy, cản trở Illusion /ɪˈluː.ʒən/ **(n)** ảo tưởng Superiority /səˌpɪr.iˈɔːr.ə.ʈi/ **(n)** sự ưu việt, vượt trội hơn Wart /wɔːrt/ **(n)** mụn cóc

have a whole different feeling about the world and your place in it. It's a great relief. How do you do it? You have *preferences* about who you spend time with, but you don't make everybody else "wrong". You have preferences about your circumstances but you don't see everything as *right* or *wrong*. You recognize that your ultimate goal is peace of mind, so you decide to see differently. Fred says: "But my family conditioned me to concentrate on the negative!" Fine. Maturity is that point in our lives when we take responsibility for our thoughts and actions. Now that you are in charge of your mind, Fred, you can change it. Look for beauty in those around you and you will find more within yourself. YOU SEE PEOPLE NOT AS THEY ARE BUT AS YOU ARE. YOUR EXPERIENCE OF THE WORLD IS ACTUALLY YOU EXPERIENCING YOURSELF. If you don't like what you are seeing, blaming the mirror doesn't help.	Warts and all - kể cả những lỗi lầm, điểm xấu Relief /rɪˈliːf/ **(n)** sự nhẹ nhõm, khuây khỏa Preference /ˈpref.ər.əns/ **(n)** sự ưu tiên, sự thích ai đó / gì đó hơn Maturity /məˈtʊr.ə.ţi/ **(n)** (sự) trưởng thành In charge of - chịu trách nhiệm về

IN A NUTSHELL

In fixing your life: WORKING ON YOURSELF WORKS, AND TRYING TO CHANGE THE WORLD DOESN'T.

You're not alone!

"When you meet anyone, remember it is a holy encounter. As you see him, you will see yourself. As you treat him, you will treat yourself. Never forget this, for in him, you will find or lose yourself." *– A Course in Miracles*

Encounter /ɪnˈkaʊn.ţər/ **(n)** cuộc gặp gỡ (tình cờ, bất ngờ)



The universe is even more miraculous than we may have assumed. It is so exquisitely planned that we are all getting the lessons we need from the other players in our lives at any one time. The spiritual masters taught that we are all one – that your growth is my growth, that your pain is my pain. They	Exquisitely /ɪkˈskwɪz.ɪt.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) sắc sảo Grasp /græsp/ **(v)** nắm được, hiểu thấu Phenomena /fəˈnɑː.mə.nə/ **(n)** hiện

taught that on one level, we are all linked. It's a difficult concept to grasp. But isn't it an explanation for why it is that whenever we change, everybody else changes! This phenomena of circumstances "coinciding with our needs" was given a name by Carl Jung. He coined the term: *"synchronicity"*. He described it as: *"the simultaneous occurrence of two meaningfully but not causally connected events".* If we accept this idea of *synchronicity*: • OUR LIFE HAS PURPOSE • EVERY EVENT AND EVERYONE IN IT HAS A PURPOSE • WE DON'T FEEL LIKE VICTIMS Consider it. If you were making a universe, wouldn't you want to give people the opportunity to improve their circumstances by improving themselves, rather than have them all as victims? You might say: "Well that is a fairly miraculous piece of timing – that six billion people should be always in the right place at the right time to learn their appropriate lessons from each other." Amazing, but perhaps not unlike the way billions of different cells in the human body co-operate. Of course, there are reasons to resist the idea of synchronicity and our connection to the whole. While we separate ourselves, it's easy to blame people. Once we admit we are connected, we must take more responsibility for ourselves and for others. But this is what I notice: happy and effective people tend to embrace the concept of "oneness". They see every event in their life as meaningful feedback. They expect circumstances to synchronize in their favor. High performance people discard the idea that life is a lottery.	tượng (số ít: phenomenon /fəˈnɑː.mə.nɑːn/) Coincide /ˌkoʊ.ɪnˈsaɪd/ **(v)** trùng hợp Coin /kɔɪn/ **(v)** đặt ra, sáng tác (từ mới) Synchronicity /ˌsɪŋ.krəˈnɪs.ə.ţi/ **(n)** (tạm dịch) sự đồng nhịp (chưa có từ dịch trong tiếng Việt) Simultaneous /ˌsaɪ.məlˈteɪ.ni.əs/ **(adj)** đồng thời Occurrence /əˈkɜːr.əns/ **(n)** sự xảy ra Causally /ˈkɑː.zəl.i/ **(adv)** (liên quan) nhân quả Co-operate /koʊˈɑː.pə.reɪt/ **(v)** cùng vận hành, hợp tác Oneness /ˈwʌn.nəs/ **(n)** cảm giác hòa hợp, là một với gì đó Synchronize /ˈsɪŋ.krə.naɪz/ **(v)** đồng bộ hóa Discard /dɪˈskɑːrd/ **(v)** loại bỏ

Am I making choices or is my life path already sealed?

(Tôi đang lựa chọn hay đường đời của tôi đã được định đoạt?)

Where does "predestiny" and "fate" fit into life? Seen from the human perspective, it seems logical that *either* you choose your life direction or it has already been laid down. I think both of these things can be happening at the same time	Predestiny /ˌpriːˈdes.tɪ.ni/ **(n)** sự định trước (số phận),

– that we are following a path AND we are making our own choices. (Impossible? I think God can arrange that kind of stuff.) One thing we can observe – great people achieve greatness through persistent daily effort. It may be that they had a path to follow, but they didn't wait for someone to carry them down the path.	Fate /feɪt/ **(n)** số phận Lay down **(ph.v)** sắp đặt Persistent /pərˈsɪs.tənt/ **(adj)** bền bỉ, kiên trì
AS WE LEARN MORE ABOUT THE UNIVERSAL LAWS, WE TEND TO MOVE THROUGH THE FOLLOWING PHASES: **Step 1: We have no particular goals.** We believe that life is a game of chance. We muddle along going nowhere in particular. This is the victim mentality. **Step 2: We work on our goals.** We discover goal setting. We find that visualisation and disciplined effort combine to produce extraordinary results. We also discover that sometimes you achieve your goals but they don't make you happier. **Step 3: We work on ourselves.** We discover that there is such a thing as doing your best in the present and letting life unfold – that often life will present us with greater rewards than we could ever have imagined. We discover that there is a balance to be achieved between hard work and good timing. We see that there are alternatives to desperation and frustration. As we achieve greater balance and peace of mind, our belief in struggle is replaced by a sense of challenge.	Muddle along /ˈmʌd.əl əˈlɔːŋ/ **(ph.v)** (làm) tiếp tục làm gì đó mà không có mục tiêu rõ ràng Mentality /menˈtæl.ə.ţi/ **(n)** tâm lý Visualisation /ˌvɪʒ.u.əl.əˈzeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự hình dung Combine /kəmˈbaɪn/ **(v)** phối hợp, kết hợp

So where's the meaning?

We don't make our lives meaningful with one great deed. We have to see meaning in lots of little deeds, and find a connection amongst them. Fred makes his million and asks: "What's it all about?" Mary scales the corporate ladder and says: "Where's the meaning in all this?" Sarah has her baby, but she is still depressed. There's no actual meaning in a million or in being company president or in being a mother. Meaning is in the	Deed /diːd/ **(n)** chiến công, thành tích lớn; hành vi, việc làm Corporate ladder /ˈkɔːr.pər.ət ˈlæd.ər/ **(n)** nấc thang doanh nghiệp Scale the corporate ladder - thăng tiến trong công việc

present. Being “there” is no better than being “here”. If you want to find meaning, you pay attention to the moment – and it’s in the moment that you find the rewards.	